



Historic Placemaking: Strategies for Invigorating Downtown Cheyenne

SUMMER 2013

Greetings!

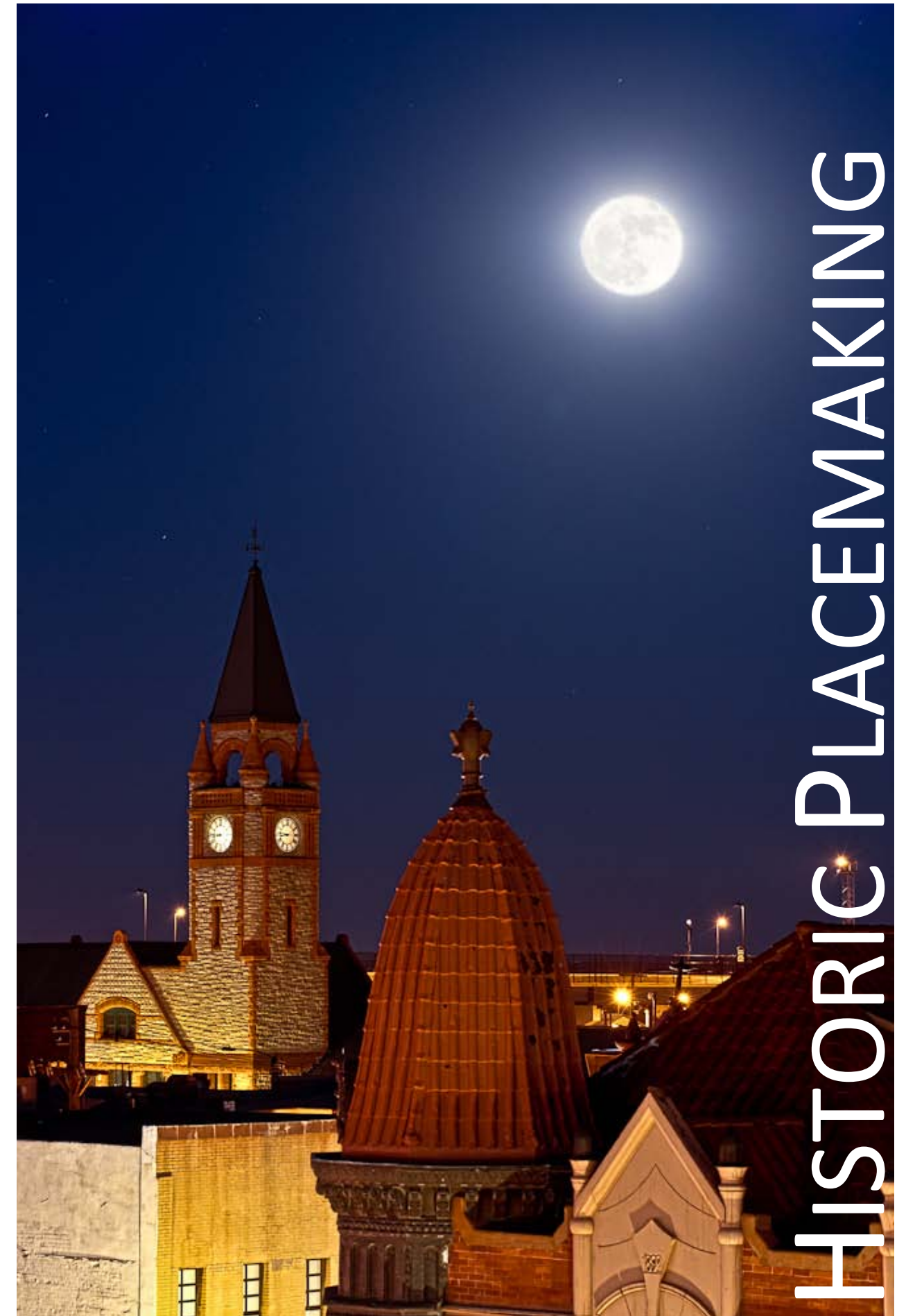
Nearly every day people who care about our community take me aside to talk about downtown Cheyenne and how to make it better. “Better” means different things to different people, but these conversations reveal common threads expressed by residents from all walks of life. Some wax nostalgic for the downtown Cheyenne they remember from childhood while others draw inspiration from travels to other cities. It’s clear that Cheyenne’s people yearn for a downtown that bustles with economic, cultural and social activity: a pleasant place to live, work, shop and dine as well as the capital city Wyoming deserves.

I share this vision for downtown Cheyenne. Rather than dwell on the past, disparage our community or bemoan the challenges inherent in reshaping our central business district, it is up to all of us to focus on how to be the best Cheyenne we can be... and we’ve got so much to work with! With its walkable scale, striking historic buildings and established organizations, we already boast assets other communities crave.

Evidence suggests that downtown is on the rebound, from significant activity by developers and other investors to new cultural organizations breathing life into once forlorn storefronts. Every month new shops and restaurants open their doors and people who want to live in an urban setting have more and more options. Downtown property owners approved a self-imposed millage to support the Downtown Development Authority’s endeavors, voting with their pocketbooks. Meanwhile Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne Frontier Days and numerous other organizations host events around Depot Plaza that introduce newcomers to all that downtown offers and ensure that they enjoy spending time in Cheyenne... and return with their friends.

Downtown’s charms notwithstanding, our greatest asset remains the talented people who live and work in Cheyenne and are willing to band together on behalf of our community. The Downtown Historic Placemaking project drew diverse ideas and insights that reflect Cheyennites’ affinity for straight talk and flair for approaching tough tasks with practical solutions and can-do spirit. Tapping that energy is one reason I look forward to partnering with Cheyenne citizens on downtown matters: to get more strong shoulders pushing the wheel.

In many ways, this document could be fairly described as a “Things to Do” list. That straight-forward approach is intentional, but the list itself reflects the hopes and frustrations of the 400+ people that took part in the Historic Placemaking project. We need to enlist and involve the numerous players that affect downtown and can, working together, make it the lively place that belongs to everyone in our community. Consequently, this plan responds to many diverse perspectives and includes implementation ideas geared towards alternative points of view. Some strategies you’ll read in this document describe long-term, large-scale initiatives with the potential to, eventually, prompt the need to revise the very maps describing downtown. Others are as simple as sprucing up the building and streets. All of them can use your help. Join us!



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Introduction

Across the country and around the world, certain cities, both large and small, inspire deep affection while others leave little lasting impression. But when people describe why they love a particular city, they tend to cite a few specific features followed by intangible aspects of their experience, from a feeling of community to friendly encounters with strangers to a heightened sense of well-being.

In short, some cities exude vitality, foster connections and promote possibilities and others do not. These places almost seem to exert a positive influence on its people – and vice versa – but how?

For decades urbanologists of all stripes have tried to understand this dynamic. It turns out that physical and economic characteristics contribute to:

- Strong links to the past, which stirs a sense of continuity and belonging;
- Potential for a bright future, which fuels optimism and the desire to invest time, money and ideas;
- Distinctive built environment with the personality and scale that evokes positive psychological responses.

Together, these facets of the urban experience create a SENSE OF PLACE that grows stronger over time. While newcomers will never understand a community’s sense of place as deeply as life-long residents, even leisure travelers can recognize it within a very short time. PLACEMAKING encompasses the process of identifying and implementing strategies to reinforce the physical, economic and social dimensions of experiencing a city or a neighborhood. Placemaking is therefore the work of many professions, including historic preservation, economic development, design and others concerned with aspects of community livability and quality of life.

Downtown Cheyenne

From a Placemaking perspective, Downtown Cheyenne presents a conundrum. It offers so many of the ingredients inherent in communities that radiate a strong sense of place, including:

- Historic buildings and fabric, resulting in a pleasant scale that promotes walkability;
- Stable area employment, including approximately 16,400 day-time jobs located within downtown’s roughly 70 square blocks;

- Strong market characteristics in part due to the draw it exerts on rural communities in Wyoming, Colorado and Nebraska;
- An organization devoted to ensuring downtown Cheyenne’s vitality that benefits from a generous and reliable funding stream;
- Recent new investments downtown, including rehabilitating historic structures and launching new cultural organizations;
- Emerging plans to address parcels with high development potential via substantial federal grant funds.

At the same time, downtown Cheyenne also suffers from impediments to fulfilling its potential, including:

- Vacant and underperforming buildings and businesses;
- Vacant and parking-dominated parcels, often held by out-of-town owners, especially on downtown’s west end;
- Gaps in the retail menu and limited housing choices;
- An economic climate that fails to generate enough return to justify rehabbing the “tired old buildings” presently offering Class B (and below) office space;
- Auto-oriented circulation patterns including one way pairs and, especially, the traffic speeds encouraged by U.S. Highway 30 and

FOUNDING CHEYENNE: AN OVERVIEW

In July of 1867, General Grenville M. Dodge, a former Union General trained as a civil engineer, arrived at the site that would become Cheyenne, Wyoming. After the Civil War, Dodge remained with the U.S. military and embarked on a new assignment: protecting the Bozeman Trail, an overland mail route that connected Montana’s gold rush territory with the Oregon Trail.

Skirmishes with local Indians who had long used the route ensued. While escaping from a war party, Dodge realized that he had discovered a pass through the Laramie Mountains that could serve the Union Pacific Railroad well. He resigned his commission and went to work laying out the Transcontinental Railway as the Union Pacific’s chief engineer.

Dodge chose Cheyenne – the name would come later – as the spot where the Union Pacific Railroad would cross Crow Creek, a South Platte River tributary. He and his survey crew laid out the site in one day, but by the time the first rails were laid four months later, over 4,000 newcomers had already arrived, certain that the area would bring them prosperity. Many followed the railroad further west, but many stayed and a town was born.

About six months later, the U.S. Congress established the Wyoming Territory, with statehood following in 1890. As the new state’s most bustling metropolis, Cheyenne became Wyoming’s capital city.

- Interstate-180, which lie beyond local municipal powers to address;
- Regional fixation on the future of a few (admittedly frustrating) buildings and parcels including the “Hole,” which marks the site of a landmark structure claimed by fire;
- A related lack of confidence in the ability of downtown’s stewards, particularly the Downtown Development Authority and the City of Cheyenne, to get things done;
- No state historic preservation tax credits and few other incentives programs, coupled with concern that some public investments devoted to downtown have not delivered sufficient results. (One very notable exception is Depot Plaza.)

Perhaps the most difficult challenge concerns the erosion of downtown’s relevance to people’s daily lives, from teenagers to senior citizens. Here Cheyenne is no different than scores of communities across the United States that have witnessed the mass exodus of downtown businesses and residents to new buildings and auto-friendly, suburban-style land use patterns. Meanwhile the rise of category killers and big boxes drew shoppers and their dollars to community edges, leaving behind an unsustainable mix downtown. Like many downtowns, Cheyenne’s Central Business District became known primarily for its civic and institutional uses – government offices, the hospital, utilities – and those who need

proximity, a neutral location or previous investment – law firms, Union Pacific, the newspaper – overrode any impulse to leave.

Every community can point to watershed events that changed people’s perception of downtown for better or ill. In Cheyenne, low water marks included:

- The 2010 departure of the Safeway at 25th and Pioneer, which left downtown without a grocery store;
- Closure of Roedel’s in 2007 at 21st and Carey, leaving downtown without a drug store and variety store;
- The arson-attributed conflagration that consumed Mary’s Bake Shoppe, thus leaving a gap between the Hynds Building and Wyoming Home on Lincolnway that has remained vacant for about seven years.

Although these three events stand out, many people’s withdrawal from downtown was due to the accretion of small incidents... a favorite shop closed, vague discomfort walking past a vacant storefront, an encounter with a panhandler, or the realization that life’s errands and entertainment could be managed without it. Bright spots over the years, including the outstanding restoration of the Plains Hotel, the Boyd Building and Depot Plaza, were not enough to offset the cumulative effects of disinvestment.

But across the country, downtowns are rebounding and there’s evidence that the tide is turning in Cheyenne as well. Cheyenne’s experience echoed the experience elsewhere, perhaps ten years later than most. Similarly, its re-emergence is also coming about a decade later. Nonetheless its renaissance can, with effort, be accelerated given that downtown Cheyenne continues to be relevant as a cluster of institutional, civic and hospitality uses. Moreover, downtown Cheyenne has seen some reinvestment activity despite the real estate market malaise following the 2008 financial crisis. Bright spots include:

- Private sector investments in, among others, The Suite, the former Grier’s Furniture Building and the former Dinneen dealership;
- New cultural organizations with an interest in downtown, including Lights On! and the newly consolidated arts community. Lights On! is animating the ground floor of the Hynds Building and Arts Cheyenne is investigating ways to enliven vacant storefronts;
- Additional things to see and do downtown, including several museums, concert series, the farmers’ market, festivals, etc.;
- The successful vote renewing an additional 10 mill levy on downtown properties, expected to yield about \$160,000 annually beginning back in November 2012;

- Laramie County voters’ decision to finance improvements benefiting downtown by imposing a Sixth Penny of sales tax;
- The ongoing work of the Downtown Development Authority and its partners.

Elsewhere, downtowns are once again becoming economic engines that attract creative people interested in the blend of attributes historic business districts offer: distinctive architecture, convenient retail and restaurant choices, walkability, access to cultural experiences and a sense of being connected to community. These attributes endure in all economic climates, giving downtowns persistent market appeal and helping them compete for traditional economic development opportunities. Demographics favor downtown revitalization too. Cheyenne’s peers, including other smaller state capitals like Little Rock, Oklahoma City and Raleigh are investing in their downtowns and reaping the ensuing benefits. Rather than pay for infrastructure and service costs associated with dispersed development patterns, these communities are working to make their downtowns appealing and finding that these investments make economic sense come budget time.

Recent analysis suggests that downtown Cheyenne’s development patterns hew to this model, with values per acre far greater than

experienced around Dell Range and other auto-urban areas. In addition, Cheyenne’s economy is relatively stable; the community benefits immensely from the steady jobs provided by its major employers and industries, including F.E. Warren Air Force Base (the oldest continuously operating Air Force Base in the U.S.), Union Pacific, the energy industry and local, regional and state government agencies. However, increasingly, economic development relies on the appeal offered by the host community and its region and its ability to attract people: from young entrepreneurs pursuing a dream to experienced hands that can have their pick of opportunities.

In short, a healthy downtown Cheyenne does more than connote pride in the “Magic City of the Plains” and reverence for its history. It nurtures the arts, sustains small businesses, boosts property values and provides an incubator for young companies getting a toehold on profitability, all while reducing sprawl and its costs. Most of all, it increases the options that this region offers, providing more choices for people in more life stages, including those that provide markets and create jobs.

Leadership is Essential

Indefatigable and high-caliber leadership is the only non-negotiable ingredient in the path towards a vibrant downtown Cheyenne. Toward fulfilling its promise, Cheyenne is fortunate that many people and organizations stand ready to offer leadership to downtown revitalization in general as well as to specific projects, problems and solutions. At the same time, leadership can originate from unforeseen sources, especially in projects that inspire passion and personal commitment.

Consequently, this plan is organized so that any interested individual or organization can jump into downtown revitalization matters if so moved... and hundreds of potential leaders participated in the development of this plan. At the same time, to ensure that strategies get started, it allocates responsibility among downtown’s private and public-sector organizations and their respective leadership, allotting tasks to entities best suited to lead the partnerships necessary for small- and large-scale success. Both the Downtown Development Authority and the City of Cheyenne will play key roles, but neither can implement this strategic action plan alone. Fortunately, the people who

believe in downtown Cheyenne are legion and help from many players is forthcoming.

Better days for downtown Cheyenne ahead!



Executive Summary

Downtown Cheyenne presents a conundrum. It offers so many of the ingredients shared by communities that radiate a strong sense of place, from its historic structures and walkable streets to its strong employment base as home to Wyoming’s capital. Several property owners are investing in downtown Cheyenne and report strong interest, especially as the region’s economy rises in tandem with world-wide energy demand. And yet, vacant storefronts and struggling businesses affirm the conventional wisdom that downtown Cheyenne has yet to meet its potential.

Over the years, Cheyenne’s leaders have invested in downtown, recognizing that a vibrant central business district nurtures the arts, small businesses, property values and provides an incubator for young companies getting a toehold on profitability while reducing sprawl and its costs. The community – especially downtown property owners – deserves immense credit for establishing the Downtown Development Authority, Cheyenne’s lead organization for enhancing the CBD.

This report sets forth recommendations stemming from a year-long collaboration

between the City, the DDA and over 400 of downtown’s champions and stakeholders to identify strategies to accelerate its recovery. The Historic Placemaking Project emerged from growing interest among community leaders in exploring how downtown Cheyenne can progress, adapting and evolving to fulfill the regions’ needs today and tomorrow.

PLACEMAKING refers to both the process and the activities that together create enjoyable, distinctive communities where authentic environments meet the needs of residents, employers and tourists. The Downtown Historic Placemaking Project strived to support partnerships and implementation from the start, involving hundreds of stakeholders in the quest for effective strategic initiatives. That meant confronting dysfunctional aspects of the system for fostering change downtown. Frustration with most of the organizations working downtown abounded, making normal communications hitches even more salient. Finally, the dialogue between the private sector and downtown’s stewards reflects years of both good will and exasperation, making for productive partnerships punctuated by occasional mutual aggravation.

Fortunately, resources for addressing downtown’s unmet potential include: committed leaders, attentive stakeholders; a full complement of development organizations; definitive legislative authority; and the financial wherewithal to make a difference.

During the Downtown Historic Placemaking process, stakeholders suggested hundreds of ideas for how to deploy these resources in the service of downtown. These ideas were consolidated into 40 strategic initiatives organized in two ways: first, by the logical organization with primary implementation responsibility, and; second, using seven “bucket” issue/action categories describing downtown’ physical plant, business life and future development prospects. The strategies are further distinguished by ease of implementation and impact along with specific steps, budgets, success metrics, and timelines.

The strategies cover about five years of activity and represent investments totaling about \$5.4 million. As inter-related and overlapping factors, all inflict reciprocal effects on downtown Cheyenne. The chart that follows summarizes the strategies. It’s important to note that the

timeline and budget reflect the initial period of intense activity and investment of both human and financial resources. However, many of these initiatives represent ongoing activities that will require continued and persistent work, including periodic assessments and course corrections.

Together, the strategies create an action agenda that requires strong leadership, bold vision and persistent effort. There is plenty to do – not just for this region’s community, tourism and economic development interests and government agencies. The strategies outline significant roles – both as leaders and as partners – for Cheyenne’s arts organizations, educational institutions, property owners, lenders, and more.

In short, everyone has a stake in downtown Cheyenne and can help shape its future. Downtowns succeed when they are true to their communities; implementing these strategies needs to occur while putting Cheyenne’s interest and character first. The result: a downtown Cheyenne that pulses with rhythmic activity, the beating of Wyoming’s and Cheyenne’s emotional and economic heart.

About the Historic Placemaking Project

Across the country, stewards of vibrant downtowns point to historic building stock as a key ingredient in creating places with character. In Cheyenne, however, many of downtown’s historic structures remain vacant or underutilized... their potential unfulfilled. Frustrated public and private sector leaders questioned why economic growth in southeast Wyoming failed to stimulate significant investment downtown. Exasperated citizens, business people and property owners vented about downtown’s woes to elected officials, the newspaper and each other.

The Downtown Historic Placemaking Project emerged from the growing conviction among community leaders that an outside perspective was needed to uncover the root of the problem. Was there something inherently wrong with downtown’s building stock, like small floor plates or inadequate parking? Were the various organizations charged with caring for downtown too feeble – not enough resources, perhaps – to do the job? Or did it have to do with City politics and priorities? Was it the national economic malaise? Could it be Cheyenne’s image as a

rustic frontier town that gave lenders and developers from out of state pause? The theories were many and varied but shared an underlying lament: given all that Cheyenne has going for it, why does downtown struggle when other communities with fewer intrinsic advantages attract investment and prosper?

What is Placemaking?

PLACEMAKING refers to both the process and the activities that together create enjoyable, distinctive communities where authentic environments meet the needs of residents, employers and tourists. PLACEMAKING emphasizes responding to community concerns and creating partnerships for change over the impulse to lay out plans and propose design solutions. PLACEMAKING acknowledges that the cumulative impact of simple efforts can be as effective – and certainly faster and cheaper – than implementing large scale development projects, reasoning that the former will strengthen the market the latter requires. Respectful of market realities and the transformative effect big projects can have, PLACEMAKING also believes that individuals can

make a big difference to downtowns, recruiting independent thinkers, entrepreneurs and urban pioneers to the table. Similarly, PLACEMAKING works from the principle that the quirky aspects of community lend charm and distinctiveness. They should be nurtured and celebrated to inspire devotion among downtown’s numerous constituencies, rather than tamped down in the name of progress. Last, but not least, PLACEMAKING sees community building as an ongoing process that never really ends; change is inevitable, so PLACEMAKING must abide in perpetuity.

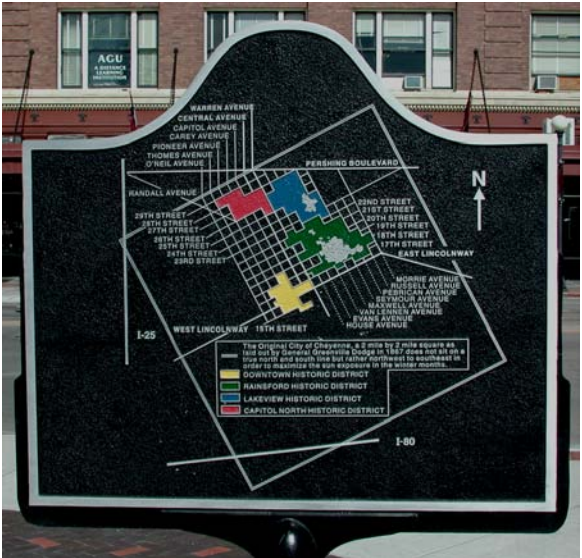
On the Process

The Downtown Historic Placemaking Project strived for a process that supported partnerships and implementation from the start. That means:

- Consulting with stakeholders in meaningful ways, listening to their concerns and ideas and incorporating insights into the work during 107 private meetings and a series of eight public community forums;
- Maintaining momentum and enthusiasm;
- Treating Placemaking as a system and recognizing that all strategies emerging from

- the work will be intertwined, in keeping with how development and redevelopment decisions reflect the interplay between numerous factors encompassing market, regulatory, finance, risk tolerance and other characteristics unique to opportunities in downtown Cheyenne today;
- Ensuring that participants understand other points of view;
 - Seeking to get some projects off the ground as soon as possible;
 - Using available resources efficiently.

The process succeeded in many regards, although the goal of getting projects started proved elusive. Initial optimism gave way to a deeper appreciation of the barriers – economic and organizational – that stymie progress in downtown Cheyenne.



Frustration and Hope in Downtown Cheyenne

Asking about downtown Cheyenne elicits different responses. Mood swings are more the norm: pessimism followed swiftly by assertions of affection for Downtown Cheyenne’s special people and places.

In gloomy or cynical moments, people pointed to lack of progress as evidenced by empty storefronts, vacant buildings, deferred maintenance, absentee owners, litter, snow piles, uneven parking enforcement, cluttered alleys, dirty windows, panhandlers and organizations they deemed wasteful, indifferent or both. In sunnier frames of mind, people took pride in successful past and present redevelopment projects, described their favorite shops, recommended restaurants, urged attendance at area museums, performances and presentations, pointed out examples of architectural excellence, and shared happy memories of concerts, parades and festivals over the years.

The sense that Cheyenne is poised on the precipice of change is striking. “We’re on the cusp,” people agreed, but yet no clear consensus on what should emerge next.

What’s Working Downtown and What Isn’t?

Downtown Cheyenne benefits from a series of assets with potential to accelerate its re-invigoration, including:

- The lovely restoration of the historic Depot, the creation of adjacent Depot Plaza and the varied and interesting programming it supports;
- Successful private sector investments in activity-generating uses, like the Plains Hotel, Suite 1901 and the Boyd Building;
- New rehabilitation investments in historic structures, such as the former Dinneen showroom and Grier furniture building;
- Thriving retail businesses including the Lincolnway “Women’s Block” cluster of home décor and fashion stores and other long-term downtown denizens offering specialty goods, like Wyoming Home and Bohemian Metals;
- Salons, spas and personal care emporia, like , Adora, Epitome, 17 Street Spa, and Noire Cocktail Salon.
- Cultural amenities, from venerable performing arts institutions like Cheyenne Little Theater to creative upstarts like Lights On! and Arts Cheyenne. The Civic Center offers patrons a steady stream of cultural opportunities and downtown also boasts several galleries offering fine arts, like Deselms and the Manitou, as well as the Lincoln popcorn Palace showing first- and second-run movies. Finally, LCCC’s pilot program to offer classes in arts

entrepreneurship at Lights On! in the Hynds Building will bring a welcome influx of young, creative people downtown;

- Museums that reinforce Cheyenne’s Western Heritage, including the Nelson Museum of the West, Cowgirls of the West and the Depot Museum;
- Lodging accommodations to suit different tastes and budgets, including the Plains Hotel and Nagle Warren Mansion;
- Steady sources of daytime market support from approximately 16,400 employees working in downtown for the Cheyenne Regional Medical Center and federal, state and local governments;
- Walkability features including short blocks, traffic calming improvements, wide sidewalks, crosswalks and street furniture;
- Affordable commercial real estate which has made it easier for new enterprises to get started and established ones to prosper. New restaurants opening their doors within the past several years include El Charrito, the Morris House Bistro, Paramount Café, Wipeout Coffee, Mitchell’s BBQ, Re-O-Na Sushi and Thai Restaurant and Anong’s Thai Cuisine. The cluster along 17th Street – Rubyjuice, Sanford’s, Two Doors Down, Pizzeria Venti – continues to thrive. The Freedom’s Edge micro-brewery in the historic Tivoli Building offers another example of a new restaurant type that has found a market niche;
- Similarly there are signs of life in the retail sector, with such new shops as J & W Mercantile, Kat’s Meow, Etcetera Gifts, Good Organic Design and others getting started downtown.

At the same time, however, serious issues beset downtown Cheyenne that reflect market, physical characteristics and the effectiveness of the organizations charged with its care, most notably the Downtown Development Authority and, to a lesser extent, the City of Cheyenne.

Downtown’s Stewards

Both the City of Cheyenne and the Downtown Development Authority are sometimes charged with wasting resources. But beyond that, complaints diverge. Some criticisms leveled at the City stem from a perception – common across almost all municipalities – that bureaucracies automatically translate to:

- Excessive and contradictory permitting requirements combined with an erratic review process;
- Elected and appointed public officials who enjoy annoying private sector business people with costly delays;
- Unreliable and/or inconsistent provision of basic public services, such as street cleaning and snow removal.

We heard opinions on the DDA that could probably be summarized as broad-based concern that the organization’s accomplishments are not in proportion to either its resources or public expectations. DDA should not rest on its laurels following success and must quickly move on to

the next of the myriad challenges facing downtown. DDA shies away from two roles that its counterparts in other communities embrace – facilitating development projects and offering technical assistance. The Downtown Cheyenne Merchants Association, the DDA’s business assistance arm, for example, needs additional technical and financial resources to support downtown merchants per its intended role.

For an organization designed to be nimble (thereby avoiding the bureaucracy inherent in municipalities), stakeholders noted that it takes DDA a surprisingly long time to get things done. DDA has been struggling with the philosophy that its work (other than its grants programs) must benefit all downtown property owners equally, which limits its ability to intervene in a targeted fashion. Instead, they focus most of their project activities (as opposed to their advocacy activities which include supporting specific development initiatives) on marketing the entire district, producing events, promoting the farmers’ market and other activities geared towards increasing exposure for downtown as a whole.

DDA staff and board have stated that they lack the resources or authority to take on catalytic projects—like redeveloping a building - that would advance downtown’s revitalization. At the

same time, they appear to have little interest in more resources or authority. Funds from the successful two-to-one mill levy vote will deliver another \$160,000 annually, which became effective in November 2012. DDA has an opportunity to change its direction.

However, to its credit, DDA is gradually becoming more aggressive. DDA deserves kudos for successfully shepherding the 17th Street Lighting initiative through the Sixth Penny referendum process, which included working with a local developer to install the lights on one demonstration block so voters could better imagine the improvements’ impact. As part of this effort, DDA partnered with Arts Cheyenne to create the first annual ArtsFest, which coincided with RibFest and drew about 2500 people into the heart of downtown, garnering praise from participants and attendees alike.

The relationship between the DDA and the City is uneven: more than a shotgun marriage; less than a partnership. Since the Clean & Safe program requires close coordination between the two and deals with basic aspects of urban life – trash, graffiti, snow, etc. – that inflame downtown denizens, it becomes the nexus for all manner of complaints about both organizations.

- From the City’s perspective, its four devoted staff (five during the summertime) work long hours on thankless tasks, balancing emergency and maintenance functions with the DDA’s special requests. Moreover, there are often special technical considerations that govern how work proceeds that non-professionals fail to appreciate.
- From the DDA’s perspective, the organization’s annual payment of about \$140,000 should afford it more discretion in how Clean & Safe staff spends time. They view Clean & Safe primarily as a means to provide downtown with faster, more comprehensive services and become frustrated when perceived City functions come first.
- From the public’s perspective, when service blunders or delays occur, it’s unclear whether the disconnect lies with DDA, which takes their Clean & Safe service requests, or the City, which executes them. Therefore

the public blame both.

When Clean & Safe critics see City staff on a coffee break or get the answering machine at DDA’s offices, tirades often follow, eroding both organizations’ bases of support. Regardless of whether blaming the DDA or the City for any of these matters is fair; they have become subjects of exasperation, if not infuriation. Addressing each organization’s real and perceived shortcomings – as well as strengthening their partnership – is as much the work of Placemaking as is dealing with physical and market problems affecting Downtown.



Negative attitudes about the DDA and the City carry enough weight and strength to exert downward pressure on the system *regardless of whether they are accurate*. And they are **not** wholly accurate, but it will take demonstrated change to overcome them: they are part of the system that characterizes both the opportunities and challenges that face Cheyenne today.

Tangible Problems Facing Downtown

No other symbol of downtown’s struggles is more potent than the “Hole,” a vacant parcel bound by Lincolnway, the east-facing facades of the Wyoming Home and Pioneer Hotel buildings, and the alley, west of Capitol, which has become the emblem of all failures to overcome market and physical impediments to downtown revitalization. The “Hole” (and its ongoing saga of development hopes raised and then dashed) offers a depressing counter-argument that dampens other public and private sector achievements in the CBD; despite all other progress, the Hole dominates the dialogue about downtown’s future. In truth, the Hole presents a difficult problem without an easy or obvious solution. Moreover, there is no agreement about whether the City should intervene for the good of downtown or whether doing so would step on private development rights and compete with

other investors’ projects. Cracking it will be a home run, but there remains the potential for numerous base hits, bunts and sacrifice flies around downtown that might cumulatively have more impact. Other issues include:

- Extensive vacant ground floor space in buildings located at critical corners, including (but not nearly limited to) the intersections of Central and 17th, Capitol and 17th and Lincolnway and Capitol;
- Substantial vacant upper story and office square footage throughout downtown. Most of it is Class B or C space, leaving would-be Class A tenants few choices;
- Buildings that contribute character to downtown but face practical and financial

- challenges impeding their historic rehabilitation, including the Hynds (some reported asbestos and small demised spaces) and numerous buildings where façade work to remove unfortunate cladding have been made challenging by the methods used to affix them. The blue building below, underneath it all, allegedly resembles its immediate neighbor (with green trim);
- Down-market uses attracted (or sustained) by inexpensive rents that conflict with upscale goals for downtown. The mismatch between, say, patrons interested in a flea market and those eying the furniture at Wyoming Home helps none of the enterprises. In a downtown with fewer vacancies, the diverse offerings and patrons would read as an interesting, eclectic mix, but without the friendly camouflage of

- crowds, everyone feels slightly out of place;
- Underwhelming gateways from both interstates (in spite of very nice median improvements coming from Interstate 25) with marginal businesses, billboards, minimal trees and scruffy parking lots;
- Auto-dominated circulation pattern, most notably caused by downtown’s several federal and state-designated roadways (especially Lincolnway and I-180);
- Enormous intrusive signs for I-180 that are scaled for 70 mph speeds. They are disproportionately large for 30 mph speeds on Lincolnway, Central and Warren;



- A host of minor issues that together convey a sense that downtown is slightly down-at-the-heels. Examples include dirty windows, temporary signs, battered utility boxes, forlorn planters, cracked sidewalks, boarded-up transoms, etc.;
- Absentee owners with little motivation to fix up their properties;
- Vacant lots and outsized parking areas that dwarf nearby buildings, especially on downtown's west side;
- Few housing choices, although well-kept neighborhoods offering a wide range of homes for different space needs and budgets are only a few blocks away;
- A sense among many that downtown is no longer relevant to their daily lives and that the real or perceived burdens of going downtown do not result in an adequate payoff vis-à-vis the shopping or dining experience.



Downtown and Dell Range

Although downtown is convenient to all of greater Cheyenne, so is Dell Range, home of the region’s mass retailers and other uses found in any auto-centric urban environment. As the aerals at right demonstrate, density variations make for very different shopping experiences. Many people find that Dell Range meets most of their retail, dining and entertainment needs; if the character of the two built environments factors into the “where to go” decision, the tradeoffs (parking availability versus historic ambiance) won’t necessarily favor downtown for many busy families.

From a Placemaking perspective, the two activity areas should complement each other; downtown will never offer a warehouse store, nor should it, just as Dell Range would not be an appropriate location for the quirky, eclectic uses that thrive in urban settings. As downtown grows stronger and more distinctive, it will be better able to offer the vibrant urban experience many Cheyennites believe they must travel to Fort Collins or Laramie to enjoy.

Offering both sets of experiences will help make Cheyenne more competitive to people making location-based decisions: where to live, visit, retire, work, etc. Moreover, the strong economic

pull that Cheyenne exerts over communities in rural Wyoming, northern Colorado and western Nebraska will only be strengthened by making downtown better. If Cheyenne can increase its appeal by improving downtown, yields (in terms of economic activity) should improve as:

- businesses enjoy better sales;
- visitors stay longer and spend more;
- property values rise;
- tax receipts improve;
- further investment becomes financially feasible.

Statutory Mandates

Enabling legislation creating the Downtown Development Authority (see Appendix A) stipulates that the organization:

- “...will promote the health, safety, prosperity, security and general welfare of the... people of this state,
- will halt or prevent deterioration of property values or structures within central business districts,
- will halt or prevent the growth of blighted areas within such districts, and
- will assist municipalities in the development and redevelopment of such districts...”

This broad mandate clearly allows DDA to intervene in deteriorated structures and



stipulates working with the City. Moreover, the legislation goes on to note that “because of a number of atypical factors and special conditions concerning downtown development unique to each locality, the rule of strict construction shall have no application to this article, but it shall be liberally construed.”

That’s excellent news for downtown Cheyenne. It recognizes DDA’s inherent need for flexibility and to act in ways that respond to local circumstances. Moreover, the legislation specifically allows intervention directed toward a single structure or property. It goes on to describe valid targets for intervention as any matter that “substantially impairs or arrests the sound growth of the central business district, retards the provision of housing accommodations, or constitutes an economic or social liability....” Suggested activities include:

- “(A) The planning or management of development or improvement activities;
- (B) Landscaping or other maintenance of public areas;
- (C) Promotion of public events;
- (D) Activities in support of business recruitment and development;
- (E) Any other economic improvement activity for which an assessment may be

made on property specially benefited thereby. “

Later, the legislation allows DDA to act in matters concerning private property, specifying that the Board can “[p]lan and propose, within the downtown development area, plans of development for public facilities and other improvements to public or private property of all kinds, including removal, site preparation, renovation, repair, remodeling, reconstruction or other changes in existing buildings which may be necessary or appropriate to the execution of any development plan which in the opinion of the board will aid and improve the downtown development area.” DDA is also allowed to either lease or sell space it acquires.

The legislation also confers DDA with authority to issue bonds to pay for improvements, with repayment stemming from project-driven revenues. However, this tool will not always make sense; only property tax and sales tax revenues generated within the planning area, in excess of that collected during the base year, can go to bond/debt repayment. The City sets the interest rate in its companion ordinance establishing DDA, so there is some potential flexibility in this regard. But clearly, the increment won’t always generate sufficient property and sales tax revenues to repay a bond

of adequate size relative to likely costs. Should DDA bond for improvements, the legislation stipulates that the City would manage the entire process including repayment. Each potential deal would have to be thoroughly evaluated on its own merits. Additional research is needed to determine how bonding might be used to leverage DDA’s funding sources. Much discussion has taken place on whether bonding is a viable option, but no definitive answer is forthcoming. Bonding would provide DDA with an option to underwrite significantly larger projects than can be accomplished under their yearly budget. Potentially, this could make a greater overall impact on downtown by playing a more significant financial role in overcoming some of the more costly obstacles currently frustrating redevelopment efforts.

Setting aside the bonding question, the enabling legislation imposes no restrictions on DDA’s ability to purchase, improve, lease or sell property and encourages it to act aggressively to support business recruitment and development. That means DDA is free to increase its impact on downtown Cheyenne if it can muster the determination and capacity to do so.

Current Resources

Resources for Placemaking encompass the financial capacity and expertise that can be brought to bear on downtown by the DDA and its partners. DDA’s budget fluctuates between about \$550,000 and \$750,000 annually due to tax increment financing (sales tax provided by the City) and the Property Tax Mill Levy, which went into effect in 2012.

In addition to the City of Cheyenne and Laramie County, DDA partners with (among others):

- **Cheyenne-Laramie County Corporation for Economic Development (Cheyenne LEADS)** – a private, not-for-profit economic development organization serving as the economic development entity for the City of Cheyenne and Laramie County;
- **Greater Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce** – devoted to advancing the prosperity of the community by being the voice of business;
- **Visit Cheyenne** – initiates programs to sustain Cheyenne’s brand identity and tourism economy, thereby benefiting visitors and locals alike.

If DDA expands its purview, it might also make sense for it to work with:

- **Cheyenne Housing and Community Development Office**, which administers Community Development Block Grant funds and is the legal basis for using CDBG funds;

- **Cheyenne Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO)**, which facilitates transportation improvements that affect local and state jurisdictions. The MPO is presently updating PlanCheyenne, the region’s common plan which addresses downtown as a critical activity center;
- **Cheyenne Transit Program**, which promotes self-sufficiency by providing safe, reliable transportation. CTP operates a transfer station downtown.

It is also easy to envision fruitful partnerships between DDA and numerous other area organizations that have already expressed an interest in working together on downtown’s behalf, including:

- **Cheyenne Housing Authority** – CHA helps provide decent, safe and sanitary housing to the elderly, disabled and economically disadvantaged families unable to find housing in the conventional market. CHA also coordinates the Senior Center for Laramie County and sponsors the Retired and Senior Volunteer Program;
- **University of Wyoming** – The university works directly with communities, providing research, education and outreach opportunities benefiting communities and businesses statewide;
- **Laramie County Community College** – LCCC is a full-service, comprehensive college with Cheyenne and Laramie campuses and outreach centers at F.E. Warren Air Force Base and in Pine Bluffs. LCCC offers 80 degree programs and a range of academic, career/technical and community education opportunities;

- **Laramie County Community Partnership** – a coalition of over 65 organizations that share resources, strengthen capacities and collaboratively serve the area’s most vulnerable residents, especially troubled youth and families with a multi-generational history of poverty. LCCP’s initiatives address issues ranging from housing to health to transportation;
- **Cheyenne Regional Medical Center** – Since 1867, a major downtown hospital has served the health needs of the region, benchmarking key health indicators and measuring progress toward a healthier Laramie County;
- **Habitat for Humanity** – Eliminating poverty housing by building homes for those in need;
- **Laramie County Library System** – is the community’s focal point for lifelong learning, fostering dynamic intellectual adventure;
- **Laramie County School District #1** – provides high quality education for Cheyenne area students. LCSD #1 inspires lifelong learners to become responsible, productive citizens;
- **State Historic Preservation Office** – promotes Wyoming’s heritage to ensure a prosperous future that respects our past;
- **United Way of Laramie County** – “No one in need” is the vision. The United Way builds partnerships that can demonstrate measurable success in impacting our community;
- **Wyoming Business Council** – operates Wyoming’s Main Street program;
- **Cheyenne-Laramie County Health Department** – preserves and enhances the

health of Laramie County’s citizens. It reviews all land use plans for air and water impacts and issues temporary food sale permits;

- **Wyoming Department of Health** – Promotes, protects and enhances the health of Wyoming’s citizens.

Helpful partners are available to DDA if it devotes itself to identifying mutually-beneficial projects and being a reliable collaborator.

Future Resources

DDA joined Wyoming’s Main Street program in March 2013. Eight other municipalities participate as full program members in Wyoming Main Street: Buffalo; Dubois; Evanston; Green River; Laramie; Rawlins; Rock Springs; Sheridan. Another seven downtowns are program affiliates.

The Main Street Program, originated by the National Trust for Historic Preservation, consists of a preservation-based economic development approach to revitalizing downtown and neighborhood business districts. It emphasizes building on local assets, from historic, cultural and architectural resources to local enterprises and community pride. The approach has been codified in what has become known as the eight principals and the four point approach – organization, promotion, design and economic restructuring.

It is not necessary to be a Main Street community to succeed in downtown revitalization. However, the program offers a structured approach, accountability and the ability to tap into the experiences of 2,000 peer communities. DDA’s decision to join the program deserves applause, for it attests to the organization’s willingness to learn from experience elsewhere and improve its approach to downtown revitalization.

Tending the Web – Downtown as a System

Efforts to make sense of the economic events that crested in September, 2008 – and the ensuing recession – have enhanced the public’s understanding of how today’s economy operates: it is a system.

From personal experience, people appreciate that an interconnected web of organizations, relationships and actions can affect the well-being of individuals, enterprises and communities located both across town and around the world. More than ever before, citizens recognize that the economic ingredients affecting downtown Cheyenne’s health – demographics, incomes, housing values, public budgets, credit availability, unemployment rates, tax incentives and debt – are all inter-connected; plucking one strand of this web creates distant vibrations. Even the machinations surrounding the redevelopment of

the Hole – let alone the dynamics of the current energy plays – provide an object lesson in Cheyenne’s links to national and global economies.

That, in turn, means tending the web connecting downtown Cheyenne’s economic actors and actions. With stakeholders realizing that simple linear relationships fail to explain what they’ve experienced as homeowners and workers, the time is ripe to incorporate a systems approach to develop sustainable partnerships and revitalize its downtown.

Downtown in Context

It’s easy to lose sight of the fact that downtown Cheyenne exists within the broader context of the region and the state. As the capital city – with the Capitol itself, the state museum and numerous places symbolic of the Equality State – downtown Cheyenne belongs to all of Wyoming’s citizens. People from around the state hold a place in their heart for downtown Cheyenne and rightly feel a certain proprietary interest in its future. Those emotions, as well as people’s perceptions about downtown Cheyenne’s positive and negative associations as well as its built environment, contributes to the experience of place.

Ensuring that downtown Cheyenne retains an authentic sense of place entails a constant sensitivity to the needs of its many stakeholders, be they people, organizations or historic buildings. Downtown’s stewards need to advocate for activities that reflect Cheyenne

community values and distinctive characteristics, working to learn from, but not replicate, the experience in other places. Downtowns succeed when they are true to their communities; people experience both the comfort of the familiar and the excitement of new discoveries that await

them. The result: a downtown Cheyenne that pulses with rhythmic activity, the beating of Wyoming’s and Cheyenne’s emotional and economic heart.



How to Use This Document

Over the course of the Downtown Historic Placemaking project, over 400 people attended 107 meetings and eight public work-sessions, offering hundreds of excellent suggestions about how to think about and respond to the issues affecting Cheyenne’s central business district. Many of the comments could be categorized multiple ways, underscoring the notion that downtown Cheyenne functions as a system and, as such, will require intervention that:

- Targets interconnections – overlaps and leverage points – between elements to shape system behaviors;
- Identifies early actions and builds feedback loops to generate momentum for positive change;
- Builds capacity to evaluate which strategies may be accomplished by volunteers and which are better suited for established organizations. Leadership and stakeholders alike must determine the match between strategies and lead organizations and partnerships.
- Increases system resilience;
- Creates synergies between elements, including via partnerships;
- Builds flexibility into implementation.

Introducing the Seven Buckets

The “things to do” suggestions made by downtown stakeholders became the impetus for organizing seven different categories of intervention, colloquially referred to as the “Seven Buckets.”

The following pages set forth the seven issue/action categories shown at right. However, as inter-related and overlapping issues, all inflict reciprocal effects on downtown Cheyenne.

The buckets frame these matters of concern to local stakeholders as an action agenda. It’s worth noting that stakeholder reaction to the seven buckets featured one common and constant general idea: the yearning for strong leadership, bold vision and persistent effort.



Make Downtown Sparkle

For busy business owners, minor maintenance matters – chipped paint, grubby windows, loose hinges, etc. – recede into invisibility with daily exposure. For visitors, however, affected buildings, businesses and blocks seem scruffy and unloved... and unworthy of patronage.



Essentials • Low rents and high vacancy rates lie at the root of the problem, but owners that address maintenance issues improve their competitiveness by attracting more tenants and traffic. • New sources of space demand are needed to promote downtown’s real estate market out of the cycle of decline; with supply exceeding demand, values and rents fall. Properties with little market value deteriorate as owners see little economic benefit to rehabilitating (or even maintaining) them. • Façade improvement programs are great for owners, but tenants can’t access them without landlord cooperation.	Stakeholder Insights • Can youth who need community service credits help out? Work release inmates? • Fresh paint and attention to windows is needed at many locations all over downtown. • Don’t forget awnings and curtains in upper story windows! (Recent action at the Atlas Theater is a great example.) • What’s with the solid doors and dark windows on the ground floors of some buildings? • We could use more landscaping. • Can we put art in empty storefronts? • Community-wide clean-up days?
Implications • Since the reasons underpinning postponed maintenance – money, time, skills, authority, procrastination, etc. – are as varied as the issues, a respectful and tailored approach to building owners is key. • Making downtown sparkle takes action by numerous players – owners, tenants, the City – and thus makes it tough to coordinate. • Deferred upkeep often reflects landlord-tenant disputes playing out as stubborn “principled” behavior that harms everyone. By pressing property rights buttons, clumsy requests that an owner address appearance issues can also do more harm than good. • Maintenance improves value, giving lenders an interest too.	

Enhance the Public Realm

The public realm makes major contributions to downtown Cheyenne’s character and appeal as a place to live, work and visit. Moreover, downtown’s quality contributes to Cheyenne’s competitiveness for economic development. It also fosters community – and statewide – pride.



Essentials • Downtown Cheyenne’s streetscape and pedestrian precincts are the junction between private property and surrounding public space. Both – together – are the foundations of community character. • Materials, signage, public art, fountains, curbs, historic plaques, banners, murals, street furniture, newspaper boxes, trash cans, flower urns, traffic signals, curbs, sidewalks, storm drains, alleys, utility poles/boxes, crosswalks, parks, manhole covers, Depot Plaza, bike racks, curb cuts, bollards, fences, fireplugs, call boxes, line paint: the tips of a very big iceberg. • Key nexus: sidewalk cafes, sandwich signs and other overlap.	Stakeholder Insights • Start a dialogue between the City, Laramie County and the state on joint planning. • Don’t forget the hospital! • Lighting is inconsistent and could be improved. A downtown-wide scheme should be developed. It’s too harsh here (private parking); under-lit there (public parking). Let’s make it consistent. • Uneven code enforcement is legend – or maybe “urban legend.” Let’s look into it. Let’s not impede development. • More trees! • Fix the curbs! • Promote free parking. • Ban one-way streets. • Remember cyclists and pedestrians!
Implications • Plans and standards (e.g., for wayfinding) already exist. • Incremental implementation is inevitable... and fine. • City, county, state and federal buildings are also a part of the public realm. • Regulations governing sidewalk cafes, festivals, public markets, concerts, races, and other joint uses of public space need to be reviewed and/or developed with participation by all affected entities.	

Recruit Businesses Downtown

Recruiting new businesses to downtown Cheyenne requires – and then creates – market strength. Placemaking participants provided over 100 ideas for new businesses, some of which are listed below under Insights.



Essentials - Shopping malls offer a facile analogy for downtown that falls apart under scrutiny as overly simplistic. - Business recruitment entails addressing market demand issues, character and physical appeal. - There are many relatively simple tools that can be deployed at a reasonable cost. - Business recruitment isn't just about resident- and visitor-serving retail, restaurant and entertainment uses. Cheyenne's relatively large daytime population is also important.	Stakeholder Insights We need: - Restaurants/clubs - Movie theatres - Boutiques - Arcade - Children's museum - Health club - Drug store - Grocery/gourmet market - Target-style small department store - Day care center - Residential choices - Brewery - Bakery - Kite shop - Ice cream shop - Bike shop "Fulfill your retail dreams here!" - Start-up funds - Partnerships
Implications - No one entity can do it alone! Business recruitment takes coordinated action by current merchants, service providers, owners, property owners, bankers, realtors, government, community development interests, etc. It's a team approach! - A balance between newly-hatched enterprises and veteran local, regional and national players will create the blend of unique shops and complimentary uses that make downtown thrive. - Downtown Cheyenne can draw attention to market characteristics that may have been overlooked by companies focused on the Dell Range retail area. - Some enterprises – both tenants and property owners – may need (or want) to be relocated into the downtown as it improves.	

Help Business Succeed

It takes so many skills to make a new retail store or restaurant successful – merchandising, marketing, accounting, tax preparation, management, hiring, just to name a few – that it's no wonder so many fail. Skills, training and an outside perspective can make the difference.



Essentials - Downtown is home to numerous retailers and restauranteurs that are doing quite well, but others are obviously troubled and/or depend on low-cost rents to survive. - Some struggling businesses need technical assistance on matters ranging from merchandising to bookkeeping. - All would benefit from sharing data, marketing together and coordinating sales, business hours, working with festivals, etc. - Downtown already features clusters of successful businesses benefiting from agglomeration, including the 17th Street restaurants and Lincolnway's interior design shops.	Stakeholder Insights - What about rewarding best practices (for example, outstanding windows, facades, etc.) - Could DDA or LCCC distribute "how to" info sheets covering business basics? - Could successful merchants lead sessions on how they did it? - Dog-friendly stores boost sales. - Hospitality and customer service training is needed. - Ask kids and teens what they want! - Could DCMA be revived through a series of "helping" strategies?
Implications - The work is perpetual. All types of small businesses – not just retailers – could use technical assistance. - Since the reasons underpinning low- or no-profit operations – money, time, skills, authority, procrastination, etc. – are as varied as the issues, a respectful and tailored approach is vital - Resources exist through LCCC, the Chamber, University of Wyoming, etc., that could help shopkeepers improve their operations. - Building upon existing and creating new retail clusters is key. - Since most businesses fail, disappointments are inevitable. That, however, isn't a justification for abandoning the effort.	

Rehabilitate Historic Structures

Without question, well-tended historic structures lend character and appeal to the downtown Cheyenne experience. At the same time, down-at-the heels buildings and structures with unfortunate cladding – obscuring original facades – detract from the downtown district’s charm.



Essentials	Stakeholder Insights
- As rehab projects often incur unexpected costs, confidence in the market – and future income streams – must be especially strong. - Years of disinvestment makes rehabilitation more difficult. - No state income tax means no Wyoming equivalent to match the federal historic rehabilitation tax credit. - Rehabbing historic structures is inherently green, thanks to the embodied carbon and reduced requirement for new materials. - Historic rehabilitation can be more expensive per square foot than new construction but must still be profitable to attract developer interest.	- How to connect property owners with existing resources – for example, façade improvement programs – so they can help themselves? - So many buildings, like the Elks Lodge, were beautiful. Can we restore them? - Can local banks create a pool of funds for historic rehabilitation?
Implications	- We need design standards and/or guidelines to avoid unfortunate decisions in the future. - Downtown buildings look pretty similar and are of a limited design vocabulary. Can we make them look more different while still having a unified theme? A “new West” aesthetic – as well as a traditional “western” brand?

Catalyze New Development

Some uses that would enhance downtown and attract new markets don’t lend themselves very well to the adaptive reuse of existing structures. Meanwhile under-developed or vacant sites downtown detract from the overall experience and contribute nothing to a “sense of place”.



Essentials	Stakeholder Insights
- With the notable exception of the “Hole” and some vacant parcels on 15th Street, there are limited opportunities for new development in the downtown core that aren’t already devoted to surface parking and/or home to existing businesses. - Downtown’s major development opportunities are west of Thomes Avenue, underscoring the need for east-west links. - More housing choices downtown will go a long way toward generating market support for retail and restaurants while increasing downtown’s attractiveness as an office location.	What about: - High-end lofts and condos? - Senior housing? - Upscale lodging? - A music venue? - A grocery store?
Implications	- Office supply store and other large format uses? - Improving the Lincoln and Atlas theaters so both bring more people downtown? - Treating the greenway as an amenity? - Developing a satellite LCCC campus? - Finding a site for the recreation center and other 6th penny projects?

Attract Diverse Markets

Shifting attitudes about downtown (and drawing more patrons) isn't just a marketing matter. Building reasons to come downtown for essentials, for work, and for fun – and to go house-hunting – will build a range of businesses, and create a virtuous circle.



Essentials

- Brand identity is more than slogans and graphics.
- Downtown Cheyenne belongs to all of Wyoming and can capture the same markets attracted by Dell Range – in more local formats.
- Adding new offerings, reducing vacancies and keeping downtown's public realm and historic structures in top shape, creating an inviting, safe atmosphere will go a long way toward attracting new markets.
- Downtown's existing 16,400-member work force is a direct path to wider audiences.
- Today's tourist is tomorrow's business owner or resident.

Implications

- Occasional panhandlers and the homeless quash trade; how to help them? Strip clubs, SROs and pawn shops connote despair but have a market. Where should they be?
- Downtown needs to understand the market as it exists today, not just as it might be if all hopes and dreams come true.
- Understanding downtown assets – people, businesses, buildings, heritage, institutions, etc. – is also key to building a cadre of champions and leaders for downtown.
- Building brand identity means tapping into the authentic character of downtown Cheyenne.
- You can't manage what you can't measure; metrics work.

Stakeholder Insights

- Melodrama has a social component.
- Need more/different music on Depot Plaza geared towards new audiences.
- Link everything to Cheyenne's brand identity.

Potential Targets:

- Youth
- Seniors
- Hospital workers
- State of Wyoming employees
- Young professionals
- Foodies (who seek ethnic restaurants and will patronize more of them).
- Kids, perhaps via a playground, or playgrounds?
- Heritage tourists (How could we leverage the several museums better?)



Guide to the Strategies

The following pages set forth 40 strategies associated with the “seven buckets” and developed in consultation with downtown stakeholders. Each is presented as a stand-alone task, although they certainly reinforce one another. The strategies are organized according to the lead agency in charge of implementation: the DDA, the City, the Historic Preservation Board and others. As shown in the diagram at right, each strategy includes:

- A designated lead partner;
- An explanation of why the strategy is needed;
- Notes with useful supplementary information;
- Specific tasks inherent in implementation;
- A budget, timeline and metrics for success.

The next page summarizes all strategies and their respective implementation timeframes. It’s important to note that the timelines and budgets reflect an initial period of intense activity and investment of both human and financial resources. However, many of these initiatives represent ongoing activities that will require continued and persistent work, including periodic assessments and course corrections. Since the Historic Placemaking project strategies will span five to seven years, the need to revise them to

respond to future circumstances – both opportunities and challenges – is not only inevitable but essential. Just as architectural blueprints do not specify paint colors, the strategies await fine-tuning by downtown stakeholders to ensure that implementation will always be uniquely Cheyenne.



The Need section describes the precipitating issue.

The Remedy section details the specific strategy.

Experience from other places tackling similar issues.

Implement a Façade Easement Program			Project Leader: City Logical Partners: DDA, CHPB, SHPO, WBC and Property Owners		
Moderately Difficult CITY 28 Need At least a dozen buildings in downtown Cheyenne may have been clad with inappropriate siding, potentially obscuring interesting historic façades behind aluminum or plaster. It's time to investigate. Disrobe these structures, refurbish the exteriors and return elevations as fully-contributing members to downtown's streetscape – and the National Register district—with the protection they need and deserve. Remedy Cheyenne's Historic Preservation Board and DDA must partner and list historic buildings that may be hiding behind false fronts. There are candidates along Lincolnway, 17 th , 18 th and elsewhere. Several may make good case studies. The best buildings may be vacant and/or have absentee owners. • Expand DDA's Capital Improvement Grant Program (CIG) to include façades and façade easement work. • Propose an 18-month program to Wyoming Business Council (WBC) to leverage DDA funding: ◦ Assume \$250,000 for ten façade grants. ◦ Require recipients to absorb cost over runs – up to \$75,000. Administer rehab via DDA, CHPB, DDA, Main Street – any nonprofit. • Deed the completed façade to the nonprofit as a permanent easement. ◦ Use the federal income tax credit as a benefit for the original owners – possibly up to \$20,000 per building and façade. Require that all work be completed within 18 months. • Make grants based on CHPB, DDA and SHPO recommendations and encourage building owners to consider full-building rehab. Notes There are many successful façade improvement and easement programs but combining the two is a novel approach (Rawlins is investigating). CHPB, DDA and its partners can use existing resources to get started.	Specific Tasks 1 Research easement precedents nationally and locally. Modify DDA's CIG grant program to allow façade work and easements to be held by DDA or other non-profits. 2 As a team, approach the Wyoming Business Council to leverage DDA's CIG funds. Follow up with the Legislature if necessary. 3 Prioritize façades that may be hiding something, e.g., by researching old photos 4 Contact owners. If they agree... Drill test holes. Peek inside false fronts and determine salvage potential. At the same time, use a walk-through to examine structural condition, adaptive reuse potential, etc. Determine if the project makes financial sense – both outside and inside? If yes... 5 Draw up a contract with the owner. Encourage the owner to consider full-building rehabilitation. Proceed. 6 Complete the work. Illuminate the façades. 7 Use the proposed tenant recruitment programs to populate the finished project (Strategies 11 - 14). Monitor results in spin-off projects in adjacent buildings and blocks. Develop a return-on-investment formula. 8 Move to the next façade. Expand the program in downtown Cheyenne and to Wyoming's Main Street communities.	Responsible Parties 1 CHPB and DDA: Originate the program. Promote it. Recruit and maintain partners. 2 Partners: Assist in historic research, prioritization, WBC application, lobbying, working with owners and contractors, engineers, architects, potential tenants, etc. 3 Owners: Dare to be the first to donate a façade easement. Enjoy the tax credit.	Time Allowance 1 Revise DDA grant program over two months. Select target buildings in one month. 2 Discuss issues with partners in one month. 3 Draft WBC grant application according to pre-determined schedule. Achieve funding in six months. 4 Select target façades over one month. 5 Negotiate with owners over one month. 6 Complete the first façade within six months.	Success Metric 1 Approval by DDA's board to expand the CIG grant program. 2 Successful joint application to WBC. 3 Number of façade improvements and easements donated via DDA and WBC funding. 4 Owner participation. 5 Expansion of the program – statewide and with more dollars.	Budget Allowance 1 Treat all background research, partner negotiation, etc., as volunteer or paid staff time dedicated to the program = 0. 2 Allot staff time over 60 days @ \$225/day = \$13,500. 3 Produce promo materials @ \$5,000. 4 Prepare legal documents (easements, etc.) @ \$15,000. 5 Peek inside of ten façades @ \$3,000/façade = \$30,000. 6 Implement on ten façades @ \$25,000 per façade = \$250,000. 7 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$31,350.
Next Steps/Future Implications: Like the synthetic tax credit for whole-building rehab (Strategy 35), this strategy creates permanent value for building owners, DDA and CHPB.			Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$344,850, all inclusive.

Symbol denoting “bucket” strategy group

Costs associated with key work tasks.

Total cost excluding operations impacts.

Opportunities or cautions suggested by the

Total elapsed time.

Downtown Placemaking Strategies

Draft Date: 6/2013
Total Strategies: 40

[illegible]



Together, the 41 strategies create an action agenda that requires strong leadership, bold vision and persistent effort. They also create a means to

evaluate whether downtown Cheyenne's stewards succeed in fulfilling their missions and meeting stakeholders' objectives.

There is plenty to do, and not just for this region's community, tourism and economic development interests and government agencies. The strategies outline significant roles – both as leaders and as partners – for Cheyenne's arts organizations, educational institutions, property owners, lenders and more. Stakeholders should use this plan as a vehicle to get involved in creating the downtown Cheyenne we all expect and deserve.

In short, everyone has a stake in downtown Cheyenne and can help shape its future.

Giddy up!

Historic Placemaking Strategies



Historic Placemaking Strategies

Downtown Development Authority

Lead Organization for Implementation





Deploy Bucket Brigades for Cheyenne Frontier Days

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: DCMA, Visit Cheyenne, the Chamber, CFD



Need

Downtown buzzes with Cheyenne Frontier Days volunteers and staff in the weeks building up to CFD. City agencies lend a hand; merchants and property owners decorate storefronts; banners, flags and bunting lend a festive air to downtown’s streetscape. When CFD arrives, throngs of people gather around Depot Plaza. Country music fills the air. Good food and cheer abound. This is what downtown should be all the time.

CFD draws major attention to downtown Cheyenne. In return, downtown’s stakeholders should thank these volunteers and their organization. What if a new cadre of volunteers representing downtown merchants and office workers pitched in to help? Yes, many of them already participate, but not specifically as downtown stakeholders. Perhaps it’s time to organize a “thank you, CFD” campaign.

Remedy

It’s time for DDA and DCMA to challenge its members and supporters by adding five percent more helping hands to CFD’s 2500-member volunteers corps – that’s 125 extra people. DDA’s additional crew might help CFD string flags and decorations or tidy up Depot Plaza and the Carey, Lincolnway, Central, 18th and Capitol parade route. Sidewalks and curbs will be swept – every day. Debris will be cleared – in coordination with Clean & Safe and the work/release participants (Strategy 16). A few DDA teams may be raffled to private property owners for window washing and limited paint-up, fix-up tasks on façades – with assistance from work/release members. DCMA-member restaurants might offer cut-rate refreshments and meals to anyone identified with CFD or DDA; merchants could offer other discounts. There are two goals: say “thank you, CFD”; engage in the first round of regular bucket brigade deployments.

Notes

CFD is a major economic and social force in Cheyenne. It’s time to thank them and officially lend a hand.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Discuss the possibilities with CFD management: how could they use 125 more volunteers, when and where? What’s beneficial both for CFD and downtown Cheyenne?
- 2 Develop a quota system, e.g., for every five employees, DDA members should enlist at least one volunteer. Let businesses know what’s expected of them.
- 3 Publicize the idea and create media buzz.
- 4 Set a start date for the first CFD Bucket Brigades.
- 5 Make firm commitments and enlist the volunteers.
- 6 Outfit DDA’s volunteers with colorful vests.
- 7 Thank volunteers with Boots Bucks and/or Positively Cheyenne coupons.
- 8 Start planning for the 118th CFD in 2014 and, most especially, CFD’s 121st staging (which coincides with Cheyenne’s 150th birthday in 2017 (Strategy 41).

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA: Initiate, develop, manage and maintain the bucket brigade. Plan additional Bucket Brigade days throughout the year.
- 2 DCMA: Get into the act. Offer discounts to Bucket Brigade volunteers.
- 3 Visit Cheyenne and the Chamber: Incorporate volunteers into DDA’s teams.

Time Allowance

- 1 Think, plan and act in one week.
- 2 Attract volunteers in four weeks.
- 3 Recruit DCMA members in two weeks.
- 4 Monitor over the first year... and every year thereafter.

Success Metric

- 1 Productive ideas on this and additional DDA and CFD partnerships.
- 2 Number of DDA volunteers enlisted.
- 3 Additional Bucket Brigade activities.
- 4 Mutual satisfaction.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Allow 35 staff days @ \$250/day = \$8,750.
- 2 Buy Bucket Brigade supplies = \$3,000.
- 3 Design and buy vests = \$250.
- 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,200.

Next Steps/Future Implications: A new Cheyenne tradition begins in July, 2013... the first annual CFD appreciation days, sponsored by DDA and DCMA. There’s potential for many more mutually-beneficial partnerships between DDA/DCMA and Cheyenne Frontier Days.

Total Time:
Eight weeks.



Budget:
\$13,200.

Decorate Downtown’s Vacant Storefront Windows		Project Leader: DDA Logical Partners: Arts Cheyenne, Lights On!, Building Owners			
Need A quick way to gauge the health of any downtown? Count the vacant stores and empty windows. The national Main Street program was founded 30 years ago to rehabilitate buildings and façades, fill stores and repopulate the nation’s downtowns. It became both popular and successful. As Cheyenne prepares to join Wyoming Main Street, it can work on enhancing downtown’s visual appeal. How many vacant storefront windows can be given new – albeit temporary – life? How many local artists can be exposed to broader audiences? Unused and unloved vacant storefront windows can be found on almost any downtown block. It’s time to get busy. Remedy DDA can broker relationships between property owners with vacant storefronts and Cheyenne’s vibrant arts community. Successful negotiations between landlord and artist– and an initial spur-of-the-moment attempt was <i>almost</i> successful in late 2011 – will give downtown one less blemish and one more source of pride... and the artists just might make some sales. LightsOn! demonstrated this idea on the ground floor of the Hynds Building. Other owners with vacant ground floor storefronts may be willing to work with DDA to negotiate use of their space by – among others – Arts Cheyenne, Lights On!, LCCC, Laramie County Library, school groups, Camera Club, Intertribal Association, Heritage Quilters, Cheyenne Artists’ Guild, CFD – even the Cheyenne Botanic Garden. A compelling, short-term window display may spark interest in a permanent use. Lease or sale of the building may follow. The art can be moved to the next available storefront. Notes Art in vacant storefronts has been used by dozens of communities nationwide. Downtowns that started the trend years ago are almost all success stories: Main Street communities with fully fully-tenanted stores. And the artists? They often open fill storefronts as artists’ co-ops (Strategy 38) or foster more downtown galleries.	Specific Tasks 1 Convene a DDA-headed arts task force and discuss the idea. If there is interest... 2 Prioritize a list of vacant storefront windows: corners are desirable; established pedestrian traffic is more desirable; a motivated, Cheyenne-based building owner is most desirable. 3 Contact the owner to determine interest in and terms of window use. If the answer is yes... 4 Arrange a walk-through with the owner and artists. Discuss the basics: cost (if any); timelines; window washing (inside and out); lighting (and other electrical supply); liability insurance; heat (if needed); points of contact (this should be DDA’s role); access to keys, etc. 5 Draw up a sample “contract” and sign it. Keep the contract very simple and use as a template for the next installation. 6 Hold opening receptions on sidewalks. Aim for five events well-before the end of the year – or hold five simultaneous events across downtown. 7 Keep records of how long it takes to permanently rent storefronts to new merchants. 8 Declare one small victory and move to the next vacant storefront and community partner group.	Responsible Parties 1 DDA: Originate, manage and expand the program. Promote it. Recruit artists and other types of colorful displays – even by adjacent merchants. Convene meetings between artists and targeted building owners. Plan a grand opening for five storefronts. 2 Arts groups and artists: Select the best-of-the-best. Think of themed shows and seasonal displays. Change the art works often. 3 Building owners: Motivate owners through contacts made through the Cheyenne Board of Realtors.	Time Allowance 1 Talk to artists and arts groups over one week. 2 Discuss issues with building owners in one week. 3 Schedule one week per storefront for each of five installations before CFD 2013.	Success Metric 1 Number of storefronts filled with good, local art. Aim for five before CFD 2013. 2 Media attention. 3 Artwork sales. 4 Sale or lease of the building. 5 Unsolicited calls to DDA, initiated by owners and artists who want to participate.	Budget Allowance 1 Allot 30 days @ \$225/day = \$6,750. 2 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$675.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: It’s reasonable to think that filling vacant storefronts with good local art could spark some keen competition for locations and featured artists. Perhaps there will be new partnerships to coordinate activities.			Total Time: Eight weeks.	



Illuminate Downtown’s Building Features and Trees

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: City, CLF&P, Vendors, Building Owners



Need

About half the year, Cheyenne’s mornings arrive late and evenings come early. Although Wyoming’s nighttime sky is wonderfully dark, the winter months can be a bit dreary. The City’s tall cobra head street lights provide good street-level illumination, but do little to introduce any sparkle into downtown’s landscape.

Clever nighttime lighting of historic structures and notable landscape features has enlivened many urban settings, from Rockefeller Center and the Empire State Building (both use the “bathe” option) to all of downtown Asheville, North Carolina and Main Street in Livingston, Texas (the “silhouette” option). Another option is to highlight downtown’s landscape. Although maintenance strategies vary, the Downtown Business Association in Ft. Collins pays \$65,000 annually to light and maintain electric “twinkle” bulbs in downtown trees.

Remedy

The DDA should partner with CLF&P in a program to illuminate downtown’s historic fabric and call attention to notable landscapes – including all of Depot Plaza and Wyoming’s State Capitol and grounds. A few options:

- Install about 6,000 linear feet of solar-powered silhouette lights (six inches apart) on top-most cornices of The Plains, Majestic, Hynds, Pioneer Block (Wrangler) and UP Depot. Next step: add silhouette lights on “Expanded Downtown” Historic District buildings and along Capitol Avenue – about \$25,000.
- Bathe the facades of listed historic structures with soft, solar-powered up-lights. Change the colors by day or season. Select special colors for buildings that have been honored by Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board’s Dubois Award – about \$50,000.
- Accent each refurbished planter – close to \$10,000.

Notes

Downtown could use some sparkle and this approach is a simple, inexpensive and quick remedy. Downtown Cheyenne features enough interesting historic architecture to take advantage of this approach.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Determine a method to select consistent lighting themes through consultation with building owners, DCMA and stakeholders: “silhouette,” “bathe” or “wash;” programmability; colors; lumens; hours of operation, etc. Consider a mix of themes and techniques.
- 2 Investigate the availability of locally-engineered solar- and wind-powered exterior lights.
- 3 Decide if the City, DDA or the vendor will be responsible for installation and maintenance. Discuss whether all new construction and rehabilitation projects will be required by code to install this basic – albeit inexpensive – infrastructure.
- 4 Contact vendors and present the options. Negotiate terms and suggest downtown Cheyenne as a proving ground for new products.
- 5 Install a test case – or test cases for different options.
- 6 Prepare to be amazed.
- 7 Move well-beyond a test case.

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA: Run with the idea. See where it leads.
- 2 City: Bless the idea and closely follow the progress.
- 3 CLF&P: Introduce DDA to suppliers and vendors. Become a partner and advertise the advantages.
- 4 Owners: Participate.

Time Allowance

- 1 Research illumination potentials/choices in four weeks.
- 2 Prepare an illustrated prospectus in two weeks. Outline specific options, locations, desired results, etc.
- 3 Let downtown’s stakeholders vote on preferences: “bathe;” “silhouette;” etc.
- 4 Contact vendors and building owners over six weeks.
- 5 Negotiate in five weeks.
- 6 Fabricate and install within six months.

Success Metric

- 1 Number of Wyoming-based vendors.
- 2 Interest in installing a test case.
- 3 Building owner involvement.
- 4 Public reaction.
- 5 Increased night-time business.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Allocate 70 staff days @ \$225/day = \$15,750.
- 2 Assume purchase and installation @ \$50,000.
- 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$6,575.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Renewable wind and solar power lighting is already available. Ask to become a mid-size, test case proving ground. Some urbanists believe that illumination from/on individual buildings will replace traditional street lights – at lower costs and in line with the tenets of “dark skies” advocates.

Total Time:
One year.



Budget:
\$72,325.

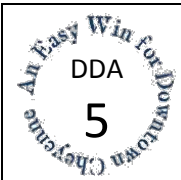


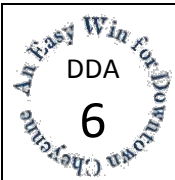
Provide Visual Merchandising Assistance

Project Leader: DDA and DCMA
Logical Partners: Individual Merchants



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Chain stores rely on standardized merchandise designs from headquarters... and franchisees had better pay attention! For locally-owned, one-off shops, it's different. Downtown Cheyenne has some very good storefront presentations – Wyoming Home, the Wrangler, Suite 1901, LightsOn!, City News, etc. – and some wonderful store interiors. Inviting displays on the outside set a mood for what's to come; passers-by are drawn inside. Chances are that if the shows windows are well done, the goods inside are worth a look. But many stores could use some help on window dressing and merchandise displays inside. The solution is simple. Anyone familiar with home improvement shows know about “staging” – making homes sell more quickly, for more money. The same concept applies to retailing: appeal to the greatest number of potential buyers; create talk; draw in more traffic; sell more. Remedy DDA should research professional retail “stagers” from outside Cheyenne – as close as Boulder, Scottsbluff, Casper or Laramie. People respond to outsiders who offer constructive criticism of their merchandise mix and display strategy. Any merchant requesting the service could receive a free walk-through. DDA would foot this bill, benefiting from the opportunity to touch base with retailers and recruit DCMA members. Follow-ups include for-fee services on merchandise mix, in-store and exterior lights, colors, cleaning, de-cluttering, rearranging fixtures and equipment for better traffic flow, etc. Higher sales would help offset the cost. The goal: make stores stand out. Shops with common interests—the Lincolnway “Woman’s Block” or downtown galleries, for example could band together to share costs. Notes A Rawlins Main Street volunteer evaluated how seven downtown Cheyenne shops handle street exposure and interior display space.in 2011 Shopkeepers responded positively, implemented suggestions and increased foot traffic.	1 Identify a few really good retail staging consultants – from outside Cheyenne. 2 Negotiate a consultant package. 3 Market the availability of these services. Evaluate and approve merchant applications. 4 Conduct initial walk-throughs. 5 Decide on levels of service. Schedule the service. 6 Sign a very simple contract among DDA, the merchant and the retail stager. 7 Watch from the sidelines as good things start to happen. 8 Upon achieving several success stories, write and illustrate a brief “how-to” on lessons-learned – a simple primer for every merchant. Market it as a product of DDA and DCMA.	1 DDA/DCMA: Provide the service as a way to address economic development for downtown Cheyenne. Initiate the service. Find the stagers and advertise their services. Target key retailers. Look for underserved niche markets. Follow-up; follow-up. 2 Individual merchants: Stay engaged. Encourage fellow merchants to participate. 3 Professional or non-professional stagers: Provide the service.	1 Research and negotiate stager contracts over one week. 2 Recruit merchants within two weeks. 3 Accompany walk-throughs in one day. 4 Negotiate four demonstration projects in two days.	1 Number of available stagers. 2 Number of staging service applicants. 3 Number of stagings completed – aim for at least ten strategically-located, demonstration shops. 4 Media coverage. 5 Buzz on the street. 6 Merchant satisfaction. 7 On-going and repeat merchant participation.	1 Research and negotiate over 22 days @ \$200/day = \$4,400. 2 Recruit merchants over ten days @ \$200/day = \$2,000. 3 Conduct introductions and walk-throughs in one day @ \$250/day = \$250. 4 Pay stagers @ \$65/hour x five hours per store x four stores = \$1,300. 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$795.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: All of downtown Cheyenne’s retailers could jointly establish a brand for themselves through excellent staging – an edgy, Wild West/New West aesthetic that draws the curious (from everywhere) and produces many more paying customers.		Total Time: One month.		Budget: \$8,745.

 Initiate Annual Tour Showcasing Downtown Living		Project Leader: DDA Logical Partners: CHPB, DCMA, CBR			
Need There appear to be over 150 residential units in downtown Cheyenne and 300 within a 7 minute stroll of Depot Plaza. They range from Single Room Occupancy (SRO) units and modest 600 square foot second floor flats overlooking Lincolnway, to senior housing near the Civic Center and large, chic, upscale apartments and lofts. Behind every carefully restored façade, there’s likely to be at least one appealing residence on an upper story. Who lives here and what does it feel like? Could I see myself living here? Could I buy a historic building, rehab the ground floor as my store or office and also have a terrific urban loft above? Young professionals, empty nesters and retirees of all types are doing just that in urban places nationwide. And there’s plenty of opportunity to do that in downtown Cheyenne, too. Remedy DDA and the Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board, working with local realtors, should initiate an annual tour to showcase downtown Cheyenne’s residences and spark interest in development opportunities by giving a peek inside a few raw, unfinished spaces. In one scenario, downtown residents open their homes to ticket-holders for a few hours. Or the trolley could ferry participants on guided excursions from place to place, ending with a reception and/or dinner. Enlist downtown’s restaurants as co-sponsors. Make sure that galleries and museums are open. Market the tour to downtown’s 16,400 employees. Use a “downtown living” brochure to prompt desire to live a bit smaller, shop locally and work closer to home – or at home. Notes Similar fundraisers have succeeded in smaller cities across the nation. Just three apartments in New Haven sparked renovation and construction of 500 new and rehabbed residential units over ten years. Downtown living in Waterloo (Iowa) increased from about 35 to 150 units in eight years. Laramie has established a program to encourage downtown living. In all three cases, there were spin-offs in retail, restaurant and office tenancies.	Specific Tasks 1 Compile a list of downtown’s most desirable residences – from eight to ten. 2 Visit three very good raw prospects for rehab as residential space. Contact the brokers. 3 Invite the tenants, realtors, etc., to a recruitment meeting. Enlist them. Agree on a date, format and times. Determine ticket costs. 4 Enlist restaurants. 5 Assemble a well-illustrated brochure for the tour; include floor plans of finished units and draft floor plans for raw space. Include a guide to downtown living. 6 Market the tour. Target downtown’s weekday population as guests. Welcome them. Plan on making a profit to be split between DDA and CHPB. 7 Create a brochure on downtown living listing all the day-to-day services within walking distance. 8 Enjoy! 9 Start planning the next tour... expanded to include new residential rehabs. Enlarge the audience to all of downtown’s 16,400 daytime workers. 10 All the while, work to protect the historic neighborhood fabric surrounding downtown. Carefully consider re-zoning from residential to commercial in order to protect this close-in residential population.	Responsible Parties 1 DDA: Organize and produce the tour. Think of it as a fundraiser. 2 CHPB: Identify the likely residential showcases. Become the initial sponsor. Serve as docents at each residence. 3 DCMA: Stay open late. 4 Hosts: Lend a hand by making special places accessible. 5 CBR: Act as docents and tour guides. 6 Restaurants: Attract new (and repeat) audiences.	Time Allowance 1 Plan on six months from idea to staging. Late spring or early summer might be a good target.	Success Metric 1 Number of residences identified – start keeping a list. 2 Number of sponsors. 3 Number of tickets sold. 4 General interest and media coverage. 5 Number of new and rehab housing starts in downtown. 6 Birth of a Downtown Cheyenne Resident’s Association (DCRA).	Budget Allowance 1 Plan the tour in 15 days @ \$250/day = \$3,750. 2 Establish a series of planning meetings among the partners = \$500. 3 Allow \$2,500 for promotion and brochure, etc. 4 Stage the reception @ \$2,000. 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$875. 6 Plan on making a profit.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Mounting the first annual tour takes time and patience, but each subsequent tour is easier. Other cities mount tours of particularly notable retail and office premises. All are good marketing tools for investing in downtowns – for a variety of interest groups.			Total Time: Six months.	 Budget: \$9,625.



Take Festivals to All of Downtown’s Streets

Project Leader: DDA and DCMA
Logical Partners: Visit Cheyenne, Chamber, City



Need

Downtowns are gathering places and almost every city has a favorite spot. In Cheyenne, it’s Depot Plaza. Civic festivals, fairs and parades just don’t work well along Dell Range’s suburban parking lots. Depot Plaza is defined by a National Historic Landmark and enclosed by four National Register buildings. It’s a terrific place for a civic party with good food, drink and entertainment. It’s packed on Friday and Saturday nights. But it’s not the only place to hold events, as DDA proved by creating ArtsFest on 17th Street in 2012: the rest of downtown awaits.

Remedy

Downtown’s merchants and restaurants sometimes gripe about Depot Plaza’s lock on public events or note that Lincolnway’s traffic discourages the Plaza crowds from going farther. But reworking Lincolnway is beyond the City’s sole control. Rather, take a cue from the DDA’s first Annual 17th Street Arts Festival on and near Dinneen Plaza... put event attendees where merchants and restaurants already are. Spread the wealth. What are some new and unusual places to be festive that DDA, as event planner, can identify? Could smaller events co-present with larger festivals, allowing more things to see and do all over downtown? Consider...

- Hold monthly kite-flying competitions. Award prizes for the biggest and strangest kites;
- Hold events for ethnic and Native American groups, Juneteenth, seasonal festivals, UP reunions;
- Plan noontime progressive Taste of Cheyenne events;
- Arrange monthly museum/gallery visits, perhaps by trolley. Mix with café, restaurant and pub crawls;
- Propose “Tour de Downtown” marathons for runners, cyclists, antique truck and auto enthusiasts; On snowy days, hold impromptu lunch-time snow sculpture contests along Capitol Avenue;
- Stage noon and after work concerts with rock, gospel, country, symphonic and choral ensembles.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Create a calendar of all Cheyenne and Laramie County festivals and events. There are dozens already on-line – large, small, family-oriented, likely-to-be-loud, etc.
- 2 Think about past suggestions for events. Dream up some new ones. Add them to the list.
- 3 Consider different times of the day and days of the week. Remember that there are 16,400 willing participants already downtown during the workweek.
- 4 List potential downtown venues other than Depot Plaza. 17th Street? 18th? 19th all the way from Holliday Park to MLK Park? Crow Creek? Near the Capitol? Near CRMC?
- 5 Match events with venues. Contact presenters. Determine interest in staging downtown. Suggest co-sponsorships for several events at once.
- 6 Seek more ideas. Prepare a refreshed events calendar.
- 7 Smooth approval processes through all City and County agencies.
- 8 Market the events. Arrange for “specials” at all downtown restaurants and bars. Put up temporary wayfinding signs to guide visitors from place to place.
- 9 Participate and enjoy – all the while, think of new ideas to celebrate and combinations of places and streets.

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA and DCMA: Conduct all research and follow-up. Maintain up-to-the-minute records and contacts.
- 2 Visit Cheyenne: Help with ideas, contacts and logistics. Market the expanded downtown events calendar to visitors.
- 3 Chamber: Join in.
- 4 City: Provide logistics and permits – all the more reason to expand Clean & Safe and add work/release participants.
- 5 Presenters: Take advantage of the opportunities.

Time Allowance

- 1 Conduct all research and contacts over two days per month.
- 2 Supervise and add new ideas in three days per month.

Success Metric

- 1 Number of successful new events.
- 2 Number of participants.
- 3 Additional venues identified.
- 4 More Ideas for more events.
- 5 Satisfaction among downtown merchants.
- 6 Increased DCMA memberships.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Dedicate 30 days annually @ \$250/day = \$7,500.
- 2 Monitor new and changing events over 20 days @ \$225/day = \$5,000.
- 3 Occasionally test ideas with an on-call, professional events planner @ \$5,000
- 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,750.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Encourage DDA and DCMA to think and act as a party planner geared towards attracting new audiences, new businesses and even more events to all of downtown.

Total Time:
Two months.



Budget
\$19,250.



Solicit Drawings, Designs and Dreams for Downtown

Project Leader: DDA and Laramie County Library
Logical Partners: City’s Planning Department



Need

It’s intriguing (and instructive) to hear people reminisce about downtown Cheyenne in the 1950s and 60s. And it’s fascinating (and encouraging) to hear dreams for downtown’s future from long-time residents and newcomers. Placemaking participants envision an energetic, bustling, vital place: from heavy pedestrian traffic to bike trails; from a small department store to a kite shop; from a game arcade to a children’s museum... a health club to an ice cream shop... a brew-pub to day care center. “Dreamscapes” are fun ways to engage all ages in imagining an ideal downtown. Given the prospects for a multi-faceted “energy play” and predictions of continued regional population growth, now is a good time to find out what the citizens of this place really want and imagine for their downtown.

Remedy

The Laramie County Library System (LCLS) holds a special, prideful place in the community. About 80 percent of residents hold library cards! It was the 2008 national Library of the Year. A DDA-LCLS partnership could solicit drawings, designs and dreams for downtown, perhaps as an all-County, all-age competition for both amateurs and professionals. LCLS might stipulate a series of must-haves mentioned by Placemaking stakeholders, e.g., trails and greenways, water features, public art, etc. Beyond that, entrants are free to dream and design tomorrow’s downtown Cheyenne. Three dimensions and bright colors welcome! Prizes would be awarded in numerous categories – age, group entries, most housing options, best showcase as Wyoming’s capital city, most visionary, etc. All entries could be displayed at LCLS with winners receiving gift cards and Boot Bucks for redemption at downtown merchants, restaurants and services.

Notes

More planning and much more rehab and new construction will change downtown (Strategy 25). This is a wonderful way to increase public involvement and garner good ideas. Architects, planners, engineers and landscape architects: Take note!

Specific Tasks

- 1 Think through the idea with DDA and LCLS. Seek approval from both Boards.
- 2 Schedule and market the first drawings, designs and dreams competition. Define entrant categories.
- 3 Solicit prize donations.
- 4 Require pre-registration of all potential entrants in each category, at no charge.
- 5 Hold how-to sessions. Encourage inventiveness. Review the “I wish this was...” entries.
- 6 Assemble a jury.
- 7 Stage the competition.
- 8 Award winners. Ask them to serve as jurors in the next competition.
- 9 Mount an exhibition of all entries with a special section for prize winners.

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA/DCMA: Drum-up support and donate prizes.
- 2 LCLS: Think, organize, cajole and be persuasive.
- 3 City: Provide technical support and logistics.

Time Allowance

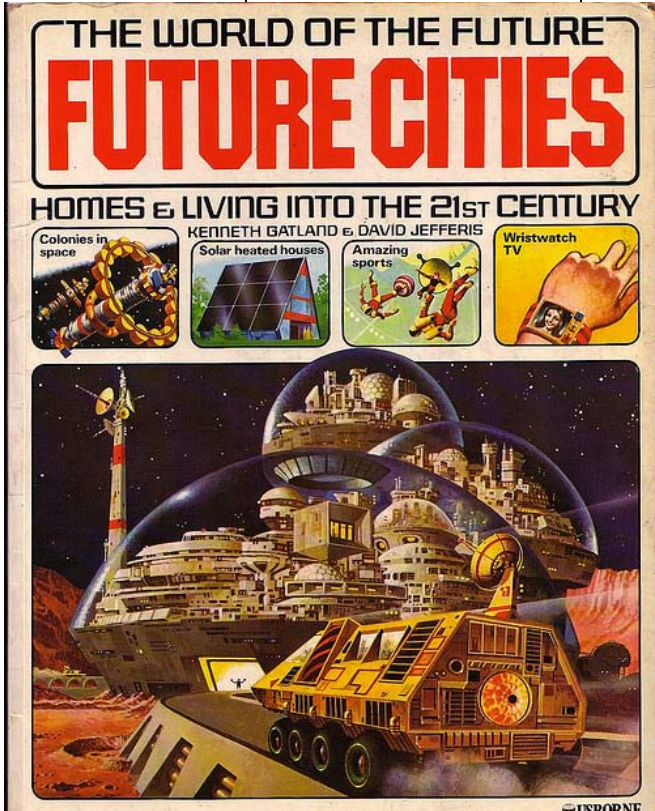
- 1 Devote six months from original idea to awards presentation.

Success Metric

- 1 Board approval.
- 2 Media attention.
- 3 Number of registered entrants.
- 4 Number of completed entries.
- 5 Again, media attention.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Plan over 20 days @ \$250/day = \$5,000.
- 2 Publicize @ \$3,500.
- 3 Allow \$4,000 for Boots Bucks and gift cards.
- 4 Collect arts and crafts supplies – paper, cardboard, markers, tape, glue, etc. = \$2,500. (Make the supplies available to younger entrants and nonprofit groups.)
- 5 Hold the competition. Jury it. Award prizes. Host a reception = \$1,500.
- 6 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,650.



Next Steps/Future Implications: Given the Library’s reputation and status, hold dreamscape competitions on a regular basis, perhaps annually. Narrow (or expand) the focus – a specific downtown site, the skyline, downtown at night, the view from I-25 and I-80, etc. Plan a “Night at the Library” for kids and put the spotlight on downtown.

Total Time:
Six months.

Budget:
\$18,150.



Quantify Dimensions of Untapped/Underserved Markets

Project Leader: DDA and DCMA
Logical Partners: Chamber, Downtown Merchants, LCCC



Need

Downtown’s vibrancy depends on successful enterprises including restaurants, retail goods, business and personal services, arts, culture and other entertainment experiences as well as services for travelers. Sadly, many new and existing businesses fail to thrive. Understanding available markets and helping them do a better job of attracting those markets will improve performance. In turn, livelier storefronts and increased commerce make downtown more attractive to both customers and other enterprises seeking a business location. Finally, showing developers that downtown makes sense for additional residential development (new, rehab and adaptive reuse) will mean additional economic activity for all merchants.

Remedy

Small enterprises often lack the skills to conduct formal market analyses or can’t afford to acquire data or hire consultants. DDA can provide this information to downtown merchants for free and, as part of its business assistance programs, help them understand the analysis and its ramifications (and include it in recruitment packages geared towards companies that might do well downtown and contribute to its character). DDA can use its position as a neutral, trusted third party to compile, sanitize and disseminate sensitive data so that downtown businesses benefit from aggregated data without fear that their own performance statistics will be broadcast to competitors. Visit Cheyenne uses this tactic to share occupancy rates and other metrics with area hotels.

Notes

Market data and analysis, including survey findings, can help existing and prospective enterprises refine their offerings and improve customer service, e.g., offering a break on shipping to appeal to tourists and festival attendees. Many national retailers and restaurant chains rely on fairly crudeMetrics to decide whether to investigate a new market, e.g., traffic and population counts. Since Cheyenne draws from well beyond its borders and downtown remains largely unappreciated, DDA needs to make the case that the region can support companies that might not give it a second look.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Identify analysis objectives. Write a program plan and, if appropriate, develop a request for proposals.
- 2 Catalog existing operators and performanceMetrics appropriate to use categories, e.g., sales per square foot, occupancy rates, price per square foot, etc.
- 3 Quantify dimensions of available markets.
- 4 Identify gaps in the menu of places to eat, sleep, shop, and be entertained, as correlated to available markets.
- 5 Define opportunities and related threshold requirements.
- 6 Develop information and marketing pieces to share the findings.
- 7 Establish systems for replicating and automating performanceMetrics from existing merchants.
- 8 Establish systems for replicating and automating distribution.
- 9 Work with LCCC, the Board of Realtors and others to incorporate information about opportunities in their work with entrepreneurs.

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA/DCMA and the Chamber: This is the core mission of recruiting new businesses and strengthening existing ones.
- 2 Merchants: Participate and be open to changes for the better.
- 3 LCCC: Provide technical support and trainees.

Time Allowance

- 1 Allow six months for all work from introductory sessions to the first release of findings.

Success Metric

- 1 A replicable system for gathering performance metrics.
- 2 A replicable system for identifying emerging opportunities.
- 3 A replicable system for sharing the findings with as many entrepreneurs and prospects as possible.
- 4 Prepare for a more bustling downtown Cheyenne. This is a really easy strategy that could pay off well indeed!

Budget Allowance

- 1 Conduct the initial market analysis @ \$25,000.
- 2 Develop the systems tools @ \$5,000.
- 3 Prepare publicity and recruitment tools for \$2,000.
- 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$3,200.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Success begets success by inspiring others to follow their dreams and take risks. Celebrating downtown’s next generation of pioneers – their trials, tribulations and sources of support – will educate and motivate future entrepreneurs. However, as downtown improves, real estate prices will rise and start-ups will require other kinds of assistance.

Total Time:
Six months.

Budget:
\$35,200.

Help Secure a Downtown Grocer or Food Co-op

Project Leader: DDA and DCMA
Logical Partners: The Private Sector, the Public



Need

Since the Safeway on Pioneer closed in 2010, downtown has lacked a full-service grocer. This inconveniences downtown’s office workers and merchants and irritates its residents. Placemaking participants put a very high priority on attracting a grocer and raised the notion of a locally-owned food co-operative frequently.

First, Cheyenne appears to be underserved: there are conventional grocery chains on the north, east and south sides. Second, there are only two independent health food stores. Preliminary market research has uncovered an unmet need for a traditional full-service grocer. Placemaking participants suggest that a new store should also sell natural, locally-grown and locally-raised foods.

Remedy

Concerted community action can help attract a grocer or even lead to starting a “Magic City” food co-op – or both.

- Acknowledge that securing a store or starting a food co-op is not easy: it takes longer than planned; it will be expensive. But it comes with great satisfaction.
- Consult nearby stores and co-ops (e.g., Big Hollow in Laramie and Main Street Market in Scottsbluff) that might expand downtown or coach the effort. Research the topic using such sources as the Co-operative Grocer’s Information Network, cgin.coop.
- Form a leadership group to examine feasibility. Recruit advocates – the customer base for a store and the foundation for a co-op. Identify the suppliers and invite all vendors at local farmers’ markets.
- Suggest appropriate downtown locations. Compare lease terms and renovation expenses. Make the case: area population, workers, residents in walking distance or a 15-minute driving radius, household incomes, etc., are traditional predictors of success.

Notes

Much small communities have full-service grocers and/or food co-ops in their downtowns. It also takes leadership, determination and funding. If the many foodies attending Placemaking events put their heads together...

Specific Tasks

- 1 Convene an internal task force made up of DDA and DCMA stalwarts interested in the idea of a grocer or food co-op. Discuss the broad issues. Pose questions-to-be-answered.
- 2 Organize a series of open-to-the-public think sessions. Focus on leadership but also consider location, local suppliers, heirloom products, local food brokers, etc. Make a “shopping list.”
- 3 Visit the region’s three co-ops – Ft. Collins, Laramie, and Scottsbluff. Take copious notes and debrief later.
- 4 Look to professional market researchers for underserved and unmet needs, product lines, start-up costs, profit (and loss) projections, etc.
- 5 Decide if Cheyenne wants to grow a co-op from local seeds or import one from outside. Alternatively, decide how to pursue a “traditional” grocer with lots of local input. During Placemaking sessions, at least two national food stores were mentioned frequently as desirable targets.
- 6 Start an aggressive promotion campaign. Recruit participants and/or potential members. Recruit more participants/members.
- 7 Hold fundraisers, perhaps in association with Cheyenne Young Professionals and Leadership Cheyenne.
- 8 Stick to the idea and follow-through.

Responsible Parties

The lead organizations are named to initiate Strategy 9. It should be quickly handed off to the private sector.

- 1 DDA and DCMA: Be the drum major from start to finish – this benefits all of downtown.
- 2 Public and private interests: Become regular patrons. Talk it up with friends and colleagues.



Time Allowance

- 1 Plan initial talks over three months.
- 2 Visit regional co-ops within that same time frame.
- 3 Make a final decision within six months.
- 4 Hire market analysts for two months.
- 5 Put feet on the accelerator within one year.

Success Metric

- 1 Number of leaders recruited.
- 2 Positive market back-up on need, household income, potential patrons, range of goods for sale, suppliers, etc.
- 3 Number of possible locations.
- 4 Number of originating members recruited (aim for at least 1,000).
- 5 Financial backing.
- 6 First year sales – and increases every year.
- 7 Growing patronage/memberships and need for more space.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Assign all preparation and research to volunteers = 0.
- 2 Visit nearby co-ops @ \$1,000.
- 2 Hire outside co-op professionals and market researchers @ ~\$15,000.
- 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,600.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Make no small plans! Locate the new grocer or food co-op near Depot Plaza, the garage and the artists’ co-op. Add to the selections available – perhaps a pharmacy, a locally-supplied florist, a wine store, a health club... and the list goes on.

Total Time:
One year.

Budget:
\$17,600.

Continue to Reinvigorate DCMA

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: DCMA, non-DCMA Merchants, the Chamber



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Placemaking sessions attracted over 400 stakeholders including property owners and merchants. Another 50 engaged in casual chats in their shops or on the street. Sadly, it's not uncommon for a merchant to say, "No, I'm not a DCMA member. I used to be, but never got anything out of it." When pressed on what "anything" means or what they want to "get out of it," answers were vague: "...Oh, they should market more... bring new businesses" or "...Oh, they should fix things up." How to engage the merchants in a systematic process to determine exactly what they want from DCMA... just ask! DDA, DCMA and the Chamber share an interest in everything downtown. (In fact, everyone does.) Thinking through their mutual and individual roles in making downtown Cheyenne live up to its potential calls for direct involvement from as many merchants as possible – downtown-based as well as the "I'll think about downtown, maybe" crowd. Remedy To enlist merchants to work with DCMA, bring back the University of Wyoming's Survey and Analysis Center—which previously surveyed downtown property owners and businesses operators—to talk to merchants and identify help they could use from DCMA. What can DCMA do to reinvigorate itself, help its members, increase sales and attract even more merchants and merchant-members? How can it demonstrate benefits to participating merchants? Notes Reinvigorating DCMA is closely related to recruiting more merchants to downtown Cheyenne. In turn, it's linked to recruiting more office and residential tenants, helping new businesses get started, and other aspects of the system.	1 Thoroughly review and understand WYSAC's 2010 research on downtown's property owners. 2 Target all types of merchants for one-on-one chats about their business needs/wants – about 30 completed kick-off conversations. Solicit ideas. 3 Create a wish-list for DCMA. Dream up more great ideas. 4 Sort the list by responsibility: DCMA; DDA; Chamber; Visit Cheyenne; City, etc. 5 Engage WYSAC to develop a merchant-directed survey process and form. Be very specific in developing questions. Be aware of a merchant's limited day-time availability. 6 Hold an opening reception for all merchants – DDA members, non-DCMA members... everyone. Announce the survey's intent and planned results. 7 Conduct the survey. Analyze, collate and compile results. 8 Develop a menu of DCMA services/activities. 9 Test each one in follow-up receptions. 10 Over time, implement each one and monitor the results. Deliver and discuss the results in regular meetings. 11 Implement the consensus set of DCMA services. Prepare to add new services to the menu.	1 DDA: Head the effort. Stick with it. Adopt a "this is a new regime" attitude. 2 DCMA members: Get to know fellow merchants – not just next door neighbors. Talk, think and plan together. 3 Non-DCMA members: Contribute to discussions. Become involved. 4 City: Be the drum major. 5 Chamber: Provide expertise.	1 Allow three weeks for kick-off chats and analyses. 2 Engage WYSAC in one week. 3 Plan meetings and outside help over three months.	1 Positive response from initial chats. 2 Number of additional requests for chats. 3 Number of completed surveys. 4 Number of new DCMA memberships in established downtown stores. 5 Number of new memberships from merchants who moved to downtown. 6 An active, aggressive and reinvigorated DCMA.	1 Conduct all research and analysis in 14 days @ \$250/day = \$3,500. 2 Hire WYSAC @ \$12,500. 3 Allocate about \$7,500 for outside help. 4 Plan on an additional 20 days @ \$250/day = \$5,000. 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$2,100.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: The immediate goal is to activate DCMA's base. The larger purpose is increasing membership and engaging <u>all</u> of them in cooperative, aggressive tactics to lure shoppers – many more shoppers – to an extraordinary and unique retail environment.		Total Time: Five months.		Total Budget: \$23,100.

Help New Business Get Started; Open the “Idea Lab”

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: LEADS, Chamber, Others



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
State agencies (especially the Wyoming Business Council), the University of Wyoming, community colleges, economic development groups, chambers of commerce, etc., offer various programs to help entrepreneurs start small businesses and create jobs. At least 15 proposals for businesses with market potential were floated over the course of Placemaking meetings. However, further investigation revealed missteps and lack of information. When starting a business, what is the <u>one</u> telephone number to call? Where is the <u>one</u> place to go to ask basic questions? If an entrepreneur’s focus is on a new venture, there’s little patience with telephone trees. Many cities claim to be <i>the</i> place for “innovation,” but few provide an incubator for hands-on guidance. Downtown Cheyenne could offer that laboratory – a helpful place devoted to making important things happen. Remedy Downtown Cheyenne can attract and cultivate Wyoming’s best entrepreneurial talent but it requires someone to offer encouragement, field questions, make connections, cut red tape and cut ribbons... a business start-up to start-up business. Over time, a well-funded partnership – akin to LEADS, but focused exclusively on downtown entrepreneurs—with talented staff can: • Cultivate local angel investors who believe in downtown Cheyenne and nurturing great ideas. • Partner with the University of Wyoming’s Research Products Center (RPC), the State’s eight major entrepreneurial programs (plus LCCC). Catalogue what’s available now in straightforward language and tweak programs to meet downtown’s specific needs with an eye towards implementing them state-wide. • Open the “Idea Lab” in downtown Cheyenne, staffed by the RPC’s faculty and students. • After a call for proposals, select at least twelve entrepreneurs to receive help advancing their ideas in exchange for an investment position. • Start a venture of the month club and repeat often.	1 Start round table discussions toward the “Idea Lab.” Be inclusive. Be patient. Invite a wide audience to participate. Expand that audience. Expand it again. 2 Over time, agree on a written action plan, expectations and a specific time table for implementation. 3 Form partnerships – wherever they may be. Recruit angel investors. Sign Memoranda of Understanding on investments, intellectual property, buy-outs, partnerships, etc. Advertise services. 4 Find appropriate downtown space(s). Open the “Idea Lab.” 5 Issue Requests for Proposals. Jury the entrants. Award fellowships. 6 Cultivate the award winners. 7 Celebrate mutually beneficial successes. 8 Move on to another best idea.	1 DDA. 2 LEADS, Chamber, Visit Cheyenne. 3 Wyoming Business Council/State of Wyoming and state agencies. 4 University of Wyoming. 5 Angel investors from the private sector.	1 Plan on one year for an initial success. 2 Dedicate at least two years for proven successes.	1 Initial interest in the “Idea Lab.” 2 Number of round table participants. 3 Number of partners and their financial contributions. 4 Ribbon cutting at the “Idea Lab.” 5 Number of venture proposals as well as number of venture proposals accepted. 6 Number of new businesses. 7 Number of new businesses after five years. 8 Number of copy cat versions in other cities and state capitals.	1 Initially, one very full-time staff at @ \$100,000. 2 Over time, a full-service agency that produces great results. 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$10,000.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Great ideas beget spin-offs and spin-offs beget more spin-offs. Capitalize on building from terrific ideas to excellent products and services. Watch them grow and spread.		Total Time: Two years.		Total Budget: ~\$110,000.



Develop Office Tenant Recruitment Tools

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: City, CBR, LEADS, Architects



Need

Strip office malls and suburban business parks offer easy access, fairly cheap rents, on-street identity and side-by-side contact with other services – print stores, office supplies, restaurants, etc. Several decades ago, the same could be said for office space in downtown Cheyenne.

Downtown already offers a variety of rehabilitated office space with more available for rehab. Where are the office tenants? Can a market be created for more converted office space... indeed, new office space? It’s time to return to the day when downtown offices are the top-of-mind choice for new and expanding businesses.

Remedy

- DDA should coordinate a short-term three- or four-year incentive program to lure office tenants back downtown with incentives based on current market data including available space, absorption rates, target and niche markets (e.g., energy, high tech, green buildings, etc.).
- Maintain an accurate, detailed listing of available downtown office space by category: move-in ready; needs work; gut rehab.
 - Subsidize architectural and design fees for new and expanded office space – 25 percent of standard fees.
 - Establish a build-out assistance program for new and expanding downtown office tenants – 25¢ for every dollar spent on approved, documented renovations.
 - Offer new employee benefits, e.g., \$100 in full value Boots Bucks and/or Positively Cheyenne coupons or free parking at a city-owned facility for one year.
 - Grant a finder’s fee to licensed agents who sign a three-year office lease (on the second or higher floor) matching the commission, up to \$1,500.
 - Plant a tree to honor each new downtown company.
 - Encourage ground floor office users to move to second or higher floors to make room for retailers to serve the growing office worker population.
 - Find out why companies chose to locate downtown to improve the pitch to successive office tenants and make it easier for them to do the same.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Commit to filling downtown’s office space – starting with the existing supply of Class A space.
- 2 Commission the office space market analysis.
- 3 Cull the results and develop incentives.
- 4 Test the incentives. Tweak them.
- 5 Print a recruitment brochure.
- 6 Market the program with realtors and brokers.
- 7 Hold open houses in existing and planned office environments.
- 8 Recruit office tenants from Cheyenne and elsewhere.
- 9 Cut ribbons.

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA: Instigate the program. Propose incentives. Provide back-up data. Monitor all activities.
- 2 City: Cheerlead; help convince office tenants to move downtown.
- 3 Market analyst: Provide accurate, convincing results. Tweak incentives.
- 4 CBR: Target and sign the tenants.
- 5 Downtown office tenants: Smile and enjoy the benefits. Then convince others.

Time Allowance

- 1 Conduct situation analyses and hold discussions over four weeks.
- 2 Perform market analyses in six weeks.
- 3 Allow two weeks for incentive development and recruitment tools.
- 4 Plan on 12 weeks to enlist partners.
- 5 Attract the first tenant in 18 weeks.

Success Metric

- 1 Uncovering a nascent demand for downtown office space.
- 2 Realtor response.
- 3 Office tenant interest.
- 4 Signed leases.
- 5 Success of incentives program.
- 6 Demand for program retention and expansion.
- 7 Number of new office employees.
- 8 Reduced vacancies.
- 9 Increased retail sales.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Fine-tune recruitment details in five days @ \$250/day = \$1,250
- 2 Hire market analyst @ \$15,000.
- 3 Negotiate with architects, designers and CBR in four days @ \$250/day = \$1,000.
- 4 Assume five new offices with ten employees each: Design fees = \$5,000 Finder’s fees = \$7,500 Parking = \$24,000 Boots Bucks = \$5,000 Build-out = \$50,000.
- 5 Dedicate 30% DDA salary equivalent each year = \$36,300.
- 6 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$14,525.

Next Steps/Future Implications: The temporary incentive program is one more step in achieving several of the goals in PlanCheyenne: contain sprawl, reuse existing infrastructure, save money, become more sustainable.

Total Time:
~ One year.



Total Budget:
\$159,775, all inclusive.

Develop Merchant Recruitment Tools

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: DCMA and Other Economic Development Leaders



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
In March, 2010, the Wyoming Survey and Analysis Center (WYSAC) surveyed almost 100 downtown <u>property owners</u>: 68 percent chose “business recruitment and retention” as DDA’s highest priority; 53 percent consider DDA’s success in this as “poor” or “very poor.” However, WYSAC didn’t poll <u>merchants</u>. That knowledge gap should be rectified; Downtown’s existing merchants best know the pleasures/perils of having a shop downtown. Moreover, they are key resources for ideas about how to help existing businesses, attract new merchants and draw more customers. Some will, inevitably, protest providing incentives to new shops when existing merchants aren’t eligible. Consequently, it’s important that merchants understand how agglomeration benefits them. Remedy “Promoting economic development for new and existing businesses in downtown Cheyenne” is part of DDA’s DNA. DDA/DCMA need to schedule a series of structured and detailed planning sessions to develop incentives for new merchants from near and far <i>as well as</i> existing merchants. Examine the advantages that a shopping mall enjoys over downtown: joint marketing; coordinated business hours; consistent maintenance and “controlled” weather; proximity to complementary retailers; signing bonuses and rent assistance... Now, imagine how downtown can adopt/adapt and, indeed, improve upon the mall standard by offering locally-sourced products, unique items, very specific and one-off niche markets, and things-you-didn’t-know-you-needed goods. <i>A situation is always made better when you plan and act together instead of alone.</i> DCMA and DDA will have access to services offered by Wyoming agencies, the Chamber, LEADS, Visit Cheyenne, LCCC, University of Wyoming, etc. In the process, emphasize the goal of reinvigorating DCMA (Strategy 10).	1 Analyze downtown’s current mix of retailers: use, size, location(s), patronage, successes, near-failures, parking, etc. 2 Quantify unmet and underserved market demands (Strategy 8). Look for existing and emerging niches that could grow significantly. Identify merchants who could add to each niche or start a new one. 4 Imagine an ideal retail mix and favorable adjacencies – just like a mall. Encourage and assist existing merchants to help create a near-ideal layout (Strategies 8 through 13). 5 Convene DCMA’s 150+ members (perhaps by market segments, e.g., retail, restaurants, galleries, etc.) to hear complaints and solicit new ideas. 6 Enlist recruitment experts as facilitators. 7 Jointly develop concepts to improve downtown’s retail environment. 8 Seek support from elected officials. 9 Compile a list of target merchants – existing and new. 10 Launch a recruitment/expansion program. Aim for one success per month. 11 Celebrate each new opening, expansion or repositioning. Celebrate the new DCMA. 12 Monitor results and repeat...early and often.	1 DDA: Task DDA’s Economic Development Committee with almost all responsibilities. 2 DDA: Task DDA’s Marketing Committee with the remainder. 3 DCMA: Engage as many members as possible. Recruit new members. Aim for 100 percent. 4 Everyone: All parties with a stake in Cheyenne’s and downtown Cheyenne’s economic well-being.	1 Plan on market research over three months. 2 Conduct planning sessions over two months. 3 Set a six month target for the first expanded or new merchant. 4 Continue and open a new merchant every month. 5 Ratchet-up and continue.	1 Initial, on-going and growing merchant involvement. 2 Success in winning City, County, State and other participation. 3 Interest from targeted merchants. 4 Number of new retailer moves to downtown. 5 Number of downtown merchant expansions. 6 Number of Cheyenne-based tools replicated in other Wyoming Main Street cities and nationwide.	1 Budget \$20,000 for market research. 2 Hire retail facilitators and coaches @ \$30,000. 3 Allocate 30 percent of DDA’s staff salary equivalent each year = \$36,300. 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$8,630.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Retenancing <i>all</i> of downtown’s vacant or under-utilized retail space is not the goal. Rather, it’s creating a bustling and healthy economy serving very satisfied patrons. Downtown Cheyenne needs to be the first choice for merchants.		Total Time: Nine months and on-going.		Total Budget: \$94,930.

Coordinate Restaurant/Retail Outreach Efforts

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: Other Economic Development Leaders and Merchants



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Recruiting tenants to fill downtown’s empty storefronts and commercial kitchens requires more than a briefcase full of persuasive market data. It also requires a coordinated effort to appeal to prospects’ hearts as well as to their heads. Business recruitment is too important to be left to chance. Remedy Earlier strategies (e.g., Strategy 4, 8, 11, 12, and 13) detail the tasks involved in establishing readiness, from identifying available space to establishing reliable market data evidencing opportunities. Other strategies describe new incentives – both financial and technical assistance – that can be offered to enterprises doing business downtown. With these tools, it will become increasingly possible to tailor solicitation packages, thereby increasing Cheyenne’s competitiveness as a business location. But recruitment also entails telling downtown Cheyenne’s story in ways that encourage alliances and attend to the human dimension. Relating recent successes, describing new and ongoing initiatives, demonstrating enthusiasm and showing that this region’s leaders value the business prospect being recruited are all important aspects of making the case that an investment in downtown will yield dividends. Notes Many other cities hire retail coordinators specifically charged with recruitment and related activities, e.g., thinking strategically about managing the mix of downtown restaurants and retailers for downtown Cheyenne’s collective benefit.	1 Tap LEAD’s, the Chamber’s and Visit Cheyenne’s staff for a primer in the etiquette and best practices of pitching downtown to prospects. 2 Develop a suite of marketing materials that can be easily updated, from leave-behinds to website pages. 3 Recruit help from the existing merchant base – especially already active DCMA members. 4 Systematically identify prospects, including homegrown enterprises operating elsewhere in Wyoming, Colorado, Nebraska, etc., that may be ready for expansion. 5 Establish a contact team. Make visits. 6 Track the results.	1 DDA/DCMA: Once again, this is DDA’s core mission and benefits accrue to all DCMA members. 2 Engage all other economic development entities. Promote active involvement from the Wyoming Business Council. Expand the programs to all Wyoming Main Street communities. Work together to put Main Streets on the map! 3 Merchants: Organize a promotion for prospects that tout the advantages.	1 Compile materials within two months. 2 Identify the recruitment team in one month. 3 Tap merchants for ideas over two months. 4 Identify prospects from near and far within two months. 5 Make contacts and carefully track the results over six months.	1 Completion of a convincing case statement for downtown Cheyenne. 2 Identify and collate prospects by category and gather contact information. 3 Track contacts and outcomes. 4 Track new enterprises downtown.	1 Allow \$3,000 for all materials. 2 Budget travel and entertainment @ \$12,000. 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,500.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: For a relatively small start-up cost, Cheyenne’s DDA could prove the program in the capital city and then enlist statewide participation by a number of Main Street communities. This could become another “salable” or licensed program to all 2,000+ National Main Street members.		Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$16,500.

Manage and Maintain Street Furniture

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: Clean & Safe, other City and County programs



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Every resurgent downtown provides amenities for pedestrians, shoppers, office workers, residents and visitors. Cheyenne provides the basics, but it's time to refresh, renew and improve many of these public facilities. Where to start? A quick walk around one downtown block with an avid stakeholder resulted in a list of 16 items needing attention – a missing trash bin lid, a loose bike rack, two burned out lights, two bent sign standards (one on public property; one on private property), litter in a cracked planter, uneven sidewalks, crumbling curbs... The Clean & Safe crew – four full-time and one or two seasonal employees – can't possibly address every such issue. Even without considering their snow removal responsibilities, there is a giant mismatch between resources and issues needing attention. Remedy One approach suggests that street furniture – the <u>movable</u> amenities provided in the public realm (e.g., benches, bike racks, tree grates, trash bins, planters, Boots Walker's boots, etc.) – is a distinct set of responsibilities. <u>Immovable</u> elements – street trees, sidewalks, curbs, gutters, painted cross-walks, traffic signals, signs and sign posts, alleys, etc. – differ. Both represent a huge civic investment but each calls for a different set of management and maintenance tools. <u>Movable</u> aspects of downtown's infrastructure need daily attention: emptying trash bins; painting bike racks and benches; watering plants; refreshing flowers; installing seasonal décor and getting ready for festivals. These tasks could be handled by work/release inmates from the Laramie County Detention Center, giving Clean & Safe staff more time to tend to the <u>immovable</u>. The result: more hands-on-deck; minimal cost increase; superior service; a neater, better looking downtown. Plus, there's on-the-job training for work/release crews. Notes Use the City's web-based "Request Partner" system, new brochures and a 311 system (Strategy 22) to improve reaction time and reduce complaints.	- Expand and carefully edit the City's existing GIS-based system to separate <u>moveable</u> from <u>non-moveable</u> items in public ownership – with an eye on what Clean & Safe should continue to do (more frequently) and what work/release participants might do. Divide the duties in a manner similar to what takes place at a suburban mall. Write detailed job descriptions for each group. - Research work/release programs in other downtowns. Determine benefits, risks, cautions, etc. - Negotiate for work/release inmates: duties; hours; security; public safety, etc. (There are indications that up to 50 work days per month may be available from the Detention Facility – that's 600 days annually.) - Publicize the new system with emphases on DCMA members, property owners, merchants and other stakeholders. - Provide orientation and training; outfit work/release participants with distinctive vests in the summer and coats and hats for the winter. Ask them to report issues involving <u>non-moveable</u> items to Clean & Safe or other appropriate City, County or State of Wyoming agencies. - Test the new system. - Monitor the new system over one year. Expand it as practicable.	- DDA: Provide financing. Expand maintenance programs at little additional cost. - Clean & Safe: Oversee initial work/release training and follow-up supervision. - Other City and County agencies: Call on Public Works and WYDOT as jobs and jurisdictions demand.	- Organize the GIS maps into two sets of responsibilities over two weeks. - Screen, recruit and orient work/release program participants over four weeks.	- Separation of the GIS system into two sets of responsibilities. - Number of eligible work/release participants. - Program success. - Public reaction – hopefully applause.	- Allow staff 15 days to propose revamping the system @ \$250/day = \$3,750. - Order vests and coats with distinctive markings @ \$100/person for 15 work/release participants = \$1,500. - Add contingency @ ten percent = \$525.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Some jurisdictions allow an approved inmate "full time work release;" a person works five days per week, ten hours a day at an assigned publicly-owned job site in exchange for one day of jail time. Again, it's worth a try.		Total Time: ~ Six weeks.		Budget: \$5,775.

Expand the Clean & Safe Program

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: City and Property Owners



Need

Downtown Cheyenne’s Clean & Safe program is both effective and criticized: effective because it takes care of some nasty situations before the public perceives them; criticized because the public doesn’t see the crew on a daily basis. It doesn’t help that there are varying definitions of what “clean and safe” really means. Discussion has been held between the City’s Clean & Safe administration and DDA to evaluate how to achieve more efficiency and productivity, given limited personnel and dollars. The challenge is to more evenly match the goals of the program with public expectations.

Remedy

Given the addition of work/release program participants (Strategy 15) – the Clean & Safe crew will be able to focus on downtown’s non-moveable public infrastructure. Expect some tweaking. For example, Clean & Safe will still be responsible for event set-up and clean, especially at Depot Plaza. But this crew could be supplemented by work/release participants. Work/release crews could also become responsible for daily maintenance of the parking garage and some of Cheyenne Transit Program’s moveable facilities.

If tasks can be split between the movable and the non-movable (Strategy 15), Clean & Safe will be better able to maintain its schedule while delivering higher-quality service. In the meantime, downtown Cheyenne’s Clean & Safe crew needs to be expanded by at least one full-time employee and several part-time workers for snow days and events on Depot Plaza. With five full-time employees and four part-time staff Clean & Safe can provide more frequent service in response to the increasing number of events, complexity of public facilities and a growing inventory of City-owned infrastructure.

Notes

Hundreds of cities employ thousands of people in Clean & Safe-type programs and offer employment to work/release participants using programs tailored to local needs. Almost all are funded through a business improvement district or a mill levy system.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Negotiate and finalize a new Clean & Safe agreement between the City and DDA.
- 2 Rationalize the division of tasks between Clean & Safe and the work/release program. As much as possible, assign Clean & Safe to the non-movable elements of the public realm. Assign moveable elements to work/release.
- 3 As necessary, revise job descriptions through the City’s planned Employee Investment Study and reprioritize duties.
- 4 Find new Clean & Safe employees and nominate work/release participants.
- 5 Become the best.



Responsible Parties

- 1 City: Continue to provide trucks, equipment, benefits and distinctive vests/coats.
- 2 DDA: Provide the bulk of funding.
- 3 Under the City’s and DDA’s example, encourage all private property owners to take better care of their own properties.

Time Allowance

- 1 Negotiate the new City/DDA contract in three weeks.
- 2 Advertise and hire new Clean & Safe employees over three weeks.
- 3 Reach agreements toward a work/release program in six weeks.

Success Metric

- 1 A new City/DDA contract.
- 2 More people working toward a cleaner downtown Cheyenne.
- 3 Improved service.
- 4 Fewer complaints.
- 5 A tidier, more prideful downtown Cheyenne.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Hire new staff @ \$40,000.
- 2 Buy additional equipment @ \$15,000.
- 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$5,500.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Offer better service by increasing staff and equipment. Over time, offer superior service in the public realm and consider offering for-free maintenance services to private property owners too. Encourage Clean & Safe team members (and work/release participants) to become entrepreneurs.

Total Time:
Three months.

Budget:
\$60,500.

Moderately Difficult to Implement DDA 17 Create Functional, Energy-Related Public Art		Project Leader: DDA Logical Partners: Arts Cheyenne, City, State, Educational, Nonprofit and Private Sectors			
Need Boots Walker, Cheyenne’s legendary cowboy singer/songwriter, helps advance history while also promoting western-themed public art. More boots, please! Mr. Walker’s partnership should be expanded from the Cheyenne Depot Museum Foundation and DDA to include Arts Cheyenne, Visit Cheyenne and private businesses. Another theme for public art was advanced in the 2006 <i>Market-Based Downtown Plan</i> by P.U.M.A. – sculpture in the urban landscape that responds to Cheyenne’s almost-constant wind. Energy generated by wind and sun in urban areas is already used to power street lights, phones and computers. There are energy-gathering façades and roofs in both new and rehab buildings. Small wind turbines rotate only three times per minute. Think about the aesthetics of wind power... functional kinetic sculptures, lights that mirror the wind’s intensity, colors that change according to temperature, programmable displays for holidays and every day. Wind art — energy-generating kinetic sculpture — can also become another tourism attraction, not in the countryside but downtown. Remedy The strong prairie wind (that Boots Walker notes in his first song) can be an asset for downtown, A Request-For-Proposals (RFP) issued jointly by DDA and Arts Cheyenne could attract well-known firms, environmental think tanks and artists whose themes encompasses wind and solar power yielding renewable energy. The RFP could require entrants to identify partnerships among businesses, researchers, artists, etc., akin to the National Center for Atmospheric Research (NCAR) joint venture with the State, University of Wyoming, LEADS, Wyoming Business Council, CLF&P and others. Notes In 1886, William Stanley produced enough power to supply one of the nation’s first electric street light systems in Great Barrington, Massachusetts. Many thought Stanley was a crank. Cheyenne could be on to something big.	Specific Tasks 1 Compile existing documents on Cheyenne’s wind and solar energy potential. Focus on the downtown. 2 Write a RFP for multi-disciplined responses to wind and solar energy. Make sure that artists are included. Award bonus points for Wyoming-based submissions. 3 Jury the entrants; select winners. 4 Form an implementation partnership and attract private sector investors. 5 Employ functional art. Monitor energy savings. 6 License the art/energy producing product for sale to others.	Responsible Parties 1 DDA: Promote the idea as a possible source of revenue and as a tool to recruit more downtown merchants and residents. 2 Arts Cheyenne: Oversee the competition and jury. 3 University of Wyoming: Tap into existing programs and researchers. 4 Private investors: Endow the venture for long-term returns. 5 Wyoming energy artists and research companies: Give them more reasons to stay here. (Internet searches are intriguing – and beautiful.)	Time Allowance 1 Research and advance the RFP within three months. 2 Issue the RFP; allow a three month response time. 3 Jury the RFPs over one month. 4 Allow six months for fabrication, testing and installation. 5 Monitor the results over one year... and every year thereafter. 	Success Metric 1 Amount of existing information. 2 Number of RFP responses. 3 Energy savings in demo installations. 4 Angel investor interest. 5 Sales figures. 6 Return on investment.	Budget Allowance 1 Anoint two point-persons for 40 days @ \$300/day = \$12,000. 2 Plan 30 days to develop and issue the RFP @ \$250/day = \$7,500. 3 Award the winning entrant(s) = say... \$25,000? 4 Install = ? 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$4,450 (without ation or ation).
	Next Steps/Future Implications: As technology quickly advances, it will be possible to gather enough energy from wind- and solar-powered sculptures to supply power to downtown businesses and residents. This could be another bonus for relocating to, working in and living downtown. Plan to attract new wind energy researchers and spin-offs as well.	Total Time: About one year.		Budget: ~ \$50,000.	

Launch Shared Food Truck Operations

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: City County Health, Restaurant Owners, Vendors, Entrepreneurs



Need

Anyone who has eaten on Depot Plaza during Cheyenne Frontier Days, Fridays on the Plaza (and other events) knows about food trucks. Catering trucks, BBQ trailers, taco-mobiles or mobile kitchens, are the humble hot dog cart's tony descendents. In the last decade, they have become a rage in urban settings. They depend on foot traffic and are run by start-up entrepreneurs (many of whom eventually open a restaurant or food store). Most offer good food at reasonable prices. In downtown Cheyenne, the concentration of potential lunch-time foot traffic is just a little far from most of the restaurants. Even though it's just a seven-block walk from the Capitol complex or CRMC to 17th Street, few can fit a quick lunch and a 14 block round-trip trek into one hour – especially in the winter. Why not take some of 17th Street's tasty affordable food to the employees just a bit north?

Remedy

DDA should consider launching a shared food truck operation in downtown Cheyenne. Interested restaurateurs, vendors and entrepreneurs could bid on leasing the truck – first-come, first-served. Terms for bids and leases are up for discussion, but a 24-hour period would enable a vendor to offer breakfast, snacks and lunch; take-out dinners are a possibility too. Thus, at least five different cuisines – e.g., pizza or pasta and salads, Chinese, burgers, Thai, Tex-Mex (along with soups and smoothies) – might be available each week. Weekend leases would be encouraged for pancakes, ribs, BBQ, chicken, etc. DDA and the vendors must:

- Agree on lease terms, e.g., times of operation; clean-up and insurance; inspections by health officials, etc.;
- Plan sites for food truck operations complete with power and running water, recepticals for litter, etc.
- Comply with federal, State and local regulations.

Notes

Experience shows that food trucks help build new customer bases for downtown's eat-in restaurants... a great way to engage locals in Cheyenne's growing "foodie" economy.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Seek permissions/requirements/permits from the City County Health Department.
- 2 Search the web for used food trucks.
- 3 Scout possible privately-owned locations for foot traffic, power and running water.
- 4 Prepare an illustrated Questions & Answers (Q&As) and Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) on food truck operations (borrowing heavily from rules and regulations from other cities).
- 5 Call open meetings with restaurant owners, vendors, entrepreneurs, etc.
- 6 Discuss the broad picture... details of operation, terms of operation, etc.
- 7 Solicit proposals; determine levels of interest.
- 8 Acquire the truck.
- 9 Monitor and report the results.



Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA: Advance the idea and become the champion. Follow through.
- 2 City County Health Department: Define the terms of operation.
- 3 Restaurants, vendors, entrepreneurs: Provide the interest and expertise.
- 4 Satisfied customers: They come back often.

Time Allowance

- 1 Dedicate one year for success.

Success Metric

- 1 Number of restaurateurs and vendors expressing interest.
- 2 Response to the initial solicitation.
- 3 Fulfilled five-day operations.
- 4 Fulfilled seven-day operations.
- 5 Available used commercial food trucks.
6. More trucks; more restaurants and food stores.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Plan three weeks of staff time @ \$225/day = \$3,375.
- 2 Find one used food truck @ \$70,000 (versus \$250,000 for an average brick-and-mortar restaurant).
- 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$7,337.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Established restaurateurs may complain at first, but they usually step-up their own game and join in. A shared food truck is an entry point for commercial food trucks, more quality and variety in things to eat, future sit-down restaurants, food stores, more taxable real estate and more employment. In the meantime, what about "stage coach" noon-time rides between the Capitol complex and CRMC to 17th Street?

Total Time:
One year.

Total Budget:
\$80,712.

Maintain Inventories of Available Downtown Spaces

Project Leader: DDA and DCMA (100)
Logical Partners: Cheyenne Board of Realtors



Need

- Anecdotal evidence suggests that downtown residents found their apartments through word-of-mouth or because they rehabilitated ground floor space and decided to live above the store.
- Most downtown office workers need proximity to other businesses or City, County and Wyoming government offices.
- If a commercial prospect were to look for available sites in downtown Cheyenne, they *might* visit DDA's web site, but would probably turn to a broker in search of more complete information.

The DDA maintains a modest list of properties available downtown on its web site but does not link to the Cheyenne Board of Realtors' MLS inventory. And it doesn't reflect the variety or competitiveness of space downtown, with only a few office listings, retail sites and apartments included. Moreover, the information is not that easy to find or read. There needs to be a one-stop clearing house for all downtown space... retail, office and residential, preferably via a partnership among DDA, DCMA and the Cheyenne Board of Realtors (CBR).

Remedy

DDA and DCMA should become a resource for brokering downtown tenancies, including steering prospects to brokers-on-call that can handle inquiries; DDA/DCMA and the Board of Realtors will need to develop a mutually acceptable approach. Currently, the comprehensive Multiple Listing Service (MLS) site can be sorted for downtown by type of tenancy, cost, condition, sale or lease, etc. It should be possible to fashion a beneficial partnership strengthening the central business district of Wyoming's capital that also helps real estate brokers.

Notes

Licensed, professional brokers often offer early insights into communities' economic health: new businesses; new employees; new residents; new opportunities. By working with them, DDA and DCMA can foster more ambassadors for downtown: a win-win idea.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Create a wish-list for an initial meeting with the Cheyenne Board of Realtors. What can DDA offer CBR members? What are some specific opportunities? What elements of *PlanCheyenne* can be leveraged to interest the real estate broker community? How will DDA help increase brokers' incomes?
- 2 Compile separate lists of every advantage to downtown tenancy and/or residency.
- 3 Schedule the meeting at CBR's offices. Propose a memorandum of understanding (MOU).
- 4 Arrange invitations for downtown's major brokers – all of them – to a second meeting/presentation.
- 5 Negotiate and sign the MOU.
- 6 Implement the MOU. Keep it active over the long-term.

Responsible Parties

- 1 DDA/DCMA: Spearhead the initiative and stick with it.
- 2 CBR: Provide all updates from MLS.
- 3 Downtown's broker community: Help drum-up more business.

Time Allowance

- 1 One month to prepare for the partnership meeting.
- 2 Two months to sign the MOU and get busy.

Success Metric

- 1 A signed MOU.
- 2 Increased downtown tenancies.
- 3 More buzz about downtown.
- 4 More tenancies.
- 5 More DDA members.
- 6 A stronger DCMA.
- 7 An emerging Downtown Cheyenne Residents' Association (Strategy 5).

Budget Allowance

- 1 Research and negotiate the MOU over ten days @ \$250/day = \$2,500
- 2 Maintain downtown's MLS sorting site in twelve days annually @ \$250/day = \$3,000.
- 3 Hold an annual presentation and reception for CRB = \$2,000.
- 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$750.

Next Steps/Future Implications: CBR and DDA/DCMA should work closely in targeting new retail, office and residential tenancies in downtown's rehabilitated historic fabric and new, infill development (Strategies 8 and 14, among others).

Total Time:
Three months.

Budget:
\$8,250.

Enlist Downtown Stakeholders to Recruit Business

Project Leader: DDA
Logical Partners: All Those Interested in Downtown Revitalization



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Placemaking (and other recent plans) produced an impressive list of what people want downtown: specific retailers, restaurants, services, etc. from next door (e.g., Dell Range) and faraway (e.g., Monrovia, California). This keen interest should be encouraged and harnessed to help fill downtown’s empty spaces. Attracting more merchants and many more office workers could be assisted by a volunteer cadre of downtown’s champions. Remedy In a series of facilitated sessions, stakeholders could be trained by local economic development leaders – the Chamber, Visit Cheyenne, LEADS, etc. – to prioritize, polish and perfect their wish-lists. The volunteers will be paid with full-value, 20 percent (or higher) Boots Bucks and/or Positively Cheyenne coupons good at downtown merchants. Among other tasks, stakeholders could: • Interview existing downtown merchants with professionally-prepared templates. Compare notes with other volunteers. Compile the results; • Help assemble an on-going inventory of all available downtown space (Strategy 19). How many square feet? Where? What’s the physical condition? Who’s the broker? Who’s the owner? • Start a public “I wish this was...” sticker campaign on vacant storefront windows and compile the results; • Research each target: history; headquarters; near-by stores or offices; population thresholds; Dun & Bradstreet rating, etc. Edit and test the recruiting case statement; • Advocate for City, County and Wyoming incentives to attract merchants and office tenants; • Conduct welcome wagon tours for prospective businesses and their employees. Notes Turn the wish-lists into reality. Home-grown activism has worked elsewhere and can yield good results for downtown Cheyenne.	1 Collect a list of all 400+ participants to Downtown Historic Placemaking, <i>PlanCheyenne</i>, <i>Vision 2020</i>, <i>Progress & Prosperity</i>, etc. 2 Gather and collate past wish-lists for specific retailers, office tenants and day-to-day services. 3 Compile an overview of current work being done in recruiting merchants and office tenants. 4 Write a mission statement with achievable goals and clear objectives. Broadcast it to all past participants. 5 Issue invitations to at least three different exercises: one for merchants or retail services; one for office tenants; one for needed professional services. 6 Outline the intent. Recruit volunteers. 7 Get busy! 8 Refine the process. Repeat at least once every year.	1 DDA: Originate the idea and advance it. Follow-through in every aspect. Coordinate merchant and tenant recruitment efforts. Stage the exercise annually. 2 “Paid” volunteers: Provide leads and do the leg work.	1 Set aside four weeks to gather all background material. 2 Plan on three weeks to organize the orientation events. 3 Follow-up with merchant and office recruiters over one year.	1 General agreement to pursue the idea. 2 Assembling the library of all past economic development studies/ideas and specific wish-lists. 3 Completing the mission statement. 4 Number of potential volunteers at each meeting. 5 Confirmed volunteers in each task. 6 Number of initial contacts and interest. 7 Number of businesses attracted to downtown Cheyenne.	1 Commit 35 days @ \$250/day = \$8,750. 2 Allow \$3,500 for meeting expenses. 3 Assume 25 volunteers at ten hours each = \$2,500 in Boots Bucks and Positively Cheyenne coupons. 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,475.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Think of this as an annual event for all of downtown’s stakeholders. Raise the bar each time. Become more ambitious, aggressive and competitive.		Total Time: Two months.		Budget: \$16,225.

Historic Placemaking Strategies

City of Cheyenne

Lead Organization for Implementation



Hide the “Hole”

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA and City Contractors



Need		Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
The Hole is known statewide as “Cheyenne’s perpetual eyesore.” By far, it’s the most frequent complaint about downtown Cheyenne... and has been since 2004 when a fire gutted Mary’s Bake Shoppe and other historic storefronts between the Hynds Building and Wyoming Home. The site’s multi-party ownership pattern complicates any quick resolution of what to do next; national economic uncertainty hasn’t helped. What could be done to quickly spruce up a major vehicular entry into downtown? What needs to enhance the pedestrian’s experience between the sparkling LightsOn! installation on the first floor of the Hynds and the retail draws at Wyoming Home, Lincolnway’s “Women’s Block” and Wrangler – to say nothing of the view from the Atlas Theater? Remedy The City must lead a short-term effort to camouflage this long-standing eyesore. In partnership with DDA, the City should embark on a quick, inexpensive, highly-visible and media-worthy event by installing a three-story, three dimensional stage set façade on the north side of Lincolnway between Hynds and Wyoming Home. This façade –placed on public property (the sidewalk) – might reflect Beaux Arts, Early Commercial, Late Victorian or even Moderne styles of architecture. In fact, several different stage set facades could be used to test public reaction and provide guidance on the eventual design of a permanent replacement on the site (Strategy 27). Show windows could contain merchandise from several downtown retailers. Carefully designed, the façade might even provide very small spaces for pop-up retail. This is a temporary installation – just until a new, permanent development gets underway. It’s quick and simple. Notes Anything that addresses conditions affecting public reaction to downtown Cheyenne – especially those recognized statewide as embarrassments – needs to be pursued and faster is better. Plus, there’s a precedent for temporary façades just several blocks away – the Cheyenne Gunslingers stage set on 15th Street at Pioneer.		1 Measure and photograph the site. 2 Photoshop after versions of the site with several versions of a false façade. 3 Seek approvals, commission a designer, complete designs and advertise for a contractor. 4 Authorize construction. 5 Work toward a permanent, fully-tenanted structure by 2015.	1 City: Remove the “perpetual eyesore.” This is a genuine public service. 2 DDA: Prove abilities to address simple solutions to a multi-year, top-of-list concern. 3 Contractors: Use under-contract and on-call vendors. They are happy to be of service.	1 Measure, photograph and Photoshop the site in one day. 2 Design an infill façade in one day. 3 Solicit vendors and contractors in three days. 4 Construct the façade in ten days. 5 Illuminate the façade in one day. 6 Hold a media event and ceremonial ribbon-cutting in one day. 7 Complete well-before Cheyenne Frontier Days 2013. 8 Work toward a permanent infill solution by CFD 2015.	1 Completion at the earliest possible date – before CFD 2013. 2 Public applause and good media reports. 3 Fill the Hole with a permanent, tenanted structure by 2015.	1 Commission the façade design @ \$3,000. 2 Inspect and survey the sidewalk @ \$500. 3 Build the façade on-site @ \$32,500. 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$3,600.
		Next Steps/Future Implications: Hide the Hole is the first step toward a final goal... fill the Hole. This is not a permanent solution, but it shows that the City and DDA can take coordinated action toward implementing more important things – the utility corridor, retrofitting Hynds and major infill development in the Hole itself.		Total Time: One month, starting now!		Budget: \$39,600.

Click and Complain: Enhance the City’s “Request Partner” System

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA



Need

Downtown Cheyenne’s stakeholders routinely notice (mostly) minor maintenance issues requiring attention by the City or other public agency partners – from potholes and bent signs to cracked sidewalks and curbs. Every day that passes without visible progress making repairs increases frustration. It also diminishes faith in the public sector and enjoyment of downtown.



Some observers contact responsible parties by phone or by using the City’s “Request Partner” system. But too few are aware of this system; without a mechanism for direct feedback, voicing concerns can feel like shouting into the wind. Many communities have created a suite of tools to facilitate the process whereby citizens report a problem, receive acknowledgement and an indication of when remedial action will occur. This is followed by a final contact when work is complete.

Many cities rely on low- or no-cost Internet solutions provided by SeeClickFix.com or Open311.org which offers ways to help citizens help their communities. However, Cheyenne also needs a pro-active approach to supplement ad hoc citizen reports. Ideally, downtown Cheyenne’s stewards would be encouraged to notice and report such matters via appropriate channels.

Remedy

This strategy encompasses three actions:

- Encourage use of the existing web-based “Request Partner” system. Insert notices in all Board of Public Utilities (BOPU) statements and Cheyenne Light, Fuel & Power (CLF&P) bills;
- Promote a 311-style approach, using downtown as the test case before rolling out the “Click a Concern” system City-wide;
- Hold public walkabouts; invite interested citizens to join officials in a tour of favorite irritants – dirty tree grates, blocked drains, full trash bins, etc. Officials could arrange for repair on-the-spot or contact the appropriate party for attention later on... all the while educating the public about who does what.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Compile a comprehensive list of who does what in downtown’s public realm. Study the current system for overlaps, gaps or unclear, unclaimed responsibilities and clues for more efficient operations. Design and print an attractive leaflet giving contact numbers for sidewalks, curbs, street signs, trash bins, etc. Distribute the leaflet touting the “Request Partner” system via BOPU and CLF&P bills within two months. Insert reminder leaflets several times each year.
- 2 Allow six months for downtown Cheyenne’s 311 system to be up-and-running. (Over 100 cities offer non-emergency 311 service, from San Francisco to Shertz, Texas. One place installed their 311 system in eleven minutes.)
- 3 Schedule public walkabouts each spring; note every plus and minus in downtown’s public realm. With clipboards, cameras and cell phones in-hand, elected officials will guide the tours with agency heads, property owners, tenants and other downtown stakeholders to list every item in need of attention – lamp posts, bike racks, benches, banners, historic plaques, parking signs, etc. Three-months’ planning is needed. Answer all complaints at least two weeks before CFD 2013.

Responsible Parties

- 1 City: Prepare the leaflets. Stage and monitor the walkabouts. Investigate 311 systems. It’s useful to note the good and not-so-good in private properties abutting the public realm too.
- 2 DDA: Build shared accountability between the City and DDA. In time, leaflets, walkabouts and downtown’s 311 system should become DDA’s projects.
- 3 WYDOT: Downtown’s major arteries – Lincolnway and the Warren/Central couplet – are WYDOT’s jurisdiction.

Time Allowance

- 1 Research, design and print the “Request Partner” leaflet within two weeks.
- 2 Arrange to insert the leaflet in all BOPU and CLF&P bills within two weeks. Decide on a regular cycle for repeat – and updated – leaflet inserts.
- 3 Establish full “Response Partner” awareness and 311 service within three months.

Success Metric

- 1 Increased number of calls resulting from greater knowledge of the “Request Partner” system.
- 2 Increasing number of citizens attending each walkabout. Number and import of items noted on each walkabout. Success shows greater attention to smaller details.
- 3 Decrease in response time to resolve each issue.
- 4 Over time, fewer 311 calls because everyone is doing their job.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Determine who does what (and who *should* do what) in ten staff days = no cost.
- 2 Design leaflets in five designer days and five staff days @ \$250/day = \$2,500.
- 3 Research 311 in two staff days = no cost.
- 4 Prep and supply walkabouts = \$2,000.
- 5 Install 311 = \$1,000.
- 6 Monitor as on-going shared City/DDA function = no cost.
- 7 Budget for immediate repairs @ \$45,000.
- 8 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$5,050.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Widespread use of this three-part package will result in a surge of to-dos... people testing the City’s commitment; citizens discovering ways to address long-time issues. What remedies will be most-visible and cost-effective? The goal is to enhance the public realm. Payback is more satisfied citizens with greater pride and engagement.

Total Time:
 Three months,
 starting now!

Budget:
 \$55,550.



Convene a Downtown Planning Summit for Today's Stakeholders

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA



Need

Widespread community participation is a touchstone in Cheyenne: witness *Vision 2020*; *Progress and Prosperity*, and; *Plan Cheyenne...* Community leaders and involved citizens tackle issues and create notable achievements. It's time to deploy that energy and experience to benefit downtown: the home base for the State, Laramie County, all City agencies, the library, Civic Center, the Cheyenne Regional Medical Center and the economic development triad of Visit Cheyenne, Cheyenne LEADS, and the Chamber. Over 50 statewide professional groups maintain offices near the Capitol. Employees supporting these activities comprise about half of the 16,400 office workers in downtown Cheyenne. Downtown also hosts major civic events: arts and crafts shows; heritage fairs; parades; and festivals like Cheyenne Frontier Days...

Over time, coordination improves as participants share information, plan together, and explore partnerships that collectively conserve public funds. Right now parallel efforts are underway to:

- attract job candidates and, at the same time, provide superior housing options leading to shorter employee commutes;
- encourage more growth downtown, e.g., by using brownfields mitigation to make more land available;
- leverage the proposed public safety building;
- investigate joint-use utility cores to help attract development and encourage historic property rehabilitation.

But each action by existing stakeholders appears to be happening in a solitary silo... contrary to Cheyenne tradition.

Remedy

The City should convene a formal, public downtown planning summit. Initial topics will include such issues affecting downtown Cheyenne as: land assembly; new construction; retrofit of historic fabric; making wise choices the path of least regulatory resistance. Discussions will likely yield a number of what-ifs, answered only by inviting more people to a subsequent summit geared toward coordination and strategy refinement.

Notes

Home-grown, whole-community discussion is the tradition in Cheyenne. Revive it and focus on downtown.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Select a target season and date for the summit.
- 2 Develop a format – day of the week; place(s); time(s); meals; speakers; moderators, etc.; create an agenda – which might include break-out sessions on:
 - Communications, inclusion and outreach;
 - Downtown economic development through retail, offices, housing options, etc.;
 - Energy efficiency, wind and solar generation and LEED certification;
 - Health and fitness;
 - Historic, natural and cultural resources;
 - Land uses – built space, open space, connectivity, the skyline, dark skies, etc.;
 - Laramie County, State of Wyoming and federal partnerships;
 - Transportation, access, parking, bikeways, etc.
- 3 Begin discussions about how to celebrate Cheyenne's 150th birthday.
- 4 Enlist the best outside facilitator(s). Enlist the best proceedings recorder(s). Consider hiring a keep-it-on-focus referee.
- 5 Invite a cross section of Cheyenne's (and Wyoming's) best.
- 6 Participate.
- 7 Consider the results and take action.
- 8 Plan and focus the second Summit.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Downtown planning summits should take place annually in the foreseeable future. The private sector will become increasingly involved. With success, these summits may be held twice annually as “developers’ forums,” melding public and private interests toward improving downtown Cheyenne.

Responsible Parties

- 1 City: Convene and produce the first summit. Over time, other stakeholders – notably, DDA – will take the reins.
- 2 Rotate summit leadership among other project partners – DDA, Laramie County, Cheyenne Regional Medical Center, the State of Wyoming, Visit Cheyenne, Chamber of Commerce, Cheyenne LEADS...

Time Allowance

- 1 Allow three months of high level outreach to potential participants.
- 2 Plan on two months to detail and stage the summit.

Success Metric

- 1 Number of participants at the first summit.
- 2 Number of participants at the second summit.
- 3 Number of people who want to become involved.
- 4 Resulting actions, participation and value added to downtown.

Budget Allowance

- 1 Plan and produce the first summit in 30 staff days = no cost.
- 2 Hire facilitators, recorders and referees for three pre- and post-days each @ \$750/day = \$20,250.
- 3 Arrange space, food service, supplies, etc. = \$3,000.
- 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$2,325.

Total Time:
Five months;
aim for mid-2013.

Budget:
\$25,575.

Implement the Next Steps in *PlanCheyenne*

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: MPO, SHPO and CHPB



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
The Chamber spearheaded <i>Vision 2020</i> in 2001. Five years later, the <i>Market-Based Downtown Plan</i> outlined the economics of downtown revitalization. Recently, <i>PlanCheyenne</i> identified downtown as a major focus. Cheyenne’s newly adopted Unified Development Code (UDC) sets design standards for some areas of the City. Now is the time to combine all of these ideas and tackle a comprehensive approach to downtown. Remedy Begin with three new sets of design and building guidelines: - First, guidelines for new construction within the CBD. This district offers the greatest flexibility of land use and the highest density in the City. - Second, guidelines for new construction within downtown’s historic district calling for sensitivity to the context of older buildings’ height, design details and materials. Some of these new guidelines might be translated from DDA’s existing guidelines. - Third, design and building guidelines for certified historic rehabilitation and retrofit of buildings listed as part of the downtown historic district. These structures must have their own set of reasonable and easily achievable design guidelines and building codes, again using DDA’s guidelines as a template. This third set will also use the Secretary of the Interior’s <i>Standards</i> and the new <i>Guidelines on Sustainability</i>. Notes There will always be philosophical differences on design and building guidelines – development standards. However, to encourage investment of millions in private dollars, Cheyenne needs to create an environment that provides certainty to investors. Few cities have the opportunity to create something entirely new in design and building guidelines. It’s appropriate that the award-winning <i>PlanCheyenne</i> will prompt other awards – rational, easy-to-use and completely sustainable guidelines for rehab, new construction and infill.	1 Research emerging guideline trends nationwide. For new construction and infill, look to form-based codes, smart codes and the US Green Building Council. For rehabilitation, research the National Park Services’ Technical Preservation Services. 2 For new and infill construction, compare Cheyenne’s existing standards and guidelines with models found in the above research. Mix and match. Be inventive. Make the standards fit Cheyenne. 3 Prepare a first draft for new and infill construction. Gather input from DDA’s Design Committee. 4 Prepare a second draft. Look for public approval and official adoption. 5 Start the process again with a focus on downtown’s historic core, using DDA’s design guidelines as a template. 6 Prepare a first draft for historic rehabilitation. Gather input from DDA’s Design Committee, Wyoming’s State Historic Preservation Office and CHPB. 7 Prepare a second draft. Look for public approval and official adoption. 8 Implement all sets of design and building guidelines.	1 City: Authorize the work. Provide personnel and support. 2 MPO: Provide personnel, advice and support. 3 SHPO: Assist with the rehab and infill guidelines. 4 CHPB: Provide back-up and advice on the rehab and infill guidelines. 5 Public: Provide input and support.	1 Plan on one year from start to completion.	1 Authorization of the work. 2 Broad participation throughout. 3 Responses to the first drafts. Responses to the final drafts. 4 Guidelines being translated into adopted codes. 5 Replication elsewhere.	1 Assign one full-time staff person for one year with all support = \$10,000. 2 Expect \$20,000 for outside opinions/input. 4 Allow \$5,000 for public input. 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$3,500.
Next Steps/Future Implications: Once again, here is an opportunity for Cheyenne to create another first... perhaps the “Cheyenne Guidelines” and then the “Cheyenne Codes.”			Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$38,500.

Plan for Major Downtown Infill Development

Project Leader City
Logical Partners MPO, DDA and the public



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Avoiding sprawl and its infrastructure costs and reviving downtown while accommodating population growth entails thoughtful reuse of buildings and under-utilized land. At least 100,000 SF of historic fabric remains vacant, ready for rehabilitation, retrofit and reuse. Within 63 City blocks – from 15th to 24th and Capitol to Snyder – 35 acres are vacant (not including streets). Twelve acres – 35 percent – are owned by the public; 65 percent is held by only 42 individuals. Cheyenne can leverage these assets to create a cooperative plan for rehab, reuse and new construction without displacing any businesses homes or churches: a new town, downtown. Remedy Letting real estate market forces play out retards infill and redevelopment. The most effective intervention is to forge a private/public partnership to: • Begin with “Drawings, Designs and Dreams” (Strategy 7). Incorporate concepts from Strategies 11 through 14. • Consider the benefits of a community land trust (Strategy 33). Use the historic rehab investment consortium and the proposed “synthetic” tax credit (Strategies 35 through 37). • Blend new construction and historic rehab. Create vistas from the near west side to the Capitol and Depot Plaza. Create a signature skyline. • Design new vehicular access from Missile Drive into downtown, easing congestion on Lincolnway. Add bikeways and greenways between MLK Park and Holliday Park. Plan a downtown “Central Park” with the old steam plant as centerpiece. Use Crow Creek as an amenity. Add recreation and healthy activities. Provide more housing options. Add affordable office and retail space. Find places for the grocery store (Strategy 9), the “Idea Lab” (Strategy 11), the artists’ co-op (Strategy 38) and high-tech and energy companies that provide employment opportunities.	1 Open public discussion toward a new town, downtown. 2 Adopt major downtown infill as a Cheyenne 150 goal (Strategy 41). 3 Factually, systematically determine how many square feet of vacant historic buildings and how much under-used land exists (an extension of Strategy 8 and Strategy 19). Who owns what? Are all taxes and permits current? What’s the status of leases, liens, etc.? Are there private or public records of each building’s structural suitability? 4 On several overlays, map all ownerships, rights-of-way, streets, etc. Imagine an almost blank canvas. 5 Invite public ideas in charrettes. Start with drawings, design and dreams (Strategy7), MPO plans, bikeway and pedestrian plans, landscape studies, etc. Build consensus. 6 Notify neighboring property owner of potential plans. 7 Propose and open a RFQ/RFP process for “master” planner and developer. Invite for-profits, nonprofits, public agencies, etc. 8 Jury the results. Decide how best to proceed.	1 City: Commit to and oversee the entire process. Begin by establishing the policy that Cheyenne infills on vacant land and reuses historic fabric to counter sprawl. Become an equity partner. 2 MPO: Participate fully. Provide expertise. Manage the process. 3 DDA: Take part and advocate. If possible, become an equity partner. 4 Public: Participate. 5 Developers: Produce a superior real estate product.	1 Target Cheyenne 150 for first phase completion – five years.	1 Completion of all background analyses. 2 Consensus for moving ahead. 3 Response to RFQ/RFP process. 4 Negotiation of agreements. 5 Start of infill and rehab. 6 Ribbon cuttings and occupancy. 7 Number of new residents, businesses and employees.	1 Conduct initial research and assessment in nine months = ~\$100,000. 2 Allow one month for initial public input = ~\$20,000. 3 Achieve public consensus in two months = \$10,000. 4 Issue RFQ/RFP documents over 30 days @ \$275/day = \$8,250. 5 Invite a national/international jury to recommend awards = \$50,000. 6 Issue contracts to proceed as the prize. 7 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$18,825.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Re-imagine DDA as a redevelopment agency, using existing powers to acquire, form partnerships and accomplish major infill, rehab and new construction. Is this an opportunity to make downtown the purview of a Joint Powers Board?		Total Time: Five years.		Total Budget: \$207,075.

Revisit Downtown’s Parking Fee Structure

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA/DCMA, CTP, Visit Cheyenne, the Chamber



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Many Placemaking interviews lasted <i>exactly</i> two hours due to downtown’s parking regulations. Free parking is a nice amenity, but it engenders anxiety about incurring a \$10 ticket for exceeding the two-hour limit. The garage also angst-ridden. Parking in downtown Cheyenne calls for strategic management. To provide better management, improve parking turnover and generate more revenue, many cities opt for pay-station technology. Solar-powered, electronic meters accept coins, tokens, credit cards, etc. Usually, one pay-station serves up to twelve spaces. A customer pays; the pay-station prints a receipt; the receipt is displayed on the dashboard for easy monitoring. It shows time-in, amount of time purchased and expected time-out. Pay-station technology allows management to program varying rates – the most desirable places at certain times, hour-of-the-day, season... even free. Most cities recoup the cost of pay-stations within three years. Remedy The City should test pay-stations (perhaps in the eight-blocks (76 block faces) bounded by Thomes, Lincolnway, Central and 18th) expanding them to all lots and garages if they prove advantageous, and: • Issue monthly (or annual) parking tags at reduced rates for use on-street or in City lots/garages and monitor their use to discourage violations; • Through DCMA, offer pay-station tokens to merchants so they can reward frequent shoppers; • Remove parking signs to improve curb appeal. Charging a modest fee of 25¢ per hour would generate over \$200,000 and pay for itself in one year. Notes Some up-scale suburban shopping malls are installing pay-station technology. To combat meter “feeding,” fees could increase with each time unit purchased.	1 Research precedents in other cities. Determine best-practices as well as pitfalls to avoid. Ask for recommendations on manufacturers and maintenance agreements. 2 Compare manufacturers’ specifications. 3 Test proposals with DCMA member and all merchants. 4 Discuss pay-station technology with Visit Cheyenne and the Chamber. What inventive programs will make it easy for residents and visitors to understand and use? 5 In the meantime, thoroughly investigate the numbers, costs, locations and impacts of parking for downtown’s 16,400 employees. Could there be special parking zones and rates for car-poolers? Could a Cheyenne Transit Program offer eShuttle service from some areas to employment centers via high-frequency, demand-responsive vans? 6 With Council’s approval, prepare a Request for Proposals (RFP) for pay-station providers. 7 Install pay-stations. Remove existing signage. 8 Test close-in park-and-ride for employees. 9 Monitor results and revenues. 10 Decide what to do with extra revenue.	1 City: Implement pay-station technology as a public service and an additional source of public revenue. Carefully explain where, why and how-to to the public (perhaps in statements from the Board of Public Utilities and CLF& P). 2 DDA and Visit Cheyenne: Monitor the program. 3 DCMA: Promote pay-stations and gather merchant support. 4 CTP: Test the park-and-ride and eShuttle.	1 Research the technology and prepare pro forma over four weeks. 2 Prepare a show-and-tell for DDA, merchants and DCMA in three weeks. 3 Propose the system in City Council in two weeks. 4 Conduct RFQ/RFP within six weeks. 5 Select vendor over one week. 6 Accept delivery and install within one year.	1 Positive cash flow in the very short term. 2 Merchant acceptance. 3 Patron acceptance. 4 Visitor acceptance. 5 Program expansion.	1 Complete research, prepare pro forma, make show-and-tell presentations, etc., in 30 staff days @ \$300/day = \$9,000. 2 Prepare RFQ/RFP in five staff days @ \$250/day = \$1,250. 3 Buy and install 76 pay-stations @ \$6,200 each = \$471,200. 4 Remove parking signs and repaint parking spaces = \$25,000. 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$50,645.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Most communities nationwide see improvements in revenues and customer satisfaction, including decreased anxiety. Pay-stations should be implemented on all downtown streets, parking lots and garages.		Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$557, 095, pre-revenue.



Fill the “Hole”

Project Leader: City and DDA
Logical Partners: The Entire Community



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Several Placemaking proposals could together spark a new gateway on and near downtown’s 100 percent corner – Capitol and Lincolnway. The City owns some of the land; the City and WDOT control rights-of-way. Adjacent property owners are active in DDA and downtown’s most iconic merchant is across the street, as is Depot Plaza and the historic Atlas. Plus, there’s an emerging retail niche to the west. The Plains Hotel, the parking garage and transit center are all one block away... as are Dinneen and Grier’s. Remedy Make filling the Hole overwhelmingly appealing. The City and DDA could initiate discussions on filling the Hole while embarking on major an adaptive reuse of the Hynds and appealing to nearby property owners. • Build one utility core to serve new construction in the Hole as well as retrofit of the Hynds. Connect other historic buildings to it. • Assemble parcels via a community land trust (Strategy 33). Develop a partnership to fund new construction (Strategy 25). Fine-tune the streamlined approval/permit process (Strategy 29). • Use the investment consortium to fund the Hynds (and other nearby buildings). Take advantage of the tax credit and use the revolving loan fund (Strategies 35 through 37). Improve nearby historic façades and take easements (Strategy 28). • Tenant the Hynds and infill with the food co-op (Strategy 9), the nonprofit artists’ co-op (Strategy 38), the Idea Lab (Strategy 11), start-up energy and tech-related businesses, loft residences... • Landscape the area per DeBoer’s 1919 tree plan (Strategy 31). Illuminate facades (Strategy 3) with energy-generating public art (Strategy 17). Notes This is a significant civic undertaking akin to a sports arena or public park which will be in use 24/ 7/365 and serve as a catalyst for the rest of downtown.	1 Adopt “Fill the ‘Hole’” as a civic priority. Organize think-and-act sessions. Build leadership in the private and public sectors. Mount a public awareness campaign and develop broad grass-roots support. Gather support from the County and the State. 2 Charter a public benefit development corporation – a coalition of nonprofits and the private sector. Direct it to form broad partnerships, acquire property rights, finance, design and rehabilitate/construct the mixed-use, mixed-income project. 3 Assemble a brilliant administrative team for the public benefit corporation. 4 Work with nearby property owners and determine their interest in joining forces. 5 Work with WYDOT on vehicular access and pedestrian amenities along Lincolnway – especially from Warren to Thomes (modeled after the excellent work in front of Dinneen’s). 6 In every way, encourage the artists’ co-op, food store, Idea Lab, business incubator and other nonprofit tenancies. 7 Define financing tool(s) and secure funding. 8 Stick to the idea. Follow-through every aspect. 9 Move the stage set façades that were hiding the Hole to other locations.	1 City and DDA: Champion the idea. Charter the corporation. Hand off to the nonprofit and private sectors through the public benefit development corporation.	1 Consider the options and charge ahead within two months. 2 Charter the public benefit corporation and recruit staff over four months. 3 Refine the project – tenants, financing, design parameters – within six months. 4 Break ground within twelve months. 5 Cut ribbons within three years – just in time for Cheyenne’s 150th birthday.	1 Civic receptivity to the proposal. Ongoing interest and support. 2 Broad participation throughout. 3 Media attention. 4 Ground-breaking(s). 5 Grand opening(s).	Assume start-up costs for the first year only will be the City’s and DDA’s responsibility. Hand off to the public benefit corporation. 1 Prepare background materials, conceptual designs and promotions @ \$50,000. 2 Assign City, DDA and MPO staff time at a blended rate of \$275/day for 175 days = \$48,125. 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$9,812. 4 Prepare as many grant proposals as it takes to get things moving. 5 Proceed with construction.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Fill the Hole becomes downtown Cheyenne’s 150 th birthday gift to itself – a signature project combining historic rehab, infill, carefully-crafted “new west” architecture, an artists’ co-op and food store, the Idea Lab business incubator, an eastern anchor for the new town, downtown... A civic pat-on-the-back is well deserved! Happy Birthday!	Total Time: Three years.		Budget: \$107,937, plus construction.	

Implement a Façade Easement Program

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA, CHPB, SHPO, WBC and Property Owners



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
At least a dozen buildings in downtown Cheyenne <i>may</i> have been clad with inappropriate siding, potentially obscuring interesting historic façades have behind aluminum or plaster. It’s time to investigate. Disrobe these structures, refurbish the exteriors and return elevations as fully-contributing members to downtown’s streetscape – and the National Register district—with the protection they need and deserve. Remedy Cheyenne’s Historic Preservation Board and DDA must partner and list historic buildings that may be hiding behind false fronts. There are candidates along Lincolnway, 17th, 18th and elsewhere. Several may make good case studies. The best buildings may be vacant and/or have absentee owners. - Expand DDA’s Capital Improvement Grant Program (CIG) to include façades and façade easement work. - Propose an 18-month program to Wyoming Business Council (WBC) to leverage DDA funding: - Assume \$250,000 for ten façade grants. - Require recipients to absorb cost over runs – up to \$75,000. Administer rehab via DDA, CHPB, DDA, Main Street – any nonprofit. Deed the completed façade to the nonprofit as a permanent easement. - Use the federal income tax credit as a benefit for the original owners – possibly up to \$20,000 per building and façade. Require that all work be completed within 18 months. - Make grants based on CHPB, DDA and SHPO recommendations and encourage building owners to consider full-building rehab.	- Research easement precedents nationally and locally. Modify DDA’s CIG grant program to allow façade work and easements to be held by DDA or other non-profits. - As a team, approach the Wyoming Business Council to leverage DDA’s CIG funds. Follow up with the Legislature if necessary. - Prioritize façades that may be hiding something, e.g., by researching old photos. - Contact owners. If they agree... Drill test holes. Peek inside false fronts and determine salvage potential. At the same time, use a walk-through to examine structural condition, adaptive reuse potential, etc. Determine if the project makes financial sense – both outside and inside? If yes... - Draw up a contract with the owner. Encourage the owner to consider full-building rehabilitation. Proceed. - Complete the work. Illuminate the façades. - Use the proposed tenant recruitment programs to populate the finished project (Strategies 11 - 14). Monitor results in spin-off projects in adjacent buildings and blocks. Develop a return-on-investment formula. - Move to the next façade. Expand the program in downtown Cheyenne and to Wyoming’s Main Street communities.	- CHPB and DDA: Originate the program. Promote it. Recruit and maintain partners. - Partners: Assist in historic research, prioritization, WBC application, lobbying, working with owners and contractors, engineers, architects, potential tenants, etc. - Owners: Dare to be the first to donate a façade easement. Enjoy the tax credit.	- Revise DDA grant program over two months. Select target buildings in one month. - Discuss issues with partners in one month. - Draft WBC grant application according to pre-determined schedule. Achieve funding in six months. - Select target façades over one month. - Negotiate with owners over one month. - Complete the first façade within six months.	- Approval by DDA’s board to expand the CIG grant program. - Successful joint application to WBC. - Number of façade improvements and easements donated via DDA and WBC funding. - Owner participation. - Expansion of the program – statewide and with more dollars.	- Treat all background research, partner negotiation, etc., as volunteer or paid staff time dedicated to the program = 0. - Allot staff time over 60 days @ \$225/day = \$13,500. - Produce promo materials @ \$5,000. - Prepare legal documents (easements, etc.) @ \$15,000. - Peek inside of ten facades @ \$3,000/façade = \$30,000. - Implement on ten façades @\$25,000 per façade = \$250,000. - Add contingency @ ten percent = \$31,350.
Notes There are many successful façade improvement and easement programs but combining the two is a novel approach (Rawlins is investigating). CHPB, DDA and its partners can use existing resources to get started.	Next Steps/Future Implications: Like the synthetic tax credit for whole-building rehab (Strategy 35), this strategy creates permanent value for building owners, DDA and CHPB.		Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$344,850, all inclusive.

Streamline and Coordinate the Permitting Process

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: Outside Experts



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Complaints about the building permit process in Cheyenne – especially for historic preservation and retrofit – focus on conflicting, unclear language and differing interpretations, at different times, from different – or the same -- departments. Frustration must not be part of downtown’s rebirth. Adopting the Unified Development Code – another step in <i>PlanCheyenne</i> – eases some confusion. However, owners can be dazed by mechanical, energy, fire prevention, historic and streetscape requirements. It’s no solace that all codes and ordinances are for greater public safety. Remedy There are talented people in most City offices. Instruct them to 1) think and work together, 2) disassemble the building permit process and 3) reassemble it with the end users – developers, builders, investors – at top-of-mind. They are the customers. The City has services to sell (and its own economic well-being to consider. For example, there should be only <i>one</i> place to start applications for historic rehabilitation, adaptive reuse, infill and new construction. For now, that is City Hall in Planning & Development. If a prospective project comes to a broker or outside organization, they must know to point that lead toward P&D. • Prepare a downtown development guide(s) in plain English with permitting and approval processes diagramed using simple flow charts. • Add a “How do I...?” button to the City’s web site, specifically for downtown development. • Provide alternatives within the code to encourage innovation. Notes This situation is not unique to Cheyenne. (Some are worse.) But many have streamlined and coordinated the building approvals and permitting process. Cheyenne must follow suit.	1 Conduct public workshops on building code interpretation specific to rehabilitation and retrofit of historic properties. Listen to complaints. Identify common hurdles and stumbling blocks. Propose innovations and alternatives to satisfy all life/safety issues. 2 Use the results of the workshops to propose and adopt new codes as necessary. Specify innovative techniques to meet the intent of the code. 3 Re-engineer the building approval and permitting process, including duties and responsibilities of all City offices including: Attorney; Board of Public Utilities; Building Permits; City-County Development; Engineer; Housing and Community Development; Planning; Public Works; Traffic; Transportation; Zoning. 4 Set a completion date and stick to it. 5 Expect that not all department heads will be available for each meeting. Select alternate representatives. 6 Think and act like a jury: retire to a private room (no electronic devices); elect a fore-person; review the facts on both sides of the case; dissect the evidence; reach a conclusion; vote on a verdict; report out. 7 Deliver a draft to Council and test the results.	1 City: Make this an in-house job (as much as possible) following input from the public workshops.	1 Let the “jury” decide – probably in six months. Less time is better.	1 Number of citizens attending public workshops. 2 Participation in the workshops by as many decision-makers as possible. 3 In-house meeting attendance records. 4 Interim reports. 5 Levels of agreement among City staff. 6 Receptivity and approval by City Council. 7 Increased number of buildings rehabilitated and retrofitted. 8 Public appreciation and thanks.	1 Assume a six month schedule @ two sessions each month for eleven departments at \$250/day = an astonishing \$264,000. However, all participants are City employees. This is part of their job. Thus, allocate nothing. 2 Allow \$10,000 for outside expert advice and review. 3 Plan on expenses @ \$4,500. 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,450.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: The downtown development handbook and web site button should be expanded to cover every neighborhood in Cheyenne. Over time, consider adding a concierge-type ambassador for all things bricks-and-mortar in downtown. Make it easy for the City to increase revenues.		Total Time: Six months.		Budget: \$15,950.

Grant Funds for Life/Safety Issues in Historic Buildings

Project Leader City
Logical Partners: CHPB, SHPO, Main Street, County, State, etc.



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Rehabilitating older buildings to meet current life/safety codes can be thorny – and expensive given asbestos removal, fire separation and protection, egress and ADA compliance, along with satisfying market demand for updated plumbing, electrical, HVAC and energy efficiency/ “green” certification . Moreover, it’s impractical to apply today’s codes to structures that, in some cases, were built a century ago. Plus, each historic building is a unique case. Remedy Downtown Cheyenne’s preservation advocates should push for a statewide approach to life/safety issues in adaptive reuse of historic structures and propose a grant program to offset additional costs – specifically for a life/safety “package.” This could be accomplished by the same coalition working toward a tax credit for historic rehab (Strategy 35). Goals below are paraphrased from a National Institute of Building Science’s program – Whole Building Design Guidelines (WBDG). - Accommodate life/safety needs in new ways to preserve historic structures. - Update building systems balancing the desire for new technologies with respecting building design meeting codes and fulfilling tenant needs. - Comply with accessibility requirements while meeting preservation goals. Notes Maryland and New Jersey have developed rehab codes, providing flexibility to achieve life/safety objectives without extensive building reconfiguration. However, no states offer grants for life/safety retrofit. Wyoming could be the first.	To repeat from the tax credit list (in Strategy 35)... with a few changes... - Gather the partners for think sessions and select case studies. In Cheyenne, this <i>must</i> include the Hynds and other vacant buildings. Add a few problematic samples from other Wyoming Main Street communities. - Commission architects/engineers to isolate the life/safety costs in historic rehab. (This is not all that difficult.) - Build a logical, simple, well-illustrated presentation for the Wyoming Business Council. Use the Hynds and add specific what-if and but-for cases. Pitch the program. - Follow advice for negotiating in the Capitol’s corridors and involve other Main Street communities. - Listen to reactions. Tweak the proposal. - Lobby. Educate the building community – owners, architects, engineers, realtors, code officials, investors, Wyoming Association of Municipalities, etc. – on the benefits of Whole Building Design Guidelines: an infrastructure component that benefits the entire community, beyond an individual historic structure. - Work with WBC to add a new grant program to fund life/safety issues to increase economic development across Wyoming.	Coalition: Think. Write drafts. Critique each other. Discuss eligibility outside test cases in Cheyenne in other Wyoming Main Street communities. Commit to a consensus plan and follow through.	- Begin with the end in mind. Schedule according to the Legislative calendar. - Plan on eight weeks of meetings (the same common agendas) to detail the plan and prepare convincing arguments. - Allow twelve weeks to educate, “sell” and lobby. Stress the urgency. - Commit to a total of one year from start to finish.	- Agreement to pursue the life/safety grant program. - Number of partners on-board. - Amount of staff time devoted or donated to the effort. - Success in the Legislature. - Number of copy cat programs – in Wyoming and elsewhere. 	- Assign partners’ staff for 70 days @ \$225/day = \$15,750. - Hire architects @ \$7,500 to develop the outlines for a demo life/safety package for several selected buildings. - Plan on outside, expert help over 10 days @ \$400/day = \$4,000. - Include education and promotion production costs @ \$15,000. - Add contingency @ ten percent = \$4,225.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: A statewide grant program for updating life/safety packages for Wyoming’s architectural heritage could become a new national model.		Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$46,475.



Revive S.R. DeBoer’s 1929 Street Tree Program

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA and volunteers



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Cheyenne’s latitude, altitude and topography offer landscaping challenges – constant wind, temperature extremes, the semi-arid nature of the High Plains, and rapid cool downs. Placemaking participants bemoaned hail damage to downtown’s 400 planters in 2011 and commended property owners that landscaped public areas along with downtown Ft. Collins’ dense tree canopy. S.R. DeBoer was a Denver-based landscape architect who designed public parks, tree-lined boulevards and private gardens in the western US. At least 14 of his projects are listed on the National Register of Historic Places. While designing and implementing Cheyenne’s Holliday Park and Lake Minnehaha in the late-1920s, there are hints that he became intrigued with a tree-lined “power corridor” on Capitol Avenue between the Wyoming State Capitol (the public sector) on 24th and the Union Pacific Depot (the private sector) on 15th. By the early 1930s, DeBoer and colleagues are said to have developed a street tree plan for the city. Remedy It’s time to revisit and adapt DeBoer’s ideas – starting downtown. Arborists caution against DeBoer’s plans for dense plantings of Russian Olive (now banned in Wyoming) and Plains Cottonwood (the official state tree). Instead, professionals suggest colorful and fast-growing trees such as Thornless Honeylocust, Hackberry, Deborah Norway Maple, Burr Oak, Littleleaf Linden, Box Elder and other trees favored by sustainability advocates and permaculturalists. Notes An extensive, healthy urban forest offers numerous benefits. More street trees will increase downtown’s beauty, boost property values, lower temperatures, slow storm water runoff, improve water quality and maintain air quality. The USDA’s iTree and OpenTreeMap software enable officials and residents to register trees and monitor the impacts.	1 Assign City staff to take on a street tree program... beginning with a pilot project on Capitol Avenue – the “power corridor” – and working outward to all of downtown. 2 Research DeBoer’s early work in Cheyenne and elsewhere. 3 Consult urban forestry programs statewide and nationally. 4 Determine appropriate tree species and complementary plantings – especially prairie grasses. 5 Plan appropriate tree locations throughout downtown. Consider proximity to the 400 existing planters and whether it will be necessary to saw-cut sidewalks. 6 Seek a national sponsor for donations and subsidies. 7 Offer “memorial trees” to patrons and promoters. 8 Enlist partners – clubs, schools, religious groups, contractors, master gardeners, etc. 9 Hold a major public dig-in day to plant the pilot project on Arbor Day, Friday, April 26, 2013... and beyond.	1 Cheyenne Parks and Recreation’s Department of Urban Forestry and the Cheyenne Botanic Gardens: Engage these professional arborists/landscapers. 2 DDA: Plan for taking on most maintenance tasks – perhaps in partnership with Leadership Cheyenne. Continue to budget for tree maintenance. 3 Service clubs and private citizens: Replicate the successes of Cheyenne Botanic Gardens and Paul Smith Children’s Village. Think about tree and planter “adoption” programs all over downtown.	1 Conduct all research in four weeks. 2 Plan tree locations in two weeks. 3 Plan the pilot project over four weeks. 4 Allow twelve weeks for sponsorship and partnership recruitment. 5 Add another two weeks for Arbor Day dig-in planning.	1 Public and private interest in reviving DeBoer’s plan. 2 Number of partners and individuals enlisted. 3 Number of trees planted during the first dig-in. 4 Number of trees planted over five years. 5 Participation in street tree planting/monitoring via iTree and OpenTreeMap.	1 Research and plan tree locations: 35 staff days @ \$100/day = \$3,500. 2 Plan the pilot project: 20 staff days @ \$250/day = \$5,000. 3 Recruit sponsors: 20 staff days @ \$250/day = \$5,000. 4 Implement the demo: 2” to 3” caliper trees (to 8’ to 10’ heights) @ \$215 average/tree x 54 trees = \$11,610. 5 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$2,511.
Next Steps/Future Implications: The revived DeBoer plan for downtown may become a model for neighborhood-by-neighborhood, City-wide tree replanting programs. The planning steps and successes must be documented as an international model for “greening” in response to specific climatic circumstances.			Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$27,621.

Petition to Ease Wyoming's Restaurant Liquor License Laws for Cheyenne and Beyond

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: DDA, Main Street, Visit Cheyenne, WCCA and WAM



Need

The prospect of opening a restaurant gleams in many entrepreneurs' eyes. There's a myth that 90 percent of restaurants fail in their initial year. In fact, it's only 27 percent, in line with other businesses. Almost 125 restaurants open nationwide every day; over 42,000 restaurant licenses were issued in 2010. What would make it easier for aspiring restauranteurs in downtown Cheyenne? Wyoming Statute §12-4-102(d) mandates a population formula to determine the number of "retail," "restaurant" and "bar and grill" licenses. In Cheyenne, there are no "retail" licenses available (for on-site, off-site and package sales). There are *unlimited* "restaurant" licenses (no bar; table service only; \$1,050 annually). But there are only three unfilled "bar and grill" permits (allowing a stand-up bar; \$10,500 initially; \$1,500 renewals). Basic fees are modest, but the limited number of "bar and grill" permits stymies.

Locally-owned restaurants are a hallmark of reviving downtowns. The locavore movement increases interest and demand. Cheyenne's urban core is home to several exceptional dining options. There should be more restaurants offering enhanced choices, sparking greater interest downtown, attracting more day- and night-time activity and opening new eyes to downtown's potential.

Remedy

The City and DDA should adopt legislative agendas to amend liquor license laws. The Wyoming Association of Municipalities, Wyoming County Commissioners Association and Wyoming Main Street could help in amending Statute §12-4-102(d).

- Exempt Wyoming Main Street's 14 communities and affiliates from the population formula. (Almost 25 percent of Wyoming's population lives in these communities. As Cheyenne and Casper join Wyoming Main Street, that number jumps to 45 percent.)
- Exempt Wyoming's two Metropolitan Statistical Areas (Casper and Cheyenne) and the state's seven Micropolitan Statistical Areas (Evanston, Gillette, Jackson, Laramie, Riverton, Rock Springs and Sheridan) from the population formula. (About 73 percent of Wyoming's citizens live in these nine communities.)

Notes

As 17th Street's Restaurant Row demonstrates, restaurants attract more restaurants, more people and other businesses.

Specific Tasks

- 1 One-by-one, inform downtown's existing restaurant owners/operators of the intent to amend statutes. Recruit their support.
- 2 Convene a meeting with DDA, Main Street, Wyoming Association of Municipalities (WAM) and Wyoming County Commissioners Association (WCCA).
- 3 Develop a petition, lobbying agenda and valid reasons to amend the formula.
- 4 Enlist other Wyoming Main Street communities, municipalities and counties.
- 5 Enlist the Metropolitan and Micropolitan areas.
- 6 Attract support from the Wyoming Lodging & Restaurant Association (WLRA).
- 7 Establish a time line.
- 8 Approach the legislature.

Responsible Parties

- 1 City, DDA and Visit Cheyenne: Convene a facts commission. Write a case statement supporting amendments to the statute.
- 2 Main Street: Enlist member communities. Seek letters of endorsement.
- 4 WAM, WCCA (and WLRA): Adopt this as part of legislative agendas for 2013 and 2014.
- 5 WLRA: Anticipate more members.

Time Allowance

- 1 Meet, make assignments and prepare the case in five weeks.
- 2 Enlist others to the cause in eight weeks.
- 3 As necessary, engage WAM's, WCCA's (and WLRA's) lobbyists.
- 4 Attract support from electeds over two weeks.

Success Metric

- 1 Number of partners joining the effort.
- 2 Victory in Wyoming's legislature.
- 3 Number of new downtown Cheyenne restaurants.
- 4 Resulting number of other new businesses.
- 5 Cheers!

Budget Allowance

- 1 Plan 30 staff days @ \$275/day = \$8,250.
- 2 Allow \$5,000 for materials.
- 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$1,325.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Wyoming's population formula for liquor licenses dates from the 1930s. Less restrictive laws will yield more restaurants and more jobs for very high percentages of Wyoming's population. The State should also help to ease federal regulations governing micro-breweries and distilleries.

Total Time:
Four months.

Budget:
\$14,575.

Organize a Downtown Community Land Trust

Project Leader: City
Logical Partners: MPO and DDA



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Community input was at the core of completing <i>Vision 2020</i> and the <i>Market-Based Downtown Plan</i>. As well, <i>PlanCheyenne</i> successfully used public engagement tools. All three provide great ideas for downtown’s future. Meanwhile: - The US Environmental Protection Agency’s \$1 million Brownfields Assessment Grant for Cheyenne will be implemented throughout and adjacent to downtown – with stakeholder involvement. - The MPO produced visions for downtowns near west side. - The City is pursuing the Capitol Basin stormwater project on Cheyenne’s front porch. These public programs could leverage \$200 to \$400 million in private investment in downtown Cheyenne. Will the public continue to be involved? Is there a private/public partnership offering guidance? Will market forces prevail? A community land trust (CLT) may provide a good common-ground answer. CLTs acquire and manage land for CLT members – primarily to preserve affordability. Think of CLT as a nonprofit condominium: CLT owns and manages the land; private interests or the public lease the land – usually for 99 years – and own what’s built upon it. CLT members can be any entity: developers; churches; home owners; businesses, etc. But all members have a say in what takes place – new development, historic rehab, etc. In effect, land value is taken out of the equation. Value comes from what is built <u>on</u> CLT’s property. The tax base grows and strengthens the local economy.	- Assign City and County planning staff to research CLTs in general, downtown precedents elsewhere, Jackson Hole’s version and Wyoming statutes. Prepare preliminary recommendations. - Review land statistics gathered for the major infill development exercise. Show public and private ownerships, add rights-of-way, overlay other popular urban places. Does this warrant a Cheyenne-style CLT? - Prepare a test case on vacant City, County and State land. What could be built on each? How do structures address each other? What’s the added tax value and revenue? - Prepare a test case on downtown’s 43 historic structures. CLT would eliminate the underlying value of the land, thus ensuring the building’s future while thwarting demolition. - Share ideas and test case results with selected public and private owners. - Present options to the Mayor, City Council and County Commissioners. - Proceed accordingly.	- City and MPO: Name joint staff to research and test. - DDA: Arrange site access and ownership profiles. Assist in any way. - State: Provide legal opinions; recommend enabling legislation changes.	- Provide recommendations within one month. - If approved, prepare additional back-up in three months. Continue research and invite expert opinions. - Declare the CLT within one year.	- Level of general interest in the CLT. Good reaction from the public. Emerging leadership from electeds. - Private interest in pursuing CLT membership. - Responses from the financial community. - Legal formation of the CLT. - First ground lease signing. Then, first shovel in the ground and first ribbon cutting.	- Research over 20 days @ \$250/day = \$5,000. - Provide case statements over 40 days @ \$250/day = \$10,000. - Host CLT experts = \$5,000. - Seek legal advice over five days @ \$3,000. - Add contingency @ ten percent = \$2,300.
Remedy In planning for major infill development (Strategy 25), a CLT can deliver land at a lower cost, enabling development of more affordable and higher value uses as determined by its members. One place to begin might be the 35 undeveloped acres on the near west side of which twelve acres – 35 percent – is in public ownership. Private owners of adjacent lands could join the CLT too.					
Notes There are over 250 CLTs in 31 states including one chartered in Wyoming: the Jackson Hole Community Housing Trust. Cheyenne should join the National Community Land Trust Network and develop sensible site-specific approaches for downtown Cheyenne.	Next Steps/Future Implications: CLT’s are eager to share success stories. The non-profit National CLT Network and several affiliates should be invited to Cheyenne to look at the potential, give advice and provide coaching. CLT may be eligible for Joint Powers Board status under Wyoming Statute §16-01-1d.		Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$25,300.

Historic Placemaking Strategies

Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board

Lead Organization for Implementation



Introduce a Tax Credit for Historic Rehabilitation

Project Leader: CHPB
Logical Partners: SHPO, DDA and State



Need

Most real estate investors pay federal income tax. They can earn a 20 percent federal tax credit for eligible costs incurred in certified historic rehabilitation of income-producing structures. In addition, 30 states offer additional benefits ranging from a five percent to 20 percent tax credit. For example, investors in Utah and North Carolina are entitled to a tax credit against their federal income tax liability and another 20 percent against their state income tax liability.

Of course, Wyoming has no state income tax. No tax; no tax credit which means no statewide incentive to save historic structures. Consequently, it's no surprise that Wyoming lags other states in the volume of certified historic rehab projects.

Remedy

A "synthetic" tax credit needs to be championed by project leaders, working with Wyoming's Business Council, which would create a financial buffer between the (sometimes) higher costs of historic rehab and lower rates for new construction. Project sponsors would be eligible for state grants – tax credits – to make up that difference. A few of the benefits:

- Creates jobs with firms doing business in Cheyenne;
- Adds to the property tax base, increasing local revenue;
- Builds a market for older buildings, thereby arresting a drop in downtown's real estate values;
- Increases investments in downtown space – lowering some rents – but opening new markets for more retail, office and residents;
- Spawn retail activity via more restaurants and services – more jobs; create a ripple effect on nearby streets.

To encourage a quick response, the synthetic tax credit might sunset in five years. It could also be retroactive for recent/current renovations.

Notes

- Maryland returns \$8.53 for each \$1.00 in state tax credits. In Rhode Island, it's \$5.35. In Missouri, it's \$4.00... with 6,871 new jobs and \$60 million in new local revenue over three years.
- In ten years, Virginia's state tax credit created an additional 10,700 jobs and \$444 million in wages.
- Massachusetts' tax credit leveraged investment of \$50 million.

Nearby Colorado, Montana and Utah use state tax credits to encourage rehab. Why not Wyoming?

Specific Tasks

- 1 Gather potential partners for a think session or two; select several case studies. In Cheyenne, this might include Dinneen and Grier (as recent projects) and Hynds, Paramount and Majestic (as proposed projects). Add a few from other Wyoming Main Street communities.
- 2 Build a logical, simple, well-illustrated presentation for the Wyoming Business Council. Use Dinneen, Grier and add other specific "what-if" and "but-for" cases. Cite national examples. Pitch the program.
- 3 Follow advice for negotiating the Capitol's corridors and involve other Wyoming Main Street communities.
- 4 Listen to reactions. Tweak the proposal.
- 5 Lobby. Enlist allies including building owners and investors. Lobby some more.
- 6 Achieve success.

Responsible Parties

- 1 Coalition: Think and write drafts. Critique one another. Discuss eligibility outside of the test cases in Cheyenne – Wyoming Main Street members only? Commit to a consensus plan. Follow through and follow through some more.

Time Allowance

- 1 Plan on eight weeks of meetings to detail the plan and prepare convincing arguments.
- 2 Allow twelve weeks to "sell" and lobby. Stress the urgency.
- 3 Commit to a total of six months from start to finish.

Success Metric

- 1 Agreement to pursue the synthetic tax credit program.
- 2 Number of partners on-board.
- 3 Amount of staff time devoted and donated to the effort.
- 4 Success in the Legislature.
- 5 Number of copy cat programs in states with taxes and no tax credits (e.g., Nebraska and Idaho) and states with no income tax (e.g., South Dakota).

Budget Allowance

- 1 Assign partners' staff over 50 days @ \$225/day = \$11,250.
- 2 Plan on outside help over 20 days @ \$400/day = \$8,000.
- 3 Add promotion costs @ \$10,000.
- 4 Include contingency @ ten percent = \$2,925.

Next Steps/Future Implications: This program uses wealth from Wyoming's natural resources to protect Wyoming's historic and cultural heritage. Don't let it become complicated. It's really quite simple.

Total Time:
Six months.



Budget:
\$32,175.



Form a Historic Rehab Investment Consortium

Project Leader: CHPB
Logical Partners: SHPO, City, Private Investors



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
The federal investment tax credit for rehabilitation of historic buildings has a significant record: two million jobs; investment of over \$30 billion; rehabilitation of 37,000 structures. Under this program, investors receive a 20 percent federal income tax credit for successful rehab. It's the kingpin in almost all downtown revitalization programs. Indeed, the tax credit has been used in some of downtown Cheyenne's most prominent rehab projects. The process is really quite simple. It can be tweaked to benefit a number of individuals and organizations – most notably, owners of vacant or almost-vacant buildings, private investors and nonprofits dedicated to preserving architectural heritage. The National Trust for Historic Preservation publishes a list of the “11 most endangered buildings.” Preservationists in St. Louis and Dallas maintain local lists. Cheyenne has done the same but needs to broadly publicize the targets – and take the next steps as well – to help save downtown's architectural jewels. Remedy The Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board (CHPB), along with the State Historic Preservation Office (SHPO), should reorganize the existing program and jointly name downtown's eleven most endangered buildings. Criteria might include demolition threats, architectural quality, role in Cheyenne's history and/or street front prominence. Once the first buildings (and, perhaps, the second set too) have been selected, CHPB should help form an investment consortium to acquire the structure(s) in one of at least three ways: • Negotiate to buy the property for something near appraised value; • Offer the owner an equity position in the consortium equal to the building's appraised value; • If the owner is a ground floor merchant, suggest an equity position with the remaining value as a street level retail condominium. The consortium would proceed with rehab and place an enhanced-value structure on the tax roles. With some changes to the Historic Preservation Board's charter, beneficiaries could include CHPB, current owners, local investors, banks, etc. Notes This is an (almost) home-grown jump-start for historic rehabilitation of some of downtown's favorite structures.	1 In partnership with the SHPO (and, perhaps other Wyoming Main Street communities), CHPB should identify downtown's eleven most endangered historic buildings. 2 Profile the buildings as to assessed value, structural integrity, code compliance, etc. 3 Determine the owners' interest in a) selling the building to the consortium and/or b) participating in a rehab consortium. 4 Approach local private investors who may be interested in the 20 percent federal investment tax credit with investments ranging from \$500 to \$500,000. 5 Form a limited partnership – the consortium. Raise additional funds. (If necessary, CHPB may form a separate organization to undertake limited partner status.) 6 Hire professionals to design the adaptive reuse project. 7 Begin certified historic rehab. 8 Tenant the building. 9 Maintain ownership in the consortium for at least ten years (a part of the federal tax credit regulations). 10 With CHPB and SHPO, identify the next set of the eleven most endangered buildings. 11 Repeat every year as more buildings reach age 50.	1 CHPB: Head the project from start to finish. After charter changes, become a limited partner. Hire staff with proceeds from the partnership. 2 SHPO: Help assemble the eleven-most lists. Provide technical expertise. 3 Building owners: Join the consortium and become limited partners. 4 Investors: Provide capital. Become general partners. 5 Banks: Offer lower interest loans. 6 Architects: Provide the best site-specific designs. 7 Contractors: Hire more employees.	1 Identify the eleven buildings within three months. 2 Form the consortium over six months. 3 Allow three months to negotiate with building owners. 4 Rehab the first consortium program building within one year.	1 Number of buildings eligible in the first and second rounds of the eleven most endangered program. 2 Success in raising local capital from investors and banks. 3 Number of buildings brought into the consortium. 4 Number of buildings rehabbed and tenanted. 5 Replication of the process in other Wyoming cities.	1 Allocate 90 staff days @ \$200/day = \$18,000. 2 Hire a fundraiser @ \$5,000. Share fundraising services with the revolving loan fund (Strategy 37). Aim for at least \$1,000,000. 3 Hire attorneys to write the consortium origination documents = \$12,000. 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$103,500.
Next Steps/Future Implications: There may seem to be a limitless supply of historic buildings deserving attention. Over time – perhaps ten years – that supply will be exhausted. This calls for another round of consortium action in <u>re</u>-rehabbing and adding buildings that will be age 50 by then.				Total Time: One year.	Budget: \$1,138,500.

Seed a Revolving Loan Fund for Historic Rehab

Project Leader: CHPB
Logical Partners: Main Street, WBC and DDA



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
Many states maintain revolving loan programs for historic preservation. Cities – large and small – have established programs to offer low-interest loans for acquisition/restoration of historic structures to make up the difference between the (sometimes) higher costs of historic rehab and lower rates for new construction. Loans may be available on a competitive basis or targeted to public-interest groups working in under-served communities. Some loans may be made to preservation nonprofits only. Maximum loan amounts vary widely. Most interest rates are from two to four percent. Remedy It’s reasonable to propose a historic preservation revolving loan program for downtown Cheyenne <i>if</i> it serves as a test case for statewide application – perhaps in all Wyoming Main Street communities. CHPB (or a chartered subsidiary – perhaps with partners) should start such a fund. Seed monies might come from the City, Wyoming Business Council, a legislative grant, USDA’s rural development program, foundations and private donors – and demolition permit fees directed toward preservation. Or <u>all</u> of the above. Begin CHPB’s discussions with Wyoming Main Street and Wyoming Business Council. Really, this is only an extension of WBC’s Historic Architecture Assistance Fund. • Enable private or nonprofit groups to apply for loans to acquire and restore an historic downtown structure. • Require that applicants complete exterior <i>and</i> interior rehabilitation – to the Secretary of the Interior’s standards – and meeting all local design and building regulations. • Ask applicants to include street level retail and a mix of residential and office on upper floors. • Customize the program for the “Expanded Downtown Historic District.” Take a lien on a building. Set a maximum loan amount of 15 percent of the revolving loan fund balance. Adopt a five-year repayment schedule. • Devote landfill fees on <u>all</u> demolition permits to the revolving loan fund. Notes Dozens of states and cities operate thriving, permanent, self-sufficient revolving loan funds for preservation projects. Cheyenne could too.	1 Define a scope for the pilot revolving loan program: size of seed capital, eligibility, minimum and maximum loan amounts, loan terms, high degree of public accessibility to the finished product, etc. Never forget that the scope of the program will eventually apply to all of Cheyenne – not just downtown. 2 Test the scope on a sample project and fine-tune the scope. 3 Discuss funding potential with all prospects. 4 Recruit funders. 5 Advertise availability of loans. 6 Select first-round awardees. 7 Administer the first loans. 8 Repeat often.	1 CHPB: Take charge of the entire program. Follow through. Administer the loans. Build a bigger revolving loan fund. 2 Wyoming Main Street: Suggest precedents from elsewhere. Participate in defining the scope. Spread the word. 3 Wyoming Business Council: Provide seed capital, say... \$1.5 million. 4 DDA: Help administer and staff the program. 5 City: Attend ribbon cuttings.	1 Define the program in one month. 2 Engage partners over three months. 3 Raise funds within six months. 4 Allow two months to advance the program and find the first projects.	1 Interest in the revolving loan fund. 2 Amount of funds raised. 3 Number of applicants for the loans. 4 Number of successful rehabs. 5 A permanent and expanding revolving loan fund.	1 Dedicate 150 volunteer days = 0. 2 Plan on 24 staff days @ \$250/day = \$6,000 3 Hire a proven fundraiser @ \$5,000. Share with the consortium (Strategy 36). Aim for at least \$1,000,000 or a match to WBC’s funding input. 4 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$151,100.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: Over time, loan funds should be available in all of Cheyenne’s National Register districts. The fund also may be opened for new construction too – <i>if</i> a project is deemed to contribute to an existing National Register district.		Total Time: One year.		Budget: \$1,662,100.

Historic Placemaking Strategies

Other Partnerships

Lead Organization for Implementation



Start a Cooperative for Artists and Artisans

Project Leader: Arts Cheyenne
Logical Partners: All Artists and Craftspeople



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
From the start, an unusually large number of artists and craftspeople participated in the Placemaking project. It turns out that artisans of all stripes make up a sizable and active community – much of it centered in downtown Cheyenne: over 50 presenting and supporting organizations; more than 20 galleries and facilities; programs in public and private schools as well as at LCCC; public art (including the Capitol Avenue bronzes and 19 Boots Walker installations); a Mayor’s advisory committee; community programs; an incredibly packed Arts Cheyenne events calendar – at least ten to choose from every day. However, all of this enviable activity lacks a central showcase and outlet open to all artists and craftspeople. Remedy Arts Cheyenne should initiate an arts and crafts marketplace for all types of handmade in Wyoming and “forever west” pottery, glass, jewelry, paintings, photography, furniture, clothing, bedding, sculpture, fiber, metal, film... an Arts Cheyenne Arts & Crafts Co-op would accept any artist in any field as a member... perhaps at \$75 per year. Members would: • Staff the co-op for four hours each month, e.g., 10:00 am to 2:00 pm, 2:00 to 6:00 pm and 6:00 to 8:00 pm on Friday and Saturday; • Agree on a new theme every three months: photography; household items; pottery, etc. with a peer jury for each; • Earn 35 percent for the artist and 65 percent for the co-op on all sales. At the outset, the co-op should be at least 1,000 square feet – strategically placed near Depot Plaza, Wyoming Home, the “Women’s Block,” Wrangler, Donna’s, LightsOn!, The Plains, Nelson Museum, etc. Notes A central showcase for local art was mentioned seven times in Placemaking sessions. Reference was often made to the artists’ co-operative on Trimble Court in downtown Ft. Collins. It opened its doors 40 years ago. In that time, no other downtown gallery has suffered from competition. In fact, there are now more galleries and arts venues in downtown Ft. Collins.	1 Agree to agree on partnerships to start a co-op in downtown Cheyenne. Visit co-ops in nearby cities and interview their leadership and partners, e.g. Trimble Court in Ft. Collins, EDGE and Creative Co-op Studio in Denver. 2 Broadcast details about the potential, membership terms, etc. Incorporate ideas from respondents. Enlist their membership and support. 3 Convene a first co-op membership meeting. Assign a task force to suggest at least 15 themes and agree to help stage them. Name a finance/fundraising committee and a governing board. 4 Find sympathetic landlords and/or angel investors. 5 Agree on the location. Consider donating a firm percentage of sales receipts to lease and fit-up expenses. Negotiate and sign the lease. 6 Start the self-help rehab with possible assists from Leadership Cheyenne, Cheyenne Young Professionals, building trades and through donated materials. 7 Announce and market the grand opening. 8 Think about expansion. 9 Help organize a competition to design a logo for Cheyenne’s 150th birthday celebration (Strategy 41).	1 Arts Cheyenne: Become the instigator. Follow through. Think of every detail and plan way ahead. 2 Co-op members: Operate a top-notch facility featuring Cheyenne’s and Laramie County’s best creative talent.	1 Discuss, agree and sign a MOU in 35 days. 2 Find a great space in 20 days. 3 Identify the angel investor in three months. 4 Negotiate and sign a lease in five days. 5 Rehab over 60 days.	1 A signed Memo of Understanding to launch the co-op. 2 Number of artist members. 3 Finding a home for the co-op and completing the self-help rehab. 4 The grand opening. 5 Growing number of members. Increasing number of themed shows. First expansion of the co-op. 6 Number of new galleries near the co-op.	1 Allow 30 volunteer days for discussion, planning and framing the co-op agreement/MOU = 0. 2 Plan on legal review @ \$500. 3 Rent space @ \$10 psf = \$120,000. 4 Upfit the space with artist labor and donated materials = \$17,500. 5 Hold a grand opening = \$1,500. 6 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$13,950.
	Next Steps/Future Implications: The co-op will grow. Think about an initial location while also considering expansion – perhaps to the second floor of an ADA compliant building. Look at the promising niche market along West Lincolnway. Promote the co-op to locals and make the experience a must-see for Cheyenne’s visitors.		Total Time: Six months.		Budget: \$153,450.

Enhance Cheyenne's Gateways

Project Leader: MPO
Logical Partners: WYDOT, WBC, City, DDA, Service Clubs, etc.



Need

Attractive window displays lure shoppers inside and attest to the merchant's pride in the store's offerings. The same holds true at larger scales: gateways to a city reveal much about how citizens and elected officials care about attracting outsiders.

Despite downtown Cheyenne's charms, getting there means passing through some dreary scenery via Exit 362 on I-80 (South Greeley) and Exit 9 on I-25 (Lincolnway). Easy access from two Interstates is a boon, but these routes to downtown are uneven. The City, WYDOT and service groups (notably, Kiwanis) have done a very good job improving these approaches. MPO has produced a great set of plans for both. Additional improvements are in the works in cooperation with WYDOT and Union Pacific along West Lincolnway. How can these improvements (and work recently completed in front of the Dinneen project) be expanded to the rest of Lincolnway and the I-180 corridor?

Remedy

It's time to implement MPO's 2005 plans for both gateways. Cost estimates (including contingency) were about \$850,000 for Lincolnway and \$1.9 million for I-180/South Greeley (including signs, lighting and landscape). Chances are these estimates have not increased dramatically. The plans also included a realistic sources-of-funds section. Major points:

- Apply for federal transportation enhancement funds administered by WYDOT (Transportation Enhancement Activities – Local, or TEAL) in a roughly 90 percent federal, ten percent State and City formula;
- Continue partnering with Union Pacific. UP owns land on Lincolnway and I-180 passes over the massive UP yards;
- Submit a Business Ready Community Grant to the Wyoming Business Council "...to improve the community's aesthetic character... to make itself more attractive for business development."

Notes

Lincolnway and South Greeley are the primary gateways – front yards – into downtown. In turn, downtown Cheyenne is the gateway – the front porch – to the State Capitol. "What the neighbors think" is important. Improve Lincolnway and I-180 as ways to get to downtown, not just *through* it.

Specific Tasks

- 1 Convene a planning process under MPO leadership to create a vision for downtown's gateways. Invite Cheyenne Parks & Recreation's Department of Urban Forestry, the Botanic Gardens, master gardeners, garden clubs, service organizations, WYDOT, businesses and the public to help in proposing joint actions.
- 2 Initiate additional planning for similar gateway improvements (signage, lighting, landscape, etc.) along all of Lincolnway. Create gateway "zones" for pedestrian and bike traffic from the east and west.
- 3 Prepare and sign a "gateways" MOU headed by MPO, and joined by WYDOT, the City, the State and other partners.
- 4 Research all major grants. Look into smaller grant programs. Assess volunteer capacities. Fill in the blanks.
- 5 Unveil the program. Hold public input sessions and become media-worthy. Attract more interest and volunteers.
- 6 Write ambitious grant proposals. Gather letters of support and lobby.
- 7 Build on MPO's existing plans. Specify public art, plant species, lighting, sidewalk enhancements, and pedestrian crossings – especially along Lincolnway at and near Depot Plaza.
- 8 Hire contractors. Stage dig-ins for volunteers.
- 9 Cut really big ribbons.

Responsible Parties

- 1 MPO: Head the effort from start to finish.
- 2 WYDOT: Initiate the MOU and provide coordination and technical assistance.
- 3 City/DDA: Participate smartly and become the public's ears and eyes.
- 4 Service clubs: Provide volunteers.

Time Allowance

- 1 Organize partners over four weeks.
- 2 Research and write grants in four months.
- 3 Hire design professionals and put under a one year contract through to completion.
- 4 Implement the program over three years – well in time for Cheyenne's 150th birthday (Strategy 41).

Success Metrics

- 1 Favorable reaction to the ideas.
- 2 A signed MOU.
- 3 Success in achieving major grants – 90+ percent of overall costs.
- 4 Number of volunteers and volunteer groups.
- 5 Praise from the visiting public.

Budget Allowance

Assume about 90 percent of the \$2.75 million will be raised via TEAL, grants and the Wyoming Business Council. The remaining \$270,000 will be raised by others and through the City.

- 1 Research and write grants over four months @ \$250/day = \$40,000.
- 2 Update the 2005 plans via landscape architects, engineers, etc. = \$100,000.
- 3 Add 15 percent contingency = \$21,000.

Next Steps/Future Implications: It may take several years to spruce up both South Greeley and Lincolnway (and Missile Drive and Randall and Central and Nationway). But once accomplished, partner with the State of Wyoming to tidy its entry from Colorado on Interstate 25. All of this really matters!

Total Time:
Four years.



Budget:
\$161,000.

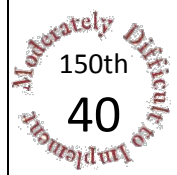
Involve Young Professionals in Downtown Cheyenne

Project Leaders: Chamber and DDA

Logical Partners: CYP, Leadership Cheyenne



Need	Specific Tasks	Responsible Parties	Time Allowance	Success Metric	Budget Allowance
The Greater Cheyenne Chamber of Commerce offers two affiliate programs to nurture future Laramie County leaders: Leadership Cheyenne (LC) and Cheyenne Young Professionals (CYP). - Leadership Cheyenne enrolls an annual class of about 20 for a rigorous, nine-month immersion in all-things Cheyenne. LC is open to all interested in civic leadership but applicants usually exceed the target class size. The main social event is the Boo Ball, an annual Halloween fundraiser benefiting a selected charitable activity. LC costs about \$700 per enrollee. - Cheyenne Young Professionals is a networking opportunity for younger adults. Monthly luncheons offer speakers on four core missions, one of which is volunteerism. Several hundred members are on the roster and annual dues are \$40. In a community that takes pride in home-grown initiatives, it’s worthwhile to suggest beneficial links between LC and CYP <i>as well as</i> between them and downtown Cheyenne – the employment site for most members.	1 Invite LC and CYP leaders to joint discussions. Compare rosters and programs. Further delineate and fine-tune the differences between the two. Then, think about what can be done more effectively together. Look at joint programming, affiliate-type arrangements via chambers of commerce in other cities. 2 Find common grounds between LC and CYP for interaction. 3 Introduce the joint programming ideas to each audience. Gather reactions. Solicit more ideas. 4 Plan an initial public event – small scale at first. 5 Stage it. Enjoy it. Make new contacts, connections and friends. Enlist more interest in the Chamber’s programs. 6 Keep communications open. Plan the next joint event. This time, be ambitious.	1 Chamber: Convene the leaders of LC and CYP. Introduce the idea of joint programs. 2 CYP: Create an equal co-leader role in affiliate-type programs. 3 LC: Create an equal co-leader role in affiliate-type programs.	1 If necessary, prepare a MOU between LC and CYP in two weeks. 2 Plan the first joint event over two weeks. 3 Hold the event within six months.	1 Interest in the idea from both LC and CYP. 2 Leadership for joint action recruited from both groups. 3 Attendance and funds raised at the first event. 4 On-going attendance and fundraising. 5 Birth of a new tradition.	1 Use existing Chamber staff and LC/CYP volunteers to plan, stage and act = \$0. 2 Allocate \$2,500 for the first event; aim for attendance of at least 400. 3 Add contingency @ ten percent = \$250. 4 Plan on making a profit and donating to a selected cause, e.g., an artist’s co-op, a grocery store, etc.
Remedy There appears to be little interaction between these two initiatives despite their common goals: know Cheyenne; promote Cheyenne; lead Cheyenne. A focused joint program. - Give the program a new name – Cheyenne Affiliates? Don’t muddle distinct functions of each, but leverage the combined energy. - Plan joint sessions specifically on downtown revitalization – why downtown is important to Cheyenne and Wyoming. - Spotlight one existing downtown business each month. Act as a welcome wagon for new businesses and new residents. - Stage four joint fundraising events each year – and keep the Boo Ball too. Select a project focus, identify sponsors, charge an entry fee, invite the public and offer food and drink. Donate proceeds appropriately given the year’s focus.	Next Steps/Future Implications: <i>Don’t</i> confuse these two valuable Chamber programs. But <i>do</i> think of ways that young (and not-so-young) professionals can plan and interact with Cheyenne’s budding and proven leaders. Communicate. Cooperate. That’s the hallmark of the Chamber of Commerce anyway.		Total Time: Six months.		Budget: \$2,750.
Notes Many Chambers are implementing joint programming for their younger members. One community Cheyenne’s size raises about \$12,500 per event... four times a year.					



Plan Cheyenne’s 150th Birthday: July 4, 2017

Project Leader: A New “Cheyenne 150” Group
Logical Partners: Everyone



Need

What happened here almost 150 years ago is still a vivid and evolving part of the American saga – the wild west, the transcontinental railroad, “Hell on Wheels,” cowboys and cowgirls, “Equality State,” boom and bust and boom again, “Magic City of the Plains,” the new West, the next West... In four years, Cheyenne will celebrate a birthday – its first 150 years. It won’t do to wait until 2017 to plan a celebration. Start now!

Remedy

Think of Strategy 1 as a series of dress rehearsals for the really big event. The City should charter a totally inclusive “Cheyenne 150” nonprofit organization and give it sole responsibility to plan, organize, coordinate, implement and manage a year-long commemoration that 1) showcases the past, 2) celebrates today’s Cheyenne and 3) guarantees Cheyenne’s promise tomorrow. Cheyenne 150 might:

- Adopt 15 strategies suggested in this Placemaking document for completions and ribbon cuttings. For example, add 15 new downtown arts, culture and food festivals – to be continued beyond 2017 (e.g., High Plains cook-offs using heritage recipes, traditional Native American foods, Intercontinental Hotel menu tastings, etc.;
- Start a CheyenneCorps intern program for Wyoming’s budding architects, engineers, craftspeople, environmentalists, archaeologists, etc., to restore facades, buildings and artifacts (e.g., UP engines and rolling stock);
- Host the 2017 edition of the Indigenous Native American Games, an affiliate of the US Olympics Committee. (Past INAG games attracted 10,000 athletes from 1,000 tribes in the US and Canada);
- Plan a National Main Street conference for the 16 other state capitals that are also Main Street communities to identify common strategies. Test them in Cheyenne;
- Hold 5th, 10th... reunions for the three high schools and LCCC;
- Celebrate the various modes of transport that opened Cheyenne: horses; mule teams; stage coaches; vintage 1917 cars and trucks; UP rolling stock, etc.

Notes

This is much too big a milestone to ignore!

Specific Tasks

- 1 Charter a blue-ribbon nonprofit organizing committee. Seek lessons from elsewhere. Think of 2017 as similar to staging an Olympic Games: they are expensive but there are generous “official sponsors” who can help ensure a profit.
- 2 Coordinate very closely with W.E. Warren Air Force Base (it’s also their 150th birthday), CFD (CFD’s 121st staging is in 2017) and other established and new festivals.
- 3 Hire an experienced executive director and staff.
- 4 Research and hold many, many presentations on Cheyenne’s and Laramie County’s history, contributions and future needs. Compile lists of complementary events. Get everyone involved in a big splash for 2017 and beyond.
- 5 Consider using a professional events planner and fundraiser. Set goals. Attain them.
- 6 Recruit ideas for presentations and events from every organization and age group. Hold a competition to select the best. Invite events from all of Cheyenne’s international sister cities.
- 7 Organize a year-long ideas forum on “what’s next” in energy, the arts, technology, etc.
- 8 Build a nine-block stage-set celebration venue from Depot Plaza to the Capitol. Salute the five flags that have flown over Wyoming – England, France, Spain, Mexico and the Republic of Texas.
- 9 Prepare for lasting benefits.

Next Steps/Future Implications: Set in motion a sustainable platform for many organizations. This is not a one-shot festival-of-festivals. It’s meant to add to the vitality of all of Cheyenne and Laramie County. Prepare for a big, lasting civic pat on the back!

Responsible Parties

- 1 Cheyenne 150: Imagine, market and implement a huge birthday bash. Maintain the energy far beyond 2017.
- 2 Everyone: Become involved and participate.

Time Allowance

- 1 Begin now, think big and continue to do so for at least five years... and then some.

Success Metric

- 1 Level of initial enthusiasm and participation.
- 2 Number of inquiries on how to participate.
- 3 Responses that merit attention.
- 4 Fundraising success – including national and local sponsorships.
- 5 Media attention.
- 6 Number of formal events and attendance.
- 7 Profits from Cheyenne 150.
- 8 Levels of sustainability in 2022 and 2027.

Budget Allowance

- 1 One of the first tasks for Cheyenne 150 will be budgeting for sources and uses. Aim for turning a profit on events, occupancy taxes, etc.
- 2 Add a contingency of ten percent.

Total Time:
Four years...
and beyond.

Budget:
To be
determined.

Notes

Appendix A – Enabling Legislation

ARTICLE 2 DOWNTOWN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

15-9-201. Declarations.

(a) The Wyoming legislature declares that the organization of downtown development authorities having the purposes and powers provided in this act will serve a public use; will promote the health, safety, prosperity, security and general welfare of the inhabitants thereof and of the people of this state, will halt or prevent deterioration of property values or structures within central business districts, will halt or prevent the growth of blighted areas within such districts, and will assist municipalities in the development and redevelopment of such districts and in the overall planning to restore or provide for the continuance of the health thereof, and will be of especial benefit to the property within the boundaries of any authority created pursuant to the provisions of this article.

(b) The Wyoming legislature determines, finds and declares that because of a number of atypical factors and special conditions concerning downtown development unique to each locality, the rule of strict construction shall have no application to this article, but it shall be liberally construed to effect the purposes and objects for which it is intended.

15-9-202. Definitions.

(a) As used in this article, unless the context otherwise requires:

(i) "Authority" means a downtown development authority created pursuant to the provisions of this article in any municipality of this state and any successor to its functions, authority, rights and obligations;

(ii) "Blighted area" means an area within the central business district which, by reason of the presence of a substantial number of deteriorated or deteriorating structures, predominance of defective or inadequate street layout, faulty lot layout in relation to size, adequacy, accessibility, usefulness, or unsanitary or unsafe conditions, deterioration of site or other improvements, unusual topography, defective or unusual conditions of title rendering the title nonmarketable, or the existence of conditions which endanger life or

property by fire and other causes, or any combination of such factors, substantially impairs or arrests the sound growth of the central business district, retards the provision of housing accommodations, or constitutes an economic or social liability and is a menace to the public health, safety, morals or welfare in its present condition and use;

(iii) "Board" means the board of the authority or the governing body when acting as the authority pursuant to W.S. 15-9-203;

(iv) "Central business district" means the area in a municipality which is and traditionally has been the location of the principal business, commercial, financial, service and governmental center, zoned or used accordingly;

(v) "Development project" or "project" means undertakings and activities of an authority or municipality as authorized in this article in a designated area for the development or redevelopment of the area in accordance with a plan of development and includes:

(A) The planning or management of development or improvement activities;

(B) Landscaping or other maintenance of public areas;

(C) Promotion of public events;

(D) Activities in support of business recruitment and development;

(E) Any other economic improvement activity for which an assessment may be made on property specially benefited thereby.

(vi) "Director" means the chief executive officer of the authority;

(vii) "District" means the authority or the area within which the authority may exercise its powers;

(viii) "Downtown" means a specifically defined area of the municipality in the central business district, established by the governing body of the municipality pursuant to this article;

(ix) "Governing body" means the city council, town council or other governing board of any municipality of this state;

(x) "Landowner" means the owner in fee of any undivided interest in real property or any improvement permanently affixed thereto within the district. As used in this article, "owner in fee" includes a contract purchaser obligated to pay general taxes, an heir or a devisee under a will admitted to probate and does not include a contract seller of property with respect to which the contract purchaser is deemed to be the owner in fee for purposes of this paragraph;

(xi) "Lessee" means the holder of a leasehold interest in real property within the district. As used in this article, "leasehold interest" does not include a license or mere contract right to use real property within the district;

(xii) "Municipal sales tax" means revenues distributed to the municipalities from the state of Wyoming from the state sales tax as provided in W.S. 39-15-111, and includes the share distributed to a municipality from any tax collected under the provisions of W.S. 39-15-203;

(xiii) "Plan of development" means a plan, as it exists from time to time, for the development or redevelopment of a downtown development area, including all properly approved amendments thereto;

(xiv) "Plan of development area" or "development area" means an area in the central business district which the board and the governing body designate as appropriate for a development project;

(xv) "Planning board" means the agency designated by the governing body of the municipality which is chiefly responsible for planning in the municipality and, if no separate agency exists, "planning board" means the governing body of the municipality;

(xvi) "Property tax" means the revenue derived from the eight (8) mill tax authorized by Article 15, Section 6 of the Wyoming Constitution;

(xvii) "Public body" means the state of Wyoming or any municipality, quasi-municipal corporation, board, commission, authority or other political subdivision or public corporate body of the state;

(xviii) "Public facility" includes but is not limited to any streets, parks, plazas, parking facilities, playgrounds, pedestrian malls, rights-of-way, structures, waterways, bridges, lakes, ponds, canals, utility lines or pipes, and buildings, including access routes to any of the foregoing, designed for use by the public generally or used by any public agency with or without charge, whether or not the same is revenue-producing;

(xix) "Qualified elector" means a resident as defined in this section;

(xx) "Resident" means one who is a citizen of the United States and a resident of Wyoming, eighteen (18) years of age or older, who makes his residence within the municipality.

15-9-203. Powers of governing body; creation of authority; status thereof.

A municipality may itself exercise the powers specified in this article, or if the governing body, by resolution, determines it to be in the public interest, it may elect to create and establish a downtown development authority, pursuant to the provisions of this article. The authority shall have all the powers provided in this article that are authorized by the ordinance authorizing the authority, or any amendment thereto. When established, the authority shall be a body corporate and capable of being a party to suits, proceedings and contracts the same as municipalities in this state. The authority may be dissolved by ordinance of the governing body, if there is no outstanding indebtedness of the authority or if adequate provision for the payment of such indebtedness is provided.

15-9-204. Organizational procedure.

(a) Upon petition of twenty-five percent (25%) of the persons owning nonresidential property within the proposed district and following a public hearing, if the governing body of a municipality determines it is necessary to establish a downtown development authority for the public health, safety, prosperity, security and welfare and to carry out the purposes of an authority as stated in W.S. 15-9-201, it may by ordinance establish a downtown development authority. In the ordinance, the governing body shall state the boundaries of the downtown development district, as set forth in the original petition requesting the establishment of a downtown development authority within which the authority shall exercise its powers. Upon request of the governing body, the petitioners may submit an amended petition which modifies the boundaries of the district. The boundaries of the downtown development authority shall be certified to the county assessor of the county in which the municipality is located within sixty (60) days after formation of the district.

(b) Any ordinance creating a downtown development authority shall provide that any ordinance or resolution by which bonds are issued

pursuant to this article shall specify the maximum net effective interest rate of such bonds.

15-9-205. Board; appointment; membership; terms; vacancies.

(a) The affairs of the authority shall be under the direct supervision and control of a board consisting of not less than five (5) nor more than eleven (11) members appointed by the governing body. A majority of the members appointed shall reside, be a lessee or own property in the downtown development district.

(b) The board shall be constituted as follows:

(i) At least one (1) member shall be a member of the governing body, appointed to serve at the pleasure of the governing body;

(ii) Two (2) members shall be appointed for terms expiring June 30 of the year following the date of the ordinance adopted by the governing body establishing the authority;

(iii) Two (2) members shall be appointed for terms expiring June 30 of the second year following the date of the ordinance adopted by the governing body establishing the authority;

(iv) Two (2) members, if the board consists of seven (7) or more members, shall be appointed for terms expiring June 30 of the third year following the date of the ordinance adopted by the governing body establishing the authority;

(v) All other members shall be appointed for terms expiring June 30 of the fourth year following the date of the ordinance adopted by the governing body establishing the authority.

(c) A member shall hold office until his successor has been appointed and qualified. After the terms of the initial members of the board have expired, the terms of all members (except any member who is a member of the governing body) shall expire four (4) years from the expiration date of the terms of their predecessors. Appointments to fill vacancies shall be for the unexpired term. In any municipality in which the charter provides that the appointive authority is the mayor, the mayor shall make appointments to the board.

15-9-206. Board; qualifications; oath of office; rules of procedure; meetings; reimbursement; removal.

(a) A majority of the members of the board, except any member from the governing body, shall reside, be a lessee or own real property in the downtown development district within the municipality in which the authority is located. An officer or director of a corporation having its place of business in the downtown development district shall be eligible for appointment to the board. No officer or employee of the municipality where the authority is located, other than any appointee from the governing body, shall be eligible for appointment to the board. Within thirty (30) days after the occurrence of a vacancy, the governing body, except as provided in W.S. 15-9-205(c), shall appoint a successor.

(b) Before assuming the duties of the office, each appointed member shall qualify by taking and subscribing to the oath of office required of officials of the municipality.

(c) The board shall adopt and promulgate rules governing its procedure, including election of officers. The rules shall be filed in the office of the clerk of the governing body. The board shall hold regular or special meetings in the manner provided in the rules of the board. All meetings of the board shall be open to the public except those dealing with land acquisition or sales, personnel matters or legal matters. Members of the board shall serve without compensation, but they may be reimbursed for actual and necessary expenses.

(d) After notice and an opportunity to be heard, an appointed member of the board may be removed for cause by the governing body.

15-9-207. Board; powers and duties; division of property and sales tax; special fund; adjustment evaluations.

(a) The board, subject to the provisions of this article and subject to other applicable provisions of law, shall have all powers customarily vested in the board of directors of a corporation. It shall exercise supervisory control over the activities of the director and the staff of the authority in carrying out the functions authorized by this article.

(b) In addition to the powers granted by subsection (a) of this section, the board may:

(i) Appoint and remove a director and other staff members, who shall be employed upon recommendation of the director, and prescribe their duties and fix their compensation;

(ii) At the request of the governing body, prepare an analysis of economic changes taking place in the central business district of the municipality;

(iii) Study and analyze the impact of metropolitan growth upon the central business district;

(iv) Plan and propose, within the downtown development area, plans of development for public facilities and other improvements to public or private property of all kinds, including removal, site preparation, renovation, repair, remodeling, reconstruction or other changes in existing buildings which may be necessary or appropriate to the execution of any development plan which in the opinion of the board will aid and improve the downtown development area;

(v) Implement, as provided in this article, any plan of development, whether economic or physical, in the downtown development area as is necessary to carry out its functions;

(vi) In cooperation with the planning board and the planning department of the municipality, develop long-range plans designed to carry out the purposes of the authority and to promote the economic growth of the district, and implement education and public relations programs to persuade property owners and business proprietors to implement such plans to the fullest extent possible;

(vii) Retain and fix the compensation of legal counsel to advise the board in the proper performance of its duties;

(viii) Make and enter into all contracts necessary or incidental to the exercise of its powers and the performance of its duties.

(c) Notwithstanding any law to the contrary, any plan of development as originally adopted by the board or as later modified pursuant to this article may, after approval by the governing body of the municipality, contain a provision that property taxes, if any, levied after the effective date of the approval of the plan of development by the governing body upon taxable property within the boundaries of the development area each year, or that municipal sales taxes collected within the area, or both, shall be divided for a period not to exceed twenty-five (25) years after the effective date of approval by the governing body of the provision, as follows:

(i) That portion of the property taxes which are produced by the levy at the rate fixed each year by the governing body upon the valuation for assessment of taxable property within the boundaries of the development area last certified prior to the effective date of approval by the governing body of the plan, or, as to an area later added to the boundaries of the development area, the effective date of the modification of the plan, or that portion of municipal sales taxes

collected within the boundaries of the development area in the twelve (12) month period ending on the last day of the month prior to the effective date of approval of the plan, or both, shall be paid into the treasury of the municipality;

(ii) That portion of the property taxes or all or any portion of the municipal sales taxes, or both, in excess of such amount shall be allocated to and, when collected, paid into a special fund of the municipality and used, as determined by the authority and the governing body of the municipality, for the payment of the principal of, the interest on, and any premiums due in connection with the bonds of, loans or advances to, or indebtedness incurred by, whether funded, refunded, assumed or otherwise, the municipality for financing or refinancing, in whole or in part, a development project within the boundaries of the development area and for payment of costs of landscaping or other maintenance of public areas, promotion of public events, activities in support of business recruitment and development and funding of capital improvements. Any excess municipal sales tax collection not allocated pursuant to this paragraph shall be paid into the funds of the municipality. Unless and until the total valuation for assessment of the taxable property within the boundaries of the development area exceeds the base valuation for assessment of the taxable property within such boundaries, as provided in paragraph (i) of this subsection, all of the property taxes levied upon the taxable property in the development area shall be paid into the treasury of the municipality. Unless and until the total municipal sales tax collections in the development area exceed the base year municipal sales tax collections in such area, as provided in paragraph (i) of this subsection, all municipal sales tax collections shall be paid into the funds of the municipality. When such bonds, loans, advances and indebtedness, if any, including interest thereon and any premiums due in connection therewith, and including any refunding securities therefore, have been paid, all taxes upon the taxable property or the total municipal sales tax collections, or both, in the development area shall be paid into the funds of the municipality.

(d) The special fund described in paragraph (c)(ii) of this section and the tax monies paid into the fund may be irrevocably pledged by the municipality for the payment of the principal of, the interest on, and any premiums due in connection with the bonds, loans, advances or indebtedness if the question of issuing the bonds or otherwise providing for the loans, advances or indebtedness and the question of the intended pledge are first submitted for approval to the qualified electors of the municipality at an election. The election shall be called by resolution of the board adopted at a regular or special meeting and approved by the governing body by a majority vote. The election shall be held, conducted, canvassed and returned in accordance

with the Political Subdivision Bond Election Law, W.S. 22-21-101 through 22-21-112.

(e) School districts which include all or any part of the development area shall be permitted to participate in an advisory capacity.

(f) In the event there is a general reassessment of taxable property valuations in any county including all or part of the development area subject to division of valuation for assessment under subsection (c) of this section, or a change in the sales tax percentage levied in any municipality including all or part of the development area subject to division of sales taxes under subsection (c) of this section, the portions of valuations for assessment or sales taxes under both paragraphs (i) and (ii) of subsection (c) of this section shall be proportionately adjusted in accordance with the reassessment or change.

15-9-208. Plan of development; procedure for approval; public hearings; notice thereof; findings of governing body.

(a) An authority shall not actually undertake a development project for a development area unless the governing body, by resolution, has first approved the plan of development which applies to the development project.

(b) Prior to its approval of a plan of development, the governing body shall submit the plan to the planning board of the municipality, if any, for review and recommendations. The planning board shall submit its written recommendations with respect to the proposed plan of development to the governing body within thirty (30) days after receipt of the plan for review. Upon receipt of the recommendations of the planning board or, if no recommendations are received within thirty (30) days, the governing body may proceed with the hearing on the proposed plan of development prescribed by subsection (c) of this section.

(c) The governing body shall hold a public hearing on a plan of development or substantial modification of an approved plan of development after public notice by one (1) publication during the week immediately preceding the hearing, in a newspaper having a general circulation in the municipality. The notice shall describe the time, date, place and purpose of the hearing, shall generally identify the plan of development area covered by the plan and shall outline the general scope of the development project under consideration.

(d) Following the hearing, the governing body may approve a plan of development if it finds there is a need to take corrective measures in order to halt or prevent deterioration of property values or

structures within the development area or to halt or prevent the growth of blighted areas therein, or any combination thereof, and if it further finds that the plan will afford maximum opportunity, consistent with the sound needs and plans of the municipality as a whole, for the development or redevelopment of the development area by the authority and by private enterprise.

15-9-209. Additional powers of authority; sale or letting of property at fair value.

(a) In addition to the other powers granted by this article, the authority shall have all powers, except as limited in the ordinance or any amendments thereto establishing the authority, necessary to carry out and effectuate the purposes and provisions of this article, including but not limited to the following powers:

(i) To acquire by purchase, lease, license, option, gift, grant, devise or otherwise any property or any interest therein;

(ii) In connection with public facilities, to improve land and to construct, reconstruct, equip, improve, maintain, repair and operate buildings and other improvements, whether on land of the authority or otherwise;

(iii) To lease or sublease as lessor any property owned or leased by it or under its control on such terms and conditions as may be established by the board for residential, recreational, commercial, industrial or other uses or for public use in accordance with the plan of development;

(iv) To sell or otherwise dispose of property of the authority or any interest therein, subject to such covenants, conditions and restrictions as it deems necessary or desirable to carry out the purposes and objectives of the authority, for residential, recreational, commercial, industrial or other uses or for public use in accordance with the plan of development;

(v) To fix, charge and collect fees, rates, tolls, rents and charges for the use of any property of the authority or any property under its control and to pledge any such revenues in support of any obligations of the authority;

(vi) To cooperate with the municipality in which the authority is located and any other governmental agency or public body and to enter into contracts with any such agency or body;

(vii) To make to or receive from the municipality or the county in which the authority is located conveyances, leasehold interests, grants, contributions, loans and any other rights and privileges;

(viii) To invest any funds of the authority not required for immediate disbursement in property or securities in which public bodies may invest funds, and to redeem any bonds issued by the municipality at the redemption price established therein or to purchase such bonds at less than the redemption price, all bonds so redeemed or purchased to be cancelled;

(ix) To deposit any funds not required for immediate disbursement in any depository authorized by law to receive and hold public funds. For the purpose of making such deposits, the board may appoint, by written resolution, one (1) or more persons to act as custodians of the funds of the authority. Such persons shall give surety bonds in such amounts and form and for such purposes as the board requires;

(x) To demolish and remove buildings and improvements located on, and to install, construct or reconstruct improvements and facilities, including public facilities, on any land owned by the authority or the municipality in preparation for conveyance to purchasers or lessees, or otherwise.

(b) Any sale or letting of property by the authority shall be at not less than its fair value (as determined by the authority and the governing body) for uses in accordance with the plan of development. In determining the fair value of real property for such uses, an authority shall consider the uses provided in the development plan; the restrictions upon and the covenants, conditions and obligations assumed by the purchaser or lessee; and the objectives of the development plan.

15-9-210. Authorization of bonds; determination of costs; expenditure of proceeds.

(a) By ordinance adopted by the governing body at a regular or special meeting, by a vote of a majority of the members of the governing body, the municipality may issue bonds, payable solely from taxes pledged pursuant to W.S. 15-9-207, to pay all or any part of the cost of any project or for furthering any purpose of this article.

(b) The governing body, in determining such costs, may include all costs and estimated costs of the issuance of the bonds; all engineering, inspection, fiscal and legal expenses; any discount on the sale of the bonds; the cost of any financial, professional or other expert advice; contingencies; any administrative, operating or other expenses of the municipality incurred pursuant to the issuance of the bonds, as may be

determined by the governing body; all other expenses as may be necessary or incident to the financing, acquisition, improvement, equipment and completion of any development project or for furthering any purpose of this article; sufficient provision of reserves for working capital, operation, maintenance or replacement expense, or for payment or security of principal of or interest on any bonds during or after an acquisition or improvement, and equipment, as the governing body may determine; and reimbursements to any governmental agency or instrumentality for any monies expended pursuant to agreement on any project or for furthering any purpose of this article.

(c) In each project financed by the proceeds of bonds issued under this article, the governing body shall determine the costs of, and may budget a percentage of bond proceeds for, operation and administration of the project.

(d) The proceeds of the bonds may be expended by the municipality or, with the consent of the municipality, by the authority as agent for, and on behalf of, the municipality. If the proceeds of the bonds are applied for the acquisition of real or personal properties, the governing body may:

(i) Retain title to the properties in its own name, and lease or grant licenses or privileges in the properties to the authority in order that the authority may, as principal or agent, exercise its powers with respect to the properties; or

(ii) Convey title to the properties to the authority for such consideration and subject to such terms and conditions as the governing body may prescribe without regard to any restriction, limitation or condition otherwise imposed by statute on the sale or disposition of the properties by a municipality.

15-9-211. Bond provisions; lost or destroyed securities; facsimile signatures; limited obligations.

(a) Bonds issued pursuant to this article shall bear interest at a rate such that the net effective interest rate of the issue does not exceed the maximum net effective interest rate authorized, payable semiannually or annually, and evidenced by one (1) or two (2) sets of coupons, if any, executed with the facsimile or manually executed signature of any official of the municipality; except that the first coupon appertaining to any bond may evidence interest not in excess of one (1) year. The ordinance authorizing the issuance of the bonds shall specify the maximum net effective interest rate. The bonds may be issued as term or serial bonds, in one (1) or more series, may bear such date, may mature at such time not exceeding twenty (20) years duration, may be

in such denomination or denominations, may be payable in such medium of payment at such place or places within or without the state (including but not limited to the office of any county treasurer in which the municipality is located wholly or in part), may carry such registration privileges, may be subject to such terms of prior redemption in advance of maturity in such order or by lot or otherwise at such time with or without a premium, may be executed in such manner, may bear such privileges for reissuance in the same or other denomination, may be so reissued, without modification of maturities and interest rates, and may be in such form, either bearer, coupon or registered, with such recitals, terms, covenants, conditions and other details as may be provided by the governing body, subject to the provisions of this article.

(b) The governing body may provide for preferential security for any bonds, both principal and interest, to be issued pursuant to this article to the extent deemed feasible and desirable by the governing body over any bonds that may be issued thereafter. The bonds may be sold at, above or below the principal amounts thereof, but they may not be sold at a price such that the net effective interest rate of the issue of bonds exceeds the maximum net effective interest rate authorized. The bonds may be sold at public or private sale as determined by the governing body to be in the best interest of the issuer. Bonds may be issued with privileges for conversion or registration, or both, for payment as to principal or interest, or both; and, where interest accruing on the bonds is not represented by interest coupons, the bonds may provide for the endorsing of payments of interest thereon.

(c) Subject to the payment provisions of this article, the bonds, any interest coupons attached thereto, and any temporary bonds shall be fully negotiable within the meaning of and for all the purposes of this article, except as the governing body may otherwise provide; and each holder of each security, by accepting the security, shall be conclusively deemed to have agreed that the security, except as otherwise provided, is and shall be fully negotiable within the meaning and for all purposes of this article.

(d) Notwithstanding any other provision of law, the governing body in any proceedings authorizing bonds pursuant to this article:

(i) May provide for the initial issuance of one (1) or more bonds, referred to in this subsection as "bond", aggregating the amount of the entire issue;

(ii) May make such provision for installment payments of the principal amount of any such bond as it may consider desirable;

(iii) May provide for the making of any such bond, payable to bearer or otherwise, registrable as to principal or as to both principal and interest and, where interest accruing thereon is not represented by interest coupons, for the endorsing of payments of interest on such bonds;

(iv) May further make provision in any such proceedings for the manner and circumstances in and under which any such bond may in the future, at the request of the holder thereof, be converted into bonds of smaller denominations, which bonds of smaller denominations may in turn be either coupon bonds or bonds registrable as to principal, or principal and interest, or both.

(e) If lost or completely destroyed, any security authorized by this article may be reissued in the form and tenor of the lost or destroyed security upon the owner furnishing, to the satisfaction of the governing body, proof of ownership; proof of loss or destruction; a surety bond in twice the face amount of the security, including any unmatured coupons appertaining thereto; and payment of the cost of preparing and issuing the new security.

(f) Any officer authorized to execute any bond, after filing with the secretary of state his manual signature certified by him under oath, may execute or cause to be executed, with a facsimile signature in lieu of his manual signature, any bond authorized in this article, if such a filing is not a condition of execution with a facsimile signature of any interest coupon, and if at least one (1) signature required or permitted to be placed on each such bond, excluding any interest coupon, is manually subscribed. An officer's facsimile signature shall have the same legal effect as his manual signature.

(g) Bonds issued pursuant to this section shall constitute an indebtedness of the municipality within the meaning of constitutional and statutory limitations. However, each bond issued pursuant to this section shall recite in substance that the bond, including interest payable thereon, is payable solely from the revenues or special funds pledged to the payment thereof and the bond constitutes a limited obligation of the municipality.

15-9-212. Refunding bonds; limited obligations.

(a) By ordinance adopted by the governing body at a regular or special meeting, by vote of a majority of the members of the governing body, any bonds issued under this article may be refunded by the municipality without an election, subject to the provisions concerning their payment and to any other contractual limitations in the proceedings authorizing their issuance or otherwise relating thereto.

Any bonds issued for refunding purposes may either be delivered in exchange for the outstanding bonds authorized to be refunded or may be sold as provided in this article for the sale of other bonds.

(b) No bonds may be refunded under this article unless the holders thereof voluntarily surrender them for exchange or payment, or unless they either mature or are callable for prior redemption under their terms within ten (10) years from the date of issuance of the refunding bonds. Provision shall be made for paying the bonds within said period of time. No maturity of any bonds refunded may be extended over fifteen (15) years. The rate of interest on such refunding bonds shall be determined by the authority. The principal amount of the refunding bonds may exceed the principal amount of the refunded bonds if the aggregate principal and interest costs of the refunding bonds do not exceed such unaccrued costs of the bonds refunded, except to the extent any interest on the bonds refunded in arrears or about to become due is capitalized with the proceeds of the refunding bonds. The principal amount of the refunding bonds may also be less than or the same as the principal amount of the bonds refunded so long as provision is duly and sufficiently made for their payment.

(c) The proceeds of refunding bonds shall either be immediately applied to the retirement of the bonds to be refunded or be placed in escrow or in trust to be applied to the payment of the bonds refunded upon their presentation. Any proceeds held in escrow or in trust pending use may be invested or reinvested in state or federal securities. The proceeds and investments in escrow or in trust, together with any interest or other gain to be derived from any investment, shall be in an amount at all times sufficient as to principal, interest, any prior redemption premium due and any charges of the escrow agent or trustee payable therefrom, to pay the bonds refunded as they become due at their respective maturities or due at the designated prior redemption date upon which the authority shall be obligated to call the refunded bonds for prior redemption.

(d) The relevant provisions pertaining to bonds generally shall be equally applicable in the authorization and issuance of refunding bonds, including their terms and security, the bond resolution, trust indenture, taxes and revenues, and other aspects of the bonds.

(e) Bonds issued pursuant to this section shall constitute an indebtedness of the municipality within the meaning of constitutional and statutory limitations. However, each bond issued pursuant to this section shall recite in substance that the bond, including interest payable thereon, is payable solely from the revenues or special funds pledged to the payment thereof and the bond constitutes a limited obligation of the municipality.

15-9-213. Revenue bonds.

In addition to the bonds authorized pursuant to W.S. 15-9-212, the municipality may issue revenue bonds payable solely from legally available nontax revenues of the municipality. Except for the foregoing, bonds shall be issued pursuant to all the other provisions of W.S. 15-9-211. However, revenue bonds issued pursuant to this section shall not constitute an indebtedness of the municipality within the meaning of any constitutional or statutory limitations but an election of the qualified electors of the municipality shall be required for the issuance thereof. The election shall be called, conducted, canvassed and returned in the manner provided for bond elections by the Political Subdivision Bond Election Law, W.S. 22-21-101 through 22-21-112. Each revenue bond issued pursuant to this section shall recite in substance that the bond, including interest thereon, is payable solely from the nontax revenues or special funds pledged to the payment thereof and the bond does not constitute a debt of the municipality within the meaning of any constitutional or statutory limitations.

15-9-214. Tax exemption; exceptions.

The bonds and the income therefrom shall be exempt from taxation, except estate and transfer taxes.

15-9-215. Limitation of actions.

After thirty (30) days from the effective date of any ordinance or resolution authorizing the issuance of bonds pursuant to this article, all actions or suits challenging its findings, determinations or contents or challenging the validity of the bonds shall be perpetually barred.

15-9-216. Rights and powers of bondholders.

(a) Subject to any contractual limitations binding upon the holders of any issue of bonds or trustee therefor, including but not limited to the restriction of the exercise of any remedy to a specified proportion or percentage of the holders, any holder of bonds or trustee therefor has the right and power, for the equal benefit and protection of all holders of bonds similarly situated:

(i) By an action in the nature of mandamus or other suit, action or proceeding at law or in equity to enforce his rights against the municipality and to require and compel the governing body to perform its duties and obligations under this article and its covenants and agreements with the bondholders;

(ii) By action or suit in equity to require the governing body to account as if they were the trustees of an express trust;

(iii) By action or suit in equity to enjoin any acts or things which may be unlawful or in violation of the rights of the bondholders;

(iv) To bring suit upon the bonds.

(b) No right or remedy conferred by this article upon any holder of bonds or any trustee therefor is intended to be exclusive of any other right or remedy, but each such right or remedy is cumulative and in addition to every other right or remedy and may be exercised without exhausting and without regard to any other remedy conferred by this article or by any other law.

15-9-217. Officers and other personnel employed by board; duties; administrative expenses.

(a) The board shall employ and fix the compensation, subject to the approval of the governing body, of the following, who shall serve at the pleasure of the board:

(i) A director, who shall be a person of good moral character and possessed of a reputation for integrity, responsibility and business ability. No member of the board is eligible to hold the position of director. Before entering upon the duties of his office, the director shall take and subscribe to the oath of office and furnish a bond as required by the board. The director is the chief executive officer of the authority. Subject to the approval of the board and directed by it when necessary, he shall have general supervision over and be responsible for the preparation of plans and the performance of the functions of the authority in the manner authorized by this article. He shall attend all meetings of the board and shall render to the board and to the governing body a regular report covering the activities and financial condition of the authority. In the absence or disability of the director, the board may designate a qualified person to perform the duties of the office as acting director. The director shall furnish the board with such information or reports governing the operation of the authority as the board may from time to time require;

(ii) A treasurer, who shall keep the financial records of the authority and who, together with the director, shall approve all vouchers for the expenditure of funds of the authority. He shall perform such other duties as may be delegated to him by the board;

(iii) A secretary, who shall maintain custody of the official seal, if any, and of all records, books, documents or other papers not required to be maintained by the treasurer. He shall attend all meetings of the board and keep a record of all its proceedings. He shall perform such other duties as may be delegated to him by the board;

(iv) Upon recommendation of the director, such clerical, technical and professional assistants, including but not limited to persons in the fields of engineering, planning and economic research, as shall, in the opinion of the board, be necessary to provide for the efficient performance of the functions of the board.

(b) Upon approval of the governing body of the municipality and a majority of the persons voting in the election, called for the purpose of this subsection, owning real property within the downtown development authority excluding real property used exclusively for residential purposes, under election procedures specified by the governing body, an annual special assessment not to exceed thirty (30) mills against the assessed value of real property within the downtown development authority, excluding real property used exclusively for residential purposes, may be levied. The authorization for the assessment expires in four (4) years unless reauthorized by the governing body and persons owning real property within the district. The assessment shall be levied and collected in the same manner as the general property tax levy for the municipality. Proceeds of the assessment may be expended by the authority for:

(i) Administrative costs;

(ii) Landscaping or maintenance of public areas;

(iii) Planning or management of development or improvement activities;

(iv) Promotion of public events; and

(v) Activities in support of business recruitment and development.

(c) All proceeds of the assessment shall be used by the authority for district activities and improvements.

15-9-218. Authority to adopt budget; sources of finance.

(a) The authority shall adopt a budget for each fiscal year, shall maintain accounts, and shall cause an annual audit, or other oversight in accordance with rules applicable to special districts under W.S.

9-1-507(a)(iii), to be made pertaining to the fiscal affairs of the authority. Administrative review of the proposed budget shall be in accordance with the policies of each municipality, prior to submission of the proposed budget to the governing body for approval.

(b) The operations of the authority shall be principally financed from the following sources and such other sources as may be approved by the governing body:

(i) Donations to the authority;

(ii) Monies borrowed and to be repaid from other funds received under the authority of this article.

15-9-219. Assessments against funds of authority.

The governing body shall have the power to assess against the funds of the authority for the use and benefit of the general fund of the municipality a reasonable pro rata share of such funds for the cost of handling and auditing, which assessment when made shall be paid annually by the board pursuant to an appropriate item in its budget.

15-9-220. Conflict of interest.

No board member or employee of the board shall vote or otherwise participate in any matter in which he has a specific financial interest, defined as a matter in which the member or employee would receive a benefit or incur a cost substantially greater than other property owners within the district. When such interest appears, the board member or employee shall make such interest known, and shall thenceforth refrain from voting on or otherwise participating in the particular transaction involving such interest. Willful violation of the provisions of this section constitutes grounds for dismissal subject to the provisions of W.S. 15-9-206(d).

15-9-221. Provisions to be construed liberally.

All powers conferred upon municipalities by this article are cumulative and in addition to those conferred by any other general or special law or municipal charter or ordinance and shall be liberally construed to effectuate the purposes of this article. This article is an alternative method of accomplishing its purposes independent of and in addition to any other powers conferred upon municipalities electing to exercise the authority granted by this article.

15-9-222. Property in development area subject to taxes for municipality's general obligation debts.

Subject to W.S. 15-9-207, all real and personal property located within the development area shall continue to be subject to ad valorem taxes levied by the municipality to pay the principal and interest on all existing general obligation debts of the municipality and any future debts which may be authorized by law.

15-9-223. Inclusion of additional property into development area; procedure.

Subsequent to the organization of an authority, additional property may be included in the development area. Proceedings for inclusion shall be initiated by petition to the board of the authority signed by the owner or owners in fee of each parcel of land adjacent to the existing area sought to be included. The petition shall include evidence satisfactory to the board concerning title to the property and an accurate legal description thereof. If the board approves the application, it shall submit the application to the governing body of the municipality. If the governing body also approves the application, it shall then, at a regular or special meeting, by amendment to the ordinance treating the authority, redescribe the development area so as to include the additional property as described in the petition. From the effective date of the amendment the additional property shall be included within the development area and shall be subject to any taxes thereafter imposed by the municipality for the use and benefit of the authority.

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Wyoshpo@state.wy.us (and links)
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Interviews, Contacts and Chats

(With apologies – and thanks – to many of those we’ve missed on this list.)

Sean Allen
Christy Anderson
Amber Ash
Matt Ashby
Lea Bain
Rebecca Barrett
Brian Beadles
Randy Bernhart
Bev Bowman
Bob Bradshaw
Jim Brown
Georgia Broyles
Randy Bruns
Gene Burchett
Brandon Cammarata
Cheyenne City Clerk’s Office
Cheyenne Downtown Development Authority Board
Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board
Bob Clary
Jennifer Corso
Donna Cruz
Christie DePoorter
Harvey Deselms
John Dinneen
Joe Dougherty
Anne Dramko
James Elias
Jim Flesher
Fort Collins Wholesale Nursery
Glen Garrett
Patrick Graham
Bill Gribb
Lorraine Grisby
Jay Harnish
John Harrison
Carol Hoglund

Mary Hopkins
Tom Johnson
Mayor Richard Kaysen
Phil Keisler
Jack Knudson
Gary Kranse
Gilda Lara
Pete Laybourn
Scott Lieske
Brenda Lyttle
Dick Mason
Tom Mason
Michael McGee
Pat McGee
Don McKee
Frank Mendocino
Beth Miller
Sue Miller
Ed Murray
Dick O’Gara
Lisa Olsen
Lucie Osborn
Jim Osterfoss
Wendy Owen
Sara Needles
Bob Nelson
Josh Nicholas
Mona Lee Pearl
Matt Pope
Paula Qualls
Mary Randolph
Darren Rudloff
Brenda Salverson
Jan Spires
Michael Stanfield
Dale Steenbergen
Mark Stock
Thomas Stuckey
John Sundahl
Diane Tammen
Mary Ellen Tast

Pam Thayer
Bruce Thompson
Don Threewitt
Sean Timm
Tom Tisthammer
Dave Tubener
Kathleen Urban
John Volk
Robin Volk
Kelly Weidlich
Al Wiederspahn
Jeff Wiggins
Bruce Wilson
Scott Wisniewski
Sherry Wunder
Wyoming Department of Revenue, Liquor Division